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INEVITABLE CHANGES

India always corrects course: BJP veteran

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'ABUSE OF PROCESS'

Centre moves SC to stay hearings on Nicobar project

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'DAILY WORKHORSE'

OpenAI unveils new lower-cost model

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REASON TO RITUAL

The drift of Indian academia

Academic institutions must remain spaces for dissent, fearless inquiry

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SECOND ODI

India looks to seal series against WI

SPORT » PAGE 18

Suspend SIR as its constitutional validity is doubtful, says Congress

Congress Working Committee expresses 'grave concern' over 'systematic subversion' of electoral system, seeks resignation of Modi, Shah; it calls CEC a 'small fish', seeks immediate halt to the review exercise and restoration of 13.3 crore deleted names

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Alleging a "match-fixing" among Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, and Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, the Congress Working Committee (CWC) on Tuesday demanded Mr. Modi's resignation, the removal of the CEC, an immediate suspension of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, and the restoration of 13.3 crore names deleted through the exercise.

The CWC resolution called for the resignations of Mr. Modi and Mr. Shah after party president Mallikarjun Kharge said that "Mr. Kumar was a small fish and the real big ones are the Prime Minister and the Home Minister". The remark was strongly endorsed by Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi.

In its resolution, the CWC said an exercise of "doubtful constitutional validity cannot be allowed to decide who may vote in the world's largest democracy".

"This brazen vote *chori* has been organised by the CEC on behalf of the Prime Minister and the Home Minister. Nothing short of their resignation will ensure the safety of our Constitution and hard-earned democracy," the resolution said. "For the Indian National Congress, the struggle to restore universal adult franchise in India is no less than the Freedom Struggle itself," it said.

The CWC expressed "grave concern over the systematic subversion" of India's electoral system and said the Bharatiya Janata Party and its "hand-picked officials" must understand that this "brazen theft" of the people's franchise would not go unanswered.

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MUSLIM VOTERS TARGETED
» PAGE 9

Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge with Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi at the CWC meeting in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

EC reverts to original format for Form 6 online

NEW DELHI
The Election Commission has reverted to the original format of Form 6 used for fresh voter registrations in its online module, with a separate declaration to be filled by voters in States that are under currently undergoing the SIR process. » PAGE 9

SC agrees to hear petition against CEC next week

NEW DELHI
The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to hear next week a petition citing allegations against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar regarding his unilateral exercise of authority in the name of the Election Commission. » PAGE 9

Opposition lambasts demography panel's 'diabolical' questions

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

A day after *The Hindu* reported that the Union government-appointed demography panel was seeking religion-wise data on birth registrations, school enrolment, ration cards, vehicle registrations, property transactions, Aadhaar enrolment, and voter registration among others, Opposition parties raised concerns about the questionnaire.

Congress general secretary and Rajya Sabha member Jairam Ramesh accused the panel of a "diabolical agenda". "This panel has a patently diabolical agenda and has clearly articulated pre-conceived biases. Its report has already been prepared no doubt," he said on *X*.

Urging Union Home Minister Amit Shah to review the committee's working, K.B.S. Sidhu, former Special Chief Secretary, Punjab, said the panel's demand has no legal basis and it cannot be met without guessing citizens' religion from their names.

All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen president Asaduddin Owaisi also questioned the panel, saying its agenda was "to twist and distort the data."

> This panel [on demography] has a patently diabolical agenda and has clearly articulated pre-conceived biases. Its report has already been prepared, no doubt
>
> JAIRAM RAMESH
> Congress general secretary

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NEARBY

Court reserves bail plea orders in POCSO case

CHENNAI
The Special Court for POCSO Act cases on Tuesday reserved its orders on bail petitions filed by Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan, co-accused in the case filed against Gem Granites proprietor R. Veeramani, who was arrested on charges of assaulting minors. » PAGE 8

No bar on holding byelection in Perundurai: EC

CHENNAI
The legal bar on conducting a byelection to the Perundurai Assembly constituency has ended owing to the rejection of an election petition related to the constituency on September 8, the Election Commission (EC) has submitted before the Madras High Court. » PAGE 8

Police search houses of HuT 'sympathisers'

THANJAVUR
Special Intelligence Unit (SIU) personnel conducted searches in Thanjavur on Tuesday at the houses of six persons, who are allegedly 'sympathisers' of a global movement to establish an Islamic State and Caliphate. Inquiries revealed that the six persons were actively involved in the activities of the movement named Hizb-ut-Tahrir (HuT). » PAGE 8

OPPORTUNITIES PAGE 3
▸ Over 107 Jobs in today's issue

Fantastic four

Champion quartet: Vithya Ramraj, M.R. Povamma, Prachi Singh, and Kiran Pahal ran a great race in the women's 4x400m relay to give India its first athletics gold at the 2026 Asian Games on Tuesday. Shooter Neeru also triumphed to take the gold tally to six. R.V. MOORTHY (REPORT: PAGE 17)

Teachers oppose T.N. govt.'s proposal to build memorial

Saptarshi Bhattacharya
K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

The govt. plans to build the memorial complex for 5 icons on a portion of the University Union Grounds in Chetpet belonging to the University of Madras

The Tamil Nadu government has proposed to establish an integrated memorial complex for five icons – Queen Velu Nachiyar, Periyar E.V. Ramasamy, B.R. Ambedkar, K. Kamaraj, and Anjalai Ammal – along with a library on a portion of the University Union Grounds in Chetpet belonging to the University of Madras (UoM). The five personalities are also the "ideological leaders" of the ruling TVK.

A cross-section of UoM faculty, staff, physical education teachers of affiliated colleges and sports enthusiasts has objected to the proposal. The University Union Grounds on Spur Tank Road is widely used not only by sportspersons of the university and its affiliated colleges but also different educational institutions to host their sports meets and for training.

According to sources, the Chennai Collector, in a letter dated September 17, addressed to the University authorities, sought its consent for establishing the integrated memorial complex and library on a portion of the grounds. Sources said officials from the Egmore Tahsildar's office had visited the grounds recently and had taken measurements of the plot of land.

The Collector, in the letter, said Minister Rajmohan had, during the recent Budget session of the Assembly, announced the government's proposal to set up the memorial for the leaders at an investment of ₹5 crore.

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» PAGE 8

HC quashes charge sheet against 2 accused in Kavin murder case

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI/CHENNAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court on Tuesday quashed the charge sheet filed by the CB-CID against Saravanan and Krishnakumari, parents of Surjith, who is the main accused in the Kavin Selvaganesh caste killing case.

Kavin, who belonged to a Scheduled Caste and hailed from Arumugamangalam near Eral in Thoothukudi district, was in a relationship with S. Subhashini of Palayamkottai, a Siddha doctor. Kavin was murdered on July 27, 2025. Surjith, Subhashini's younger brother, was arrested on charges of murder. Later, his cousin Jayapal and his parents were arraigned as co-accused in the case.

Under suspension

The charge sheet filed against Saravanan and Krishnakumari – both Sub-Inspectors now placed under suspension – before the II Additional District Court (PCR Act Cases), Tirunelveli, said they had learnt about the relationship in 2016-17.

Thereafter, Saravanan cautioned his daughter and spoke to Kavin over phone during 2018-19.

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Top court flags steep mark-ups on essential drugs

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday expressed concern over the sharp disparity between the prices charged to retailers and consumers for essential medicines, particularly cancer drugs, observing that steep mark-ups placed an enormous burden on taxpayers and amounted to "carnage".

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta questioned the Centre on why the 16% retailer margin provided for under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order (DPCO), 2013, should not be applied uniformly to essential medicines to curb steep mark-ups over the price to retailer (PTR).

"Why not keep the 16% margin on MRP, which is prescribed in the DPCO, on everything?... Ultimately, the loser is the taxpayer. This is carnage, as simple as that," the Bench remarked.

The observations came while the top court was hearing petitions filed by advocate Kishan Chand Jain and paediatric surgeon Sanjay Kulshrestha, seeking its intervention to regulate the prices of drugs, medical equipment, and generic medicines, and make them more affordable.

Justice Mehta pointed, in particular, to the nearly ten-fold mark-up on an essential cancer drug, which was supplied to retailers for around ₹3,000 but sold to consumers for ₹27,000. He questioned who ultimately benefited from the nearly ₹24,000 difference. "You tell us why this difference... Where does this chunk of money go? Ten times..." Justice Mehta remarked.

He also referred to Rosuvas, a commonly used statin, noting that a strip costs around ₹240. He said that while the drug falls in the non-scheduled category, its combination with aspirin is a scheduled formulation subject to price control under the DPCO and costs around ₹70 per strip. "So a combination should be more costly. It should be costlier, but the disparity is there," he said.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, acknowledged the concern and said the government would have to find a way forward while "balancing equities".

'Private gainers'

He, however, said it was private hospitals, rather than pharmaceutical companies, that benefited from the steep mark-ups. "The pharma company is not the gainer. The gainer is the private hospital," the law officer submitted.

The Bench also flagged the practice of private hospitals insisting that patients purchase medicines from their in-house pharmacies, leaving them with little choice to procure the same drugs at lower prices elsewhere.

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Unchecked prices

The petitions in SC have sought directions to make drug formulations more affordable

- Justice Sandeep Mehta, part of the Bench, points to the mark-up on an 'essential cancer drug' supplied to retailers for around **₹3,000** but sold to consumers for **₹27,000**
- He also points to Rosuvas, a common statin, priced at **₹240** per strip, contrasting it with its combined formula with aspirin, which costs a mere **₹70 per strip**

> Why not keep the 16% margin on MRP, which is prescribed in the DPCO, on everything? ... Ultimately, the loser is the taxpayer. This is carnage, as simple as that - SC BENCH

New NCERT text focuses on medieval Indian history

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

The new Social Science textbook for Class 9 students released by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) on Tuesday has prioritised India's medieval history.

The textbook, *Understanding Society: India and Beyond - Part Two*, replaces the previous edition's chapters on European revolutions, particularly the French and Russian revolutions, with a detailed exploration of Indian sovereignty and resilience.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

INBRIEF

Walkathon, public awareness sessions held at RGGGH

To mark World Heart Day, observed on September 29, the Institute of Cardiology at the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital (RGGGH) organised a public awareness campaign and a walkathon on the theme 'Healthy Hearts, Brighter Tomorrows' on Tuesday. According to a press release, the programme, held under the auspices of Cardiological Society of India (Chennai Chapter), commenced with the 'Don't Miss a Beat' walkathon, which was flagged off from Madras Medical College (MMC) by dean K. Shantaraman. Director and Head, Institute of Cardiology, K. Kannan; president of CSI Chennai Chapter D. Prabhakar; and secretary of CSI Chennai Chapter M. Nandakumaran took part.

Radhika Chakravarthy is Chief Postmaster General

Radhika Chakravarthy has assumed charge as the Chief Postmaster General (CPMG), Tamil Nadu postal circle. Ms. Chakravarthy is a 1996-batch officer of the Indian Postal Service. The Tamil Nadu postal circle comprises 11,685 post offices across the State and Puducherry, and has about 50,000 employees.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (September 30, Wednesday), the following articles are available:

- What are the provisions of AFSPA? **newsth.live/whatisafspa**
- Amazon v. Perplexity: who's in control when an AI agent acts for you? **newsth.live/controlquestion**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Robotic cameras to help in detecting leaks and pollution in water network across city

Chennai Metrowater has engaged Solinas Integrity Private Limited, an IIT-M-incubated start-up, to fast-track the identification of complaints; robots were previously deployed on a pilot basis in 2023

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

Advanced solution: The cameras transmit video footage of leaks and blocks in pipelines as well as other structural damages. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Water pollution and leaks in ageing drinking water pipelines remain a concern in the city. To reduce water loss during distribution and detect leaks in the supply network, Chennai Metrowater has started using robotic equipment to assess the condition of the pipelines.

The conventional method of identifying the sources of leaks or water pollution involves digging multiple trial pits and making road cuts to understand the issue.

Officials of Metrowater said it was a time-consuming process, often resulting in disruption in water supply, more manpower and restoration costs. In some instances, identification of the issue and restoration could take up to 10 days as contamination ingress points were difficult to locate accurately.

It may be recalled that the water agency had deployed robots on a pilot basis in the city network to inspect the lines for damage in 2023.

Chennai Metrowater maintains a distribution network of nearly 6,200 km across the city. Defects in pipelines, including cracks, corrosion and sediment accumulation, pose major operational challenges. To fast-track the identification of complaints, the water agency has engaged Solinas Integrity Private Limited, an IIT-Madras-incubated startup, to provide robotic solutions across the city.

While the water agency receives complaints, including from zones 4, 5, 6 and 13, areas such as Mogappair and Ramapuram have been identified as vulnerable to frequent water pollution complaints.

With the robotic solution, a single pit, measuring 90 m to 100 m on each side, is dug to access the pipeline. Robotic micro cameras capture visual data from inside of the pipeline and transmit video footage of leaks, blocks and other structural damages. This enables officials to check defects and assess the pipeline's condition within a day, officials said.

Water pollution

Residents of Mogappair said water pollution had been a frequent issue in areas, including Golden Colony, Valliammai Salai and Kavimani Salai. They said the network was inadequate for the mushrooming buildings, and urged the authorities to provide a permanent solution.

At present, the water agency has assigned the work on a hire basis, with payment depending on the type of robotic equipment and length of the pipeline inspected.

The rates range from ₹13 per metre to ₹53 per metre. While robocams are being used for small-diameter pipelines, two other types of robotic equipment are used to inspect pipelines of a diameter larger than 100 m.

The defect detection reports generated would enable Metrowater execute repair or replacement of the pipelines.

The ₹3.99-crore project would cover pipeline inspection for two years. The startup would be responsible for restoring the dug-up portions of the roads.

Political commentator V. Ponraj, economist Parakala Prabhakar, and journalist Ayyanathan in a brain-storming session organised by the Movement for Retrieving Voter Rights on Tuesday. R. RAGU

SIR is an attempt to make India a '*savarna* Hindu Rashtra', says Parakala Prabhakar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Economist and author Parakala Prabhakar on Tuesday contended that the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls, in which several thousand entries were removed across the country, was a part of efforts to turn India into a "*savarna* Hindu Rashtra".

"By deleting these people from political society, the aim is to make India a Hindu Rashtra, a *savarna* Hindu Rashtra. Please understand that SIR is not just an electoral issue," Mr. Prabhakar said. The SIR should be opposed at the fundamental level, he said. "Fundamental opposition has to stem from what it [the SIR] is going to lead India into," he added.

The voters deleted from the rolls were largely Muslims, Christians, minorities, Dalits, Adivasis, and marginalised and voiceless people, he said. "People still ask if that was so, how these communities continue to be on the rolls...Can anybody say this will be the last SIR?" he said.

Taking part in a brainstorming session, 'Ban EVM, Reject SIR', organised by the Movement for Retrieving Voter Rights at Periyar Thidal in Chennai, Mr. Prabhakar pointed out how the SIR carried out by the Election Commission of India recently was different from the ones carried out a few years ago.

Observing that there was little time left before democracy in the country could be protected, Mr. Prabhakar called upon political parties to remain united and put up a strong fight against the SIR.

He further appealed to them not to contest elections, contending that taking part in the elections would only "legitimise the fraud".

Political commentator V. Ponraj recalled instances where several voters were removed from the electoral rolls in various parts of the country. Journalist Ayyanathan said paper ballot was essential for democracy.

Section of Perambur Barracks Road caves in

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In poor shape: The road cave-in occurred near the Purasawalkam sewage pumping station around 3.30 p.m. on Tuesday. R. RAGU

A portion of the Perambur Barracks Road caved in on Tuesday, damaging a 1,200-mm diameter sewage pipeline. Traffic was affected following the sudden cave-in, and the affected stretch was cordoned off. The traffic police diverted vehicles through alternative routes.

According to Chennai Metrowater, the cave-in occurred near the Purasawalkam sewage pumping station around 3.30 p.m. on Tuesday. Officials who inspected the site found that the soil collapse had affected the old sewer pipeline underneath the road.

Measures were initiated to ensure that sewage flow was not disrupted, and to safeguard residents. Work has commenced to repair the damaged pipeline. Residents noted that cave-ins had occurred on the road on three occasions over the past five years, causing traffic disruption. Such issues were also reported in areas such as Pallavan Salai. Residents urged the authorities to investigate the possible causes, including the ongoing Metro Rail works, for the frequent road collapse.

Officials said the damaged portion of the pipeline was being removed, and would be replaced depending on the extent of the damage. The road surface would be restored. The work was being monitored, they added.

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

AAA/Roshini
Drama Super Star S.Ve Shekhar's TWO comedy Plays@ Vani Mahal (OBUL REDDY HALL) A/C. T.Nagar OCT 3rd Saturday 7pm. KATHULA POO 4TH Sunday 7pm. Mahabharathil Mangatha. Bkg. BookMyshow.com, MDND.com. 9677160240.

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Sl. No.	Tender Number	Tender Name	Tender Quantity/ Tender Category	Published date	Last date of submission
1	KSDL/2026-27/ IND1310	Procurement of Sandalwood Oil	9200 Kgs	28.09.2026	29.10.2026

For any queries contact the undersigned
Sd/- Asst. Gen. Manager (Materials)

Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF MINES & GEOLOGY
Office of the Director, No. 49, Khanija Bhavan, South Block, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560 001 Phone No:22384134/35

No. DMG-17012/26/2025/2026-27 **Dated: 29.09.2026**

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Department of Mines and Geology is calling tender for auction of seized Iron Ore and Iron Ore stocks in cancelled stockyards under notification through MSTC.

Eligibility conditions, terms and conditions, date and time for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Separate Lot wise auction notifications are published in MSTC portal. Tender Documents, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process of respective lots shall be available in electronic form only at the website of MSTC Ltd. **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/aucsearch/search.jsp**

The auction of old stock for each lot is "AS IS WHERE IS AND NO COMPLAINT BASIS". The interested bidders shall ascertain the quantity and quality of the Iron /Manganese ore before participation. The Department is not responsible for any dispute arising after confirmation of the bid. Interested bidders may visit the MSTC Ltd website.

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Director,
Department of Mines & Geology

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PERSONAL

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I, SARATH BABU COTHAPETA JANALA, S/o. Nagarajan, Dob 29-10-1993, residing at 1/155, Kamatchi Nagar, Mugalivakkam, Chennai-125. Shall henceforth be known as SARATH BABU NAGARAJAN.

I, R. Sindhu, D/o Rajendran DOB: 15-06-1992 Native: Chennai. Residing at No. 5, Rangaswami Street, Kadambadi Amman Nagar, Mettukuppam, Nerkundram, Chennai-107. Shall henceforth be known as Sindhu

I, SUGANYA Sree, daughter of Ramadass, native district Theni, Currently residing at No.203, 2nd Floor, C Block Ramapuram village, Kiloy Road, SriperumbudurTaluk, Kanchipuram District, I hereby Confirm and declare that the above mentioned name of my father as appearing in my Aadhar Card (No.3224–1071–3243) is the correct name

I, BIRENDRA Sharma dependent of Dev kumar Sharma, resident of House no 4, Gandhi road, Mittanamalli, Avadi,Chennai 600055 have changed my name Birendra Sharma to Birendra Kumar Sharma vide affidavit EY 410394 dtd 28092026 before Notary, Chennai

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General Superintendent, CMC Vellore

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SCHEDULE

Title of the Film	:	MR. BHAARATH
Languages	:	(i) Linear Distribution Rights: Tamil language **("Original Language")**, Telugu (dubbed), Kannada (dubbed) Malayalam (dubbed) ; (ii) On Demand Rights: in all Indian language versions, including the Original Language and any dubbed versions of the same.
Star Cast	:	Bhaarath, Samyuktha Viswanathan and others
Director	:	Mr. Niranjan
Effective Date On Demand Rights	:	28 days from the date theatrical release of the original film
Effective Date Linear Rights	:	90 days from the date theatrical release of the original film
End Date	:	Perpetual
Territory	:	Entire World (Exclusive for India territories and non-exclusive for rest of the world)
Runs	:	Unlimited
Rights	:	Shall mean the Linear and Non-Linear (i)Satellite Broadcasting rights; (ii) Cable TV Rights; (iii) DTH Rights; (iv) Terrestrial Rights; (v) Doordarshan Rights; (vi) IPTV Rights; (vii) Non-linear / On-demand Rights; (viii) Airborne Rights; (ix) Seaborne Rights; (x) Surface Transport Rights; (xi) Home Video Rights; (xii) Simulcast Rights; (xiii) Subtitling Rights for all languages of the world; (xiv) Catch Up TV Rights; (xv) Mobile Rights; (xvi) Internet Rights; (xvii)Digital Exhibition Rights on On-Demand Basis through Pay TV, PPV,VOD,NVOD,AVOD, SVOD, TVOD, FVOD, EST, Internet & IPTV ; (xviii) Download Rights (Temporary); (xix) Gaming Rights; (xx) Virtual Reality Rights; (xxi) Augmented Reality Rights; (xxii) New Exploitation Rights & Methods; (xxiii) Ancillary Rights; (xxiv) Syndication Rights in India; (xxv) Direct -to – Mobile Rights; (xxvi) Commercial Establishment Rights; (xxvii) Digital Terrestrial Television Rights; (xxviii) Dubbing Rights; (xxix) Clip Rights and (xxx) Public Exhibition Rights.

Dated: 30th September 2026
Place : Chennai
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INBRIEF

Girish Mathrubootham to fund *Sarpatta Parambarai 2*

Freshworks founder Girish Mathrubootham is all set to produce filmmaker Pa. Ranjith's *Sarpatta Parambarai 2 (Second Round)*, the sequel to the 2021 boxing drama. Sources said actor Arya, a close friend of Mr. Mathrubootham, was instrumental in bringing him on board for the project. Taking to social media platform X, Mr. Arya said: "The origin of *Sarpatta Parambarai* begins," tagging Mr. Ranjith and Mr. Mathrubootham in his post. Those who know Mr. Mathrubootham well say he would never miss a Rajinikanth film, and is deeply passionate about cinema. When Freshworks filed for its initial public offering (IPO) on Nasdaq, Mr. Mathrubootham even code-named the financial filing 'Project SuperStar'.

Metro Rail Phase II tickets to cost the same; maximum to be capped at ₹50

Trains will halt at all stations between Poonamallee and Porur; for now, they will bypass unfinished stations at Alapakkam, Karambakkam, Valasaravakkam, Alwarthirunagar, Saligramam Warehouse, and Saligramam en route to Vadapalani

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Chennai Metro Rail ticket prices will remain unchanged with the commencement of operations under the Phase II network, with a ride from Poonamallee to Vadapalani costing ₹40.

According to the Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), when commuters change trains between the Phase I and Phase II networks and travel longer distances, the maximum fare would be capped at ₹50. For those who travel from Poonamallee to areas in the north, including Wimco Nagar, Tiruvottiyur, Kaladipet, and Washermenpet, or localities in the south, such as Chennai Airport, the maximum fare would be ₹50. Of this, commuters could get a 20 per cent discount on all tickets, except paper QR tickets, which could be purchased directly from the station counter.

New route: The Phase II network from Poonamallee to Vadapalani, via Porur, will be inaugurated on October 11. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

After a long wait, commuters are eagerly anticipating the inauguration of the first stretch of the Phase II network from Poonamallee to Vadapalani, via Porur, on October 11. For a trip from Poonamallee to Porur or from Porur to Vadapalani, it would cost ₹30.

The trains would cover 14.6 km, stopping at all 10 stations from Poonamallee and Porur. But for now, the next stop after Porur would be only at Vadapalani. The construction of the following stations in this stretch – Alapakkam, Karambakkam, Valasaravakkam, Alwarthirunagar, Saligramam Warehouse, and Saligramam – has been hit by delays, and it may take a few more months for the works to be finished.

R.K. Ravichandran, a resident of Iyyapanthangal, said travelling to his usual destinations including Vadapalani and Koyambedu would get a lot easier with the opening of the Phase II network. "I hope CMRL opens the remaining stations at the earliest. The stretch is going to open after months of delay. I hope they speed up the work on the other stations," he said.

Timings
CHENNAI

WEDNESDAY, SEP. 30		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:00
RISE	20:49	SET 09:08
THURSDAY, OCT. 01		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:59
RISE	21:47	SET 10:11
FRIDAY, OCT. 02		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:59
RISE	22:49	SET 11:15

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	38	29
Chennai City	38	28

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be very warm. Night will be comfortable. Chances of light to moderate rain and thundershower.

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THE HINDU
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Poor diet and sedentary habits causing metabolic disorders among youth: expert

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Poor diet, sedentary habits, and prolonged screen use are contributing to metabolic disorders among young people, said Challa Suresh, Scientist 'G' and Director Grade, Head of the Cell Biology Division, AcSIR Coordinator at the ICMR-National Institute of Nutrition, at an oration organised by Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research recently.

Prof. Challa Suresh and other participants at an event held at Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research recently.

Delivering the Prof. S.P. Thyagarajan Endowment Oration on 'The Modern Lifestyle Paradox: Why are Young People Developing Metabolic Disorder Earlier?', Prof. Suresh stressed the importance of nutritious food and healthier habits in preventing lifestyle-related illnesses.

Prof. Suresh advised young people to choose wholesome, nutrient-rich food, and limit consumption of processed and packaged foods, which he linked to rising obesity.

'Reduce screen time'

Prof. Suresh called for reducing screen time, noting that prolonged use of digital devices encourage sedentary behaviour, and affect memory and overall well-being.

The event was attended by officials of the university, academicians, clinicians, researchers, and students.

Tamil scholar and historian honoured with awards at VIT

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Eminent Tamil scholar V. Padhumanar and historian A.R. Venkatachalapathy were honoured with the Mahavidwan Meenakshi Sundaram Pillai Award and the Dr. U.Ve. Swaminatha Iyer Award, respectively, by the Dr. U.Ve. Swaminatha Iyer Library, Chennai, at a function held at Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT) on Tuesday.

Assembly Speaker J.C.D. Prabhakar presented the awards, in the presence of G. Viswanathan, chancellor, VIT, and G.V. Selvam, vice-president, VIT, a release said.

Mr. Padhumanar was presented with the award for his contribution to the Tamil language, while Mr. Venkatachalapathy got the award in recognition of his contribution to Tamil history and research.

Mr. Prabhakar also released a book on *Nannool*, with Mr. Selvam receiving the first copy, the release added.

THE HINDU
OPPORTUNITIES

Over 107 Jobs in today's issue

GENERAL

kerala IT — TECHNOPARK THIRUVANANTHAPURAM — HARMONY@WORK

WE ARE HIRING

Electronics Technology Parks-Kerala (Technopark), an autonomous organization fully owned by the Government of Kerala, invites applications from eligible candidates for the post of **Chief Security Officer**

Interested candidates may visit the Technopark website at **https://www.technopark.in/careers** for more details and submit their online application along with copies of certificates and testimonials on or before **14/10/2026**. Only online applications will be accepted.

Chief Executive Officer
Park Centre, Technopark Campus, Karyavattom P.O
Thiruvananthapuram - 695581, Phone: 0471-2700222

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VICE - CHANCELLOR

Applications are invited from distinguished academicians with proven track record as per UGC norms for the post of Vice-Chancellor at Shri Venkateshwara Vidyapeeth (Deemed-to-be University), Puducherry.
Last Date for Submission of Application on or before 05.10.2026
br.ret6@gmail.com 9442185369

VNRVJIET

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

VNR VJIET, a 31-year-old institution and one of the leading technological institutes in Hyderabad, Telangana, is distinguished by its well-established research facilities and strong support system for faculty engaged in filing copyrights and patents, invites applications for the following positions.

Post Vacant	Department	Qualifications & Experience
Assistant Professor Associate Professor Professor	CSE & Allied branches, Civil, Mechanical, Automobile, EEE, ECE, EIE and Biotechnology	• B.E/B.Tech and M.E/M.Tech in related branch with at least 60% aggregate. • Ph.D from NIT/IIIT will be preferred
	Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, English and Management Sciences	• M.A/M.Sc/MBA in related branch with at least 60% aggregate and Ph.D. • Ph.D from Central University/NIT/ IISC /IIT will be preferred

For the details of educational qualifications and experience please visit our website: **www.vnrvjiet.ac.in.** Interested candidates can send their updated resume to: **careers@vnrvjiet.in**. before **4.00 pm** on **15-10-2026.**

Date: 30-09-2026
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GENERAL SECRETARY
VIGNANA JYOTHI

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GENERAL

NML — एनटीपीसी माइनिंग लिमिटेड — NTPC Mining Limited (A Wholly Owned Subsidiary of NTPC Limited)

Advt. No.: NML/01/2026
Recruitment of Engineering Executive Trainees-2027 through GATE-2027

NTPC Mining Limited (NML), a wholly owned subsidiary of NTPC Ltd. and a Schedule 'B' CPSE, with a vision to be the leading mineral company to ensure the energy security of the Nation, is looking for young, dynamic and talented Engineering Graduates with a brilliant academic record in the following Engineering disciplines as **Engineering Executive Trainees (EET)-2027** through **GATE-2027.**

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All interested and eligible candidates should appear in the **Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering (GATE)-2027** examination in one of the above Engineering disciplines. Candidates will be shortlisted for the further selection process based on the GATE-2027 performance and the organisational requirements. GATE marks of previous years or any other examination shall not be accepted for EET-2027 recruitment. Detailed information regarding GATE-2027 is available on the website: **https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in/**

NML will publish a detailed advertisement to invite applications from candidates who have appeared in the GATE-2027 examination. The exact date and period of online application will be intimated on the NML's careers page **(https://nml.co.in/en/jobs/)** in due course. Candidates are required to visit the website regularly to get updates.

Note: The requirements notified herein are subject to change at any time based on organisational requirements. The company reserves the right to alter, modify, increase, decrease, or cancel the notified disciplines/positions, in whole or in part, without prior notice and without assigning any reason thereof. Any further addendum/ corrigendum/updates will only be published on the careers page of the NML's website.

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Sr. Asst. Engineer E-I Grade on Fixed Tenure	Fixed Tenure/ 15 Yrs	3 Yr Diploma in Electronics Engg or equivalent	UR-15	50 years	Rs. 30,000/- 3% Rs. 1,20,000/-
		3 Yr Diploma in Electrical Engg or equivalent	OBC-NCL-08, SC-9, ST-4.	OBC - 53 Years SC/ST – 55 Years	

Last date of receipt of applications is 16.10.2026. For further details, please visit recruitment link on official BEL website https://bel-india.in

Sd/-
DGM(HR&A), BEL GHAZIABAD

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(A Govt. of India Enterprise and Subsidiary of ONGC Limited) CIN No. : L19200KA1988GOI008959
Kuthethoor Post, Mangalore – 575 030 E-mail: pfte@mrpl.co.in

Date of opening of online portal for submitting application: 30/09/2026
Last Date for submitting online application: 29/10/2026

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited (MRPL), a Schedule 'A' Mini Ratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) and a subsidiary of ONGC Limited, invites online applications from bright, energetic, and dedicated professionals (Indian Nationals only) for engagement as Personnel on Fixed Term Employment (PFTE)

Advt. No.	Position Name	PFTE Position Level	No. of Posts and Reservation	Mode of Selection*
MRPL/ PFTE/02	Retail Construction Engineer / Retail Engineer	Executive Level L1	10# (UR-4, SC-2, ST-1,OBC-2 and EWS-1) #(1 reserved for PwBD -LV)	Through Personal Interview
MRPL/ PFTE/02	Terminal Operation Engineer	Executive Level L1	6 (UR-2, SC-1, OBC-2 and EWS-1)	Through Personal Interview

Abbreviation: UR-Unreserved, EWS- Economically Weaker Section, OBC (NCL) - Other Backward Class (Non-Creamy Layer), SC-Scheduled Caste, ST-Scheduled Tribe, PwBD- Persons with Benchmark Disability, LV- Low Vision.

* Eligible candidate will be called for Personal Interview (PI) after screening of the applications.

Interested candidates can visit website **https://www.mrpl.co.in/careers** for detailed advertisement.

GENERAL

VISAKHAPATNAM PORT AUTHORITY
General Administration Department

VACANCY NOTIFICATION

1.	Name of the Post & Scale of Pay	1) Deputy Chief Law Officer (Cl -I) on scale of Rs. 60,000-1,80,000 (DR) -01 Post 2) Welfare Officer (Cl – I) - Scale of Rs. 50,000-1,60,000 (DR) - 01 Post 3) Junior Hindi Officer (Cl – II) - Scale of Rs. 40,000 – 1,40,000 (DR) - 01 Post 4) Fire Officer (Contract basis) Consolidate Remuneration Rs. 60,000/- P.M - 01 Post
2.	Last Date	28.10.2026 (For all posts)

Detailed notification is available at careers section of VPA: https://vpt.shipping.gov.in

-Sd-
SECRETARY

NATIONAL LAW SCHOOL OF INDIA UNIVERSITY (NLSIU)
BENGALURU - 560072

FACULTY RECRUITMENT

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the following vacancies:

- **Professor (Law)**
- **Professor (Humanities & Social Sciences)**
- **Associate Professor (Law)**
- **Associate Professor (Humanities & Social Sciences)**
- **Associate Professor (Public Policy)**

Please visit the University website at www.nls.ac.in for the detailed Recruitment Notifications and Online Application Forms. Applications must be submitted by 26.10.2026 (5 pm IST).

Date: 30.09.2026 **REGISTRAR**

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

Hundreds of fishermen protest against Secretariat proposal at Foreshore Estate

Residents take out a silent march with black flags; community leaders urge the government to change its stand as their livelihoods will be greatly affected if construction work is launched

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Fishermen hailing from 64 villages located between Tiruvallur and Chengalpattu on Tuesday continued to pin their hopes on Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay withdrawing a G.O. issued regarding the construction of a new Secretariat at Foreshore Estate. Hundreds of fishermen and women, who staged a protest near Srinivasapuram, said they believed the Chief Minister had their welfare at heart.

Community leader K. Bharathi, who has been spearheading the protest, pointed out that Minister for Public Works and Sports Development Aadhav Arjuna had said that if asked to choose between fishermen and the Secretariat, the Chief Minister would choose the welfare of the fishermen. "We are hoping that the current proposal would be dropped and an alternative land would be chosen for the Secretariat," he said.

A community leader at the protest wanted the proposal to be dropped and an alternative site chosen for the building. M. SRINATH

Residents took out a silent march from their villages to the venue of the protest. Black flags planted on the sands fluttered in the wind, as leaders urged the government to change its stand as their livelihoods would be badly affected. "We won't have any freedom to carry on with our lives or unload our fish near the sands," said Kabaddi Maran, a community leader.

Land ownership

Roobesh, another community leader, said that the State government must return lands taken over from fishermen to build houses for government staff.

"Many of those buildings were demolished several years ago. There were several proposals, including construction of a large complex. The land on which the All India Radio stands today belonged to Nochikuppam," he said.

Viji of Srinivasapuram, another leader, said that fishermen demanded that around 10,000 slum clearance board tenements be demolished and reconstructed.

"Some of these buildings were constructed during former Chief Minister K. Kamaraj's time and in the 1970s. There has been no maintenance after the tsunami of 2004. We also want the government to construct homes for non-fishermen who live amongst us in these villages," he demanded.

Damaged platform shelters in ten railway stations to be replaced at a cost of ₹10.89 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Platform shelters in several railway stations in the western section of the city, which are damaged and leaking through the roof, are to be renovated. The suburban trains in the western section are operated from the Moore Market complex station to Tiruvallur and Arakkonam via Avadi.

The Southern Railway has proposed to replace the old shelters in the platforms of 10 railway stations, including Pattabiram, Pattabiram Military Siding, Pattabiram E Depot, Annanur, Veppampattu, Egattur, Putlur, Kadambathur, Senji Panambakkam, and Mosur.

The Pattabiram Military Siding railway station does not have proper platform shelters. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The suburban trains on the west section ply from Moore Market complex station to Tiruvallur, Arakkonam via Avadi

Essential amenities

A senior official of Southern Railway said the platform shelters would be replaced at a cost of ₹10.89 crore.

The shelters are being renovated as part of a project to provide minimum essential amenities, such as paving damaged platforms, improving water facility and providing proper accessway in 23 railway stations.

The Chennai division of Southern Railway had already started work in Annanur and Pattabiram railway stations after the tender was awarded to a contractor in September.

Commuters have been complaining about the poor access facilities in the Pattabiram Military Siding railway station.

R. Sritharan, a resident of Annanur, said the railway station, serving thousands of office-goers, had a leaking platform shelter, and wanted the work to be completed before the onset of the Northeast monsoon.

Man arrested for cheating woman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Ayanavaram police arrested a 35-year-old man for allegedly cheating a 32-year-old woman by promising to marry her and taking ₹50,000 and gold jewellery from her.

According to the police, the woman, a beautician, gave ₹50,000 to Ali Harman after he told her that he was in urgent need of money.

Later, Ali Harman also told her that he wanted to buy jewellery for their proposed wedding. Believing him, the woman handed over an earring, a ring, and a 1¼ sovereign chain.

Later, when she tried to contact him, he stopped answering her calls. Based on her complaint, Ayanavaram police conducted a probe and arrested Ali Harman.

The police said that he worked as a medical representative and had allegedly sold the jewellery obtained from the woman, and used the proceeds to purchase a car.

A car and two mobile phones, including an iPhone, were recovered from him.

'Savukku' Shankar sentenced to three-year imprisonment

'Savukku' Shankar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A city court on Tuesday convicted and sentenced YouTuber 'Savukku' Shankar to three years in prison in a case concerning alleged defamatory remarks and threats against a former newsreader.

Mahalakshmi, a former news anchor and advocate, first lodged a complaint against the YouTuber in 2013, alleging that he had published defamatory remarks about her on his 'Savukku' website.

Subsequently, Mahalakshmi filed a case before the Egmore court, alleging that Shankar and his associates had threatened her and fabricated documents.

A former news anchor and advocate lodged a complaint against him in 2013

On behalf of Mahalakshmi, it was argued that Mr. Shankar had deliberately spread defamatory allegations against her and had issued threats, warranting legal action.

Shankar's counsel, however, argued that the allegations and complaints against him were completely false.

Delivering the verdict on Tuesday, Additional Chief Metropolitan Magistrate (ACMM) Sivashakthi held that the charges against Shankar under Section 4 of the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act had been proved, and sentenced him to three years in prison.

The judge also granted the YouTuber 30 days to enable him to file an appeal.

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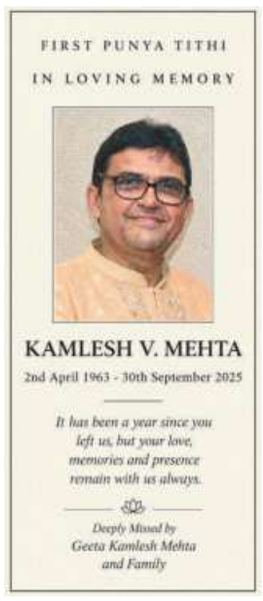
OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

In Loving Memory of Bharat Krishnan Age 70 who passed on peacefully on 30/9/2026. Son of the late S. Krishnan and Rajam Krishnan, Bharat leaves behind cherished memories in the hearts of all who knew and loved him. Deeply missed by his sisters:
Sushila Ravindranath
& Sumitra Sekaran

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES



SUPPLY WORKS

E-Tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works: **SN. 1. Tender No.: NB265736. PL Code (Group): 334316320030. Description:** Set of items for pipe laying for waste water for LHB Type coaches fitted with Bio Tank as per RCF Drg. no.-MI006005, Alt-a, Item no-1 to 10. Material specification and Quantity are as per Drawing. [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹83,290/-. **SN. 2. Tender No.: NB265716. PL Code (Group): 603200771039. Description:** Pump fuel injection to Cummins Engine model QSK50L as per CIL Part No. 5471754 (Old part No. 4306515) Bosch part No. in PUMP as AS F 00B C00017, Make: Bosch or Eqv [Warranty Period: 30 Months after the date of delivery]. **Earnest Money:** ₹79,060/-.**Date & Time of closing of tender: 14:30** hrs. of **23-10-2026.** The complete information with the tender document of above e-tender will be available in website **www.ireps.gov.in**

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(A Government of Gujarat undertaking)
Udyog Bhavan, Block No. 16, 4th Floor,
Sector - 11, Gandhinagar - 382 011
Website: https://www.gujarattourism.com

TENDER NOTICE

Bids are invited from reputed and experienced agencies for providing services towards **"Operation & Maintenance of National Salt Satyagrah Memorial (NSSM), Saifee Villa and Tourist Facilitation Centre at Dandi, Gujarat".**
The project requirements, technical specifications, eligibility criteria, selection process, etc. are included in the Tender document, which shall be available for download from the websites: **https://tender.nprocure.com/** and **https://www.gujarattourism.com** from **30/09/2026 onwards.**
The last date for submission of the **Technical and Financial Bid (online only) is 23/10/2026 up to 6:00 pm. and Technical Bid (physical only) is 26/10/2026 up to 3:00 pm.**
Managing Director

Office of the Director
INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
Govt. of Bihar
SHEIKHPURA, PATNA – 800 014 (Bihar, India)
Tel.: 0612 – 2297631, 2297099; Fax: 0612 – 2297225; Website: www.igims.org
E-Mail: director@igims.org
Ref. No.: EC/CW/ 1183/89 **/2026 /**391

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Director, IGIMS, Patna invites tender in Two Bid System (i.e. Technical & Financial Bid) from eligible, reputed and experienced Vendors for various Tender for

Sl No	Notice Inviting Tender No-	Description of work
01	06/IGIMS/Engg.Cell/CW/2026-27	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) for operation and maintenance of existing 1200 KLD capacity Sewage Treatment Plant at IGIMS Patna
02	07 /IGIMS/Engg.Cell/CW/2026-27	Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) for operation and maintenance of existing 20 KLD capacity Effluent Treatment Plant at IGIMS, Patna.

The last date of submission of tender document is **30/10/ 2026** up to 3:00 P.M. through Speed Post / Registered Post / Courier Services. The received bids (Technical only) will be opened in presence of bidders on **02/11 /2026** at 3:00 P.M. in the Store and procurement Cell, Administrative Block (Ground Floor) at IGIMS, Patna. A Pre-Bid meeting will also be arranged on **12 /10 /2026** at 3 :30 P.M.
Details of the proposed tender and its terms & conditions can be seen and downloaded from Institute Website www.igims.org. The undersigned reserves the right to accept / reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit www.igims.org for Corrigendum / Amendments etc., if any. It will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.
Director
PR- 012802 (B & C) 2026-27 **I.G.I.M.S. – Patna**
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Office of the Director
INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
Govt. of Bihar
SHEIKHPURA, PATNA – 800 014 (Bihar, India)
Tel.: 0612 – 2297631, 2297099; Fax: 0612 – 2297225; Website: www.igims.org
E-Mail: director@igims.org
Ref. No.: - **EC/CW/1082/255/2026/393**

Short Term Notice Inviting Tender for Civil Work

Sealed tenders in two bids system (Technical and Financial) are hereby invited for various civil repair and renovation works. The last date of submission of complete tender document is **13 / 10 /2026** up to **3:00 P.M.** through Speed Post / Registered Post / Courier Services only. The received bids (Technical Only) will be opened on **15 / 10/ 2026** on **3:00 PM** . Details of the propose tender can be seen and downloaded from Institute Website www.igims.org.
Undersigned reserve the right to accept / reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit www.igims.org for Corrigendum / Amendments etc., if any. It will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.
NIT No. :- 04/IGIMS/Engg.Cell /CW/2026-27
Director
PR- 012803 (B & C) 2026-27 **I.G.I.M.S.–Patna**
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

Govt. of Bihar
Office of the Director
INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES,
SHEIKHPURA, PATNA – 800 014 (Bihar, India)
Tel.: 0612 – 2297631, 2297099; Fax: 0612 – 2297225; Website: www.igims.org;
E-Mail: director@igims.org
Ref. No.: - EC / CW/ 1172 / 78 / 2026 / 392
Notice Inviting Tender for Appointment of Consultant/ Consultancy firm
NIT No.: - 08 /IGIMS/Eng. Cell /Consultancy Service /2026-27

Sealed proposals in two bids system (Technical and Financial) are hereby invited from eligible and experienced Consultancy Firms/Consultants **for Comprehensive Consultancy Services for Survey, Planning, Design, Drawing, Estimation, Tender Documentation and Tender Assistance for Hospital Campus Infrastructure/Signage Works including mandatory, regulatory, information, directional and road-side/internal signage and allied works at IGIMS, Patna.**
The last date of submission of complete tender document is **20 / 10/ 2026** up to 3: 30 P.M. through Speed Post / Registered Post / Courier Services only. The received Technical Proposals will be opened **21 /10 / 2026** up to 3 :00 P.M.. A Pre-Bid meeting will also be arranged on **05 /10 /2026** at 3 :30 P.M.
Details of the proposed tender can be seen and downloaded from Institute Website www.igims.org.
The undersigned reserves the right to accept/reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit www.igims.org for Corrigendum/Amendments etc., if any. It will be notified on this portal only and no separate advertisement will be made.
NIT No. :- 08 /IGIMS/Engg. Cell/CW/2026-27
PR. No. 012804 (B&C) 2026-27 **Director, I.G.I.M.S. – Patna**
This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also
सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

Mines and Geology Department
District- Banka
Notice Inviting E-Auction for Settlement of Stone Blocks
(Through MSTC over https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mmb/mmbbr/index.jsp**)**
बिहार खनिज (समानुदान, अवैध खनन, परिवहन एवं भंडारण निवारण) नियमावली, 2019 (समय–समय पर यथा संशोधित) में उल्लिखित प्रावधानों के तहत अनुमोदित जिला सर्वेक्षण प्रतिवेदन में सृजित पत्थर भूखण्डों की अगामी पाँच वर्षों के लिए बंदोबस्ती निम्न कार्यक्रमानुसार करायी जाएगी :–
ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रमः–

क्र0 स0	पत्थर भूखण्ड का नाम	ई–नीलामी से पूर्व प्री–बीड बैठक एवं प्रशिक्षण का समय एवं स्थान	निविदा दस्तावेज बिक्री शुल्क (10,000/–रू0) जमाकर निविदा दस्तावेज डाउनलोड प्रारंभ करने की तिथि	अग्रधन राशि ऑनलाईन जमा तथा निविदा दस्तावेज अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच एवं मूल्यांकन हेतु समाहर्त्ता द्वारा डाउनलोड करने की तिथि	तकनीकी निविदा की जाँच/ मूल्यांकन कर सफल निविदादाताओं की सूची सिस्टम में समाहर्त्ता द्वारा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	ई–नीलामी प्रारंभ होने की तिथि एवं समय	ई–नीलामी समाप्ति की तिथि एवं समय
01	पहरी पत्थर खदान	12/10/2026 जिला खनन कार्यालय, बाँका में समय 02:00 बजे से 03:00 बजे अपराहन् तक।	13/10/2026	23/10/2026 समय–05:00 बजे अपराहन् तक	24/10/2026	28/10/2026	29/10/2026 पूर्वाहन् 11:00 बजे	29/10/2026 अपराहन् 01:00 बजे

2. पत्थर भूखण्डों की विस्तृत विवरणी अनुलग्नक–6 के रूप में संलग्न है। साथ ही पत्थर भूखण्डों की विवरणी एवं KML File जिला के वेबसाईट–https://banka.nic.in एवं MSTC पोर्टल पर भी उपलब्ध है।
3. पत्थर भूखण्डों की बंदोबस्ती ई–नीलामी प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mmb/mmbbr/index.jsp से करायी जाएगी।
4. ई–नीलामी द्वारा कराई जा रही बंदोबस्ती में भाग लेने वाले निविदादाता को MSTC पोर्टल https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/mmb/mmbbr/index.jsp पर पंजीयन कराना अनिवार्य होगा।
5. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना (यथा– नीलामी कार्यक्रम, सुरक्षित जमा राशि, अग्रधन राशि, नीलामी प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क इत्यादि) विस्तृत रूप से जिला के वेबसाईट https://banka.nic.in, विभागीय वेबसाईट https://state.bihar.gov.in/mines/CitizenHome.html एवं MSTC पोर्टल पर उपलब्ध है।
6. एतद् संबंधी समस्त सूचना हेतु MSTC, दारोगा राय पथ, पटना–800001 के दूरभाष संख्या/मोबाईल संख्याः–8269000225/9899972556, Email Id:- ptnopn2@mstcindia.in/ptnopn3@mstcindia.in, Toll Free/Help Desk Number :- 0612-2506169/7969066600, समाहर्त्ता द्वारा प्राधिकृत पदाधिकारी के मो0 सं0 8544510765, 6200269788 आई0टी0 मैनेजर, बाँका जिला के मो0 सं0– 8114593904 से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।
7. उपरोक्त निर्धारित ई–नीलामी कार्यक्रम में आवश्यकतानुसार परिवर्तन किया जा सकता है।

निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
PR- 012734 (Mines) 2026-27 **समाहर्त्ता, बाँका**
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

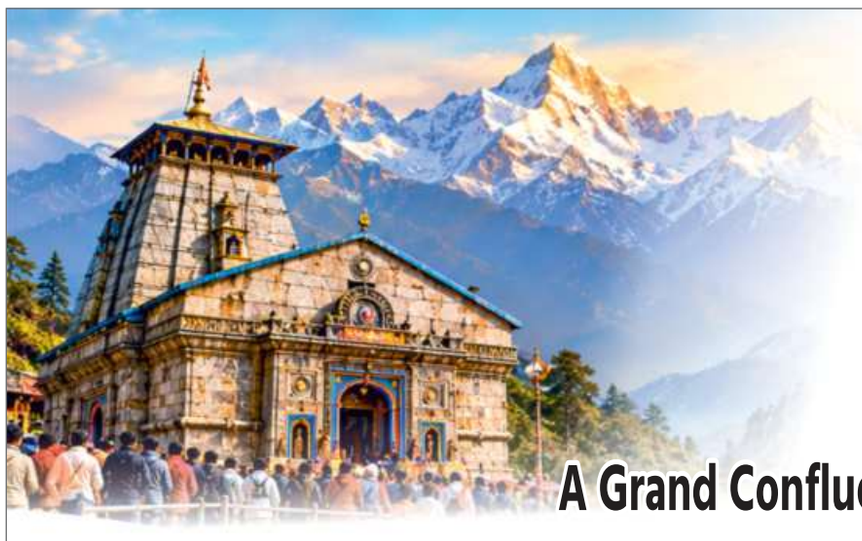
Directorate of Civil Aviation,
Uttar Pradesh, Lucknow.
E-mail:dgca.up@nic.in
E-Tender No-01/2026-27/Helicopter

E-tenders are invited by the Directorate of Civil Aviation, U.P., for the selection of valuer:

S. No	Details of work	Date of uploading E-Tender	Date of Opening E-Tender
1	Selection of valuer for providing Market Realizable Value for sale of Agusta A109S VT-UPL Helicopter along with its Spares, Rotables etc	28-09-2026	12-10-2026

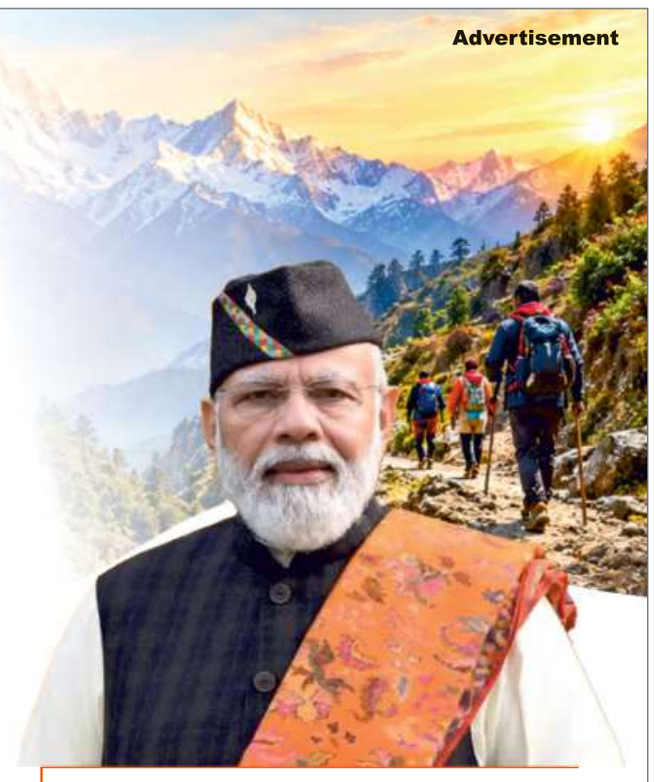
Interested organizations may download the tender document from the Uttar Pradesh e-tender portal (http://etender.up.nic.in) and submit their bids along with the prescribed fees (in accordance with e-tendering rules) by 11:00 AM on 12-12-2026. The e-tenders will be opened after the said date in the presence of the undersigned or officials authorized. The undersigned reserves the full right to cancel the tender without assigning any reason.
RO no: 257259
Ro date: 29-09-26
Website: www.up.gov.in **(Director)**

Advertisement



DEVBHOOMI Uttarakhand

Sewa | Sushasan | Samarpan



A Grand Confluence of Faith, Culture & Spiritual Consciousness

"Uttarakhand holds a special place on the tourism map, owing to its exceptionally rich culture and heritage. Tourism plays a vital role in strengthening the state's economy. Our tourist destinations are symbols of our historical and cultural civilizations, as well as our identity. Uttarakhand is a center of faith and spiritual experiences. To link tourism with employment, plans for developing new tourist destinations are being implemented here. Uttarakhand has always conveyed the message of 'Atithi Devo Bhava' to the nation and the world. The state is ready to welcome its guests."

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

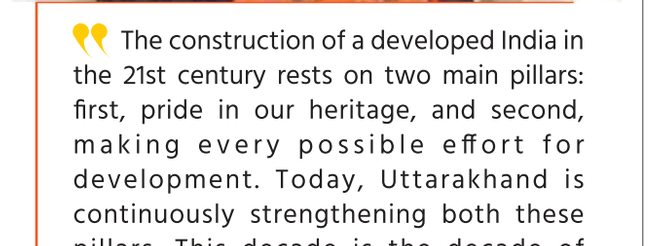
The resonant chants of "Har Har Gange" echoing from Har Ki Pauri, the sacred wisdom of revered saints, the unwavering faith of devotees, and the pristine flow of Mother Ganga—Haridwar Kumbh is not merely a religious gathering, but a magnificent celebration of India's timeless Sanatan culture and spiritual heritage.

The Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027 will commence on 14 January 2027 (Makar Sankranti) and conclude on 20 April 2027 (Chaitra Purnima). The sacred land of Haridwar is once again preparing to welcome millions of pilgrims from across India and around the world. This monumental festival offers a rare opportunity to collectively

experience devotion, spiritual discipline, selfless service, and cultural heritage. From holy dips in the sacred Ganga and darshan of venerable saints to the grand processions (Peshwai) of the Akharas and an array of spiritual ceremonies, every moment of the Kumbh carries a transcendent grace.

Concerted efforts are underway to ensure the event is seamless, safe, and well-organized, with dedicated emphasis on enhanced connectivity, efficient traffic management, immaculate cleanliness, robust security, and world-class pilgrim amenities.

This grand gathering is not solely an expression of faith; it is a living embodiment of "Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat", uniting people from diverse corners of the nation in a shared spirit of spiritual oneness. In view of this, the state government has initiated comprehensive preparations to ensure a flawless, hassle-free experience for every visiting pilgrim, sadhu, and seer.



"The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand."

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Uttarakhand Tourism Policy 2023

A Robust Roadmap Driving Sustainable Development & Investment

The geographical, cultural, and natural diversity of Uttarakhand has positioned it among the most preferred tourism destinations in North India. The state has witnessed a steady rise in tourist footfall. In 2014, approximately 22 million (2.2 crore) tourists visited Uttarakhand, a figure that surged to around 39 million (3.9 crore) by 2019. During this period, the state recorded a Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) of 11.97% in tourist arrivals.

According to a World Travel & Tourism Council report, India ranks as the world's seventh-largest tourism economy in terms of size. The report projected an estimated growth of approximately 7% in the tourism sector between 2017 and 2027. The state's new tourism policy aims to formulate a long-term roadmap for the sustainable and balanced growth of Uttarakhand's tourism sector. The role of the state government and its departments will primarily focus on policymaking, regulation, and tourism promotion. Concurrently, the private sector will play a central role in delivering services such as accommodation, tourist amenities, transportation, tour operations, activities, and events. The state government will act as a facilitator to create an enabling environment for these ventures.

Promoting Private Sector Investment

The policy highlights that private capital and industry expertise are vital for driving Uttarakhand's future tourism growth. To advance this objective, the government will promote Public-Private Partnerships (PPP). For efficient implementation, the state government will:

Reduce its direct involvement in sectors where private enterprise is encouraged, such as the development and management of tourist accommodations.

Focus on enhancing Ease of Doing Business for tourism investors.

Strengthen the Single Window Clearance System to ensure swift statutory approvals and project clearances.

Unlocking New Pathways for Tourism Development

The policy supports and incentivizes both greenfield and existing tourism ventures:

Capital Subsidy Eligibility: Newly established projects/enterprises in progress up to the subsidy application date qualify for capital subsidies. Existing units undertaking significant expansion or diversification are also eligible.

Turnover-Based Incentives: Operational tourism units and enterprises active by the application submission date are eligible for turnover-linked incentives.

The policy aims to stimulate private investment while generating employment, boosting local entrepreneurship, and strengthening the state's economy.

Priority Focus Segments During the Policy Period : To bolster the tourism landscape, the state government will focus on specific priority niches:

- Promotion of eco-destinations alongside trekking, white-water rafting, and allied adventure pursuits.

Encouragement of facilities dedicated to Yoga, Ayurveda, Naturopathy, and holistic healthcare. Preserving and highlighting sacred religious circuits, local folk culture, and traditions. Integrating historical landmarks, monuments, and traditional vernacular architecture into the tourism circuit. MICE Tourism: Development of infrastructure for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions.

Key Fiscal Incentives and Reliefs Under the Policy : Eligible tourism units will receive structured financial subsidies and concessions, including:

Capital subsidy for the hospitality sector: For hotel and accommodation-related projects. Incentives for marketing and promotion of investment in eligible tourism projects. Assistance for training and skill development. Interest subsidy/relief. Incentives for waste management and disposal. Incentives for increasing bookings through the State's online travel agency platform. Capital subsidy for investment in tourism products and services. Subsidies for projects and units that are not eligible for capital subsidy. Special incentives for premium and high-end hospitality projects. Incentives to attract foreign tourists. Incentives for organizing MICE events, art, social and cultural events, fairs, & festivals. Incentives to promote helicopter-based transportation. Exemption from electricity duty. Exemption from stamp duty.

Spiritual & Natural Gems Along the Journey

Near Yamunotri
Janki Chatti, Hanuman Chatti, Kharsali Village, Saptarishi Kund, Pandava Cave, Lakhamandal, Gangnani Kedarkantha Trek, Rana Chatti

Near Gangotri
Gaumukh Trek, Bhojbasa, Tapovan, Surya Kund & Gauri Kund, Harsil Valley, Mukhimath (Mukhba), Gangnani Dayara Bugyal Trek, Gartang Gali, Kashi Vishwanath Temple, Nachiketa Tal, Dodital

Near Kedarnath
Bhairavnath Temple, Vasuki Tal, Gaurikund, Triyuginarayan Temple, Chopta–Tungnath–Chandrashila, Guptkashi, Deoria Tal

Near Badrinath
Mana Village, Vyas Cave & Ganesh Cave, Bhim Shila, Auli, Valley of Flowers, Vasudhara Falls, Charan Paduka, Tapt Kund, Narad Kund, Jyotirmath (Joshimath), Satopanth Lake, Pandukeshwar, Adi Badri Temple, Hemkund Sahib

Seamless Journeys Through Devbhoomi

Uttarakhand is leveraging technology and infrastructure to provide visitors with a safe, comfortable and enriching travel experience.

The state is shaping a modern and culturally sensitive tourism model. Guided by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and inspired by the leadership of Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, Uttarakhand is combining technology, infrastructure development and heritage conservation to create safer and more enriching experiences for travellers.

For the Char Dham Yatra, an Aadhaar-based cloud registration system has been introduced to enhance pilgrim safety, enable hassle-free entry at checkpoints and ensure transparent data management. This innovation is modernising the pilgrimage experience while prioritising safety and accountability.

At Kainchi Dham, associated with the memory of Neem Karoli Baba, the government has invested ₹17 crore. The initiative aims to improve road connectivity, parking facilities, pilgrim amenities and environmentally sensitive infrastructure, while preserving the sanctity of this revered destination.

A ₹100-crore project is being implemented in the Jaunsar-Bawar region to restore Mahasu Devta temples, preserve traditional wooden architecture and promote cultural tourism. With active participation from local communities, the initiative is also empowering rural communities through homestays, festivals and handicrafts, ensuring that the benefits of tourism reach the grassroots.

Together, these initiatives present a shared vision of a "Seamless, Safe and Spiritual" journey across Uttarakhand. By balancing modern needs with cultural preservation, the state is positioning itself as a global example of sustainable and transformative tourism.

Uttarakhand Tourism A divine blend of natural splendor and spiritual sanctity. Nestled in the lap of the Himalayas, its renowned destinations captivate travelers from around the world. Trekking, white-water rafting, and wildlife sanctuaries also make it a prime hub for adventure enthusiasts.

Manaskhand Mandir Mala Scheme: A New Lifeline for Ancient Temples

Under the Manaskhand Mandir Mala Scheme, the state government is undertaking infrastructure development around 48 ancient temples across the Kumaon region. In the first phase, 16 temples have been selected for development.

These include Jageshwar Temple, Golu Devta Temple, Katarmal Sun Temple, Kasar Devi, Nanda Devi, Patal Bhuvaneshwar Cave, Hat Kalika, Purnagiri, Naina Devi, Baleshwar, Kainchi Dham, Varahi Devi, Baijnath, Bagnath and Chaiti Balasundari Temple, along with other important religious sites across the region.

The scheme also covers several prominent temples and pilgrimage sites in Almora, Pithoragarh, Udham Singh Nagar, Champawat, Bageshwar and Nainital, including Jhankar Saim, Naithna Devi, Vindhyavasini, Mallika Devi, Syahi Devi, Mostamanu, Berinag, Malyanath, Thalkedar, Kotgiri, Atariya Temple, Nanakmatta, Moteswar Mahadev, Meetha Reetha Sahib, Guru Gorakhnath Temple, Maneshwar Temple, Kot Bhramari, Shikhar Bhanar, Girija Devi Temple, Hanuman Temple, Somwari Mahadev, Devguru Brihaspatidham and Hanuman Garhi Temple.

The initiative is expected to strengthen infrastructure, improve pilgrimage experiences and boost economic activity around the ancient temples of the Kumaon region.

Excellent Connectivity: Easier Access to Remote Areas

With new roads, ropeways and air services, Uttarakhand is making journeys through the mountains faster, safer and more comfortable than ever for pilgrims and tourists.

Rapid infrastructure development across Uttarakhand is creating new travel experiences for tourists and residents alike, generating greater interest in exploring the Himalayas. Through initiatives such as the Parvatmala Scheme and the All-Weather Road Project, the state is ensuring that faith and ease of travel progress together.

The Delhi–Dehradun Expressway enables travellers to reach the gateway to Uttarakhand from the national capital in just about two and a half hours. This important corridor connects with the All-Weather Char Dham Road, making access to Badrinath, Kedarnath, Gangotri and Yamunotri easier, even during challenging weather conditions.

Ropeway projects are transforming travel in the mountains. The 11.5-km Sonprayag–Kedarnath Ropeway is set to become one of the world's highest ropeways and will be capable of transporting thousands of pilgrims to the temple every hour. Similarly, the Govindghat–Hemkund Sahib Ropeway will reduce a difficult 12-hour trek to just 45 minutes, while the Dehradun–Mussoorie Ropeway will transform a 33-km mountain journey into a scenic 15-minute ride.

Air connectivity is also expanding rapidly. Under the Mukhyamantri Udan Khatola Yojana, helicopter services are

Mukhyamantri Udan Khatola Yojana, helicopter services are connecting remote districts, while Jolly Grant and Pantnagar airports are being upgraded to international standards.

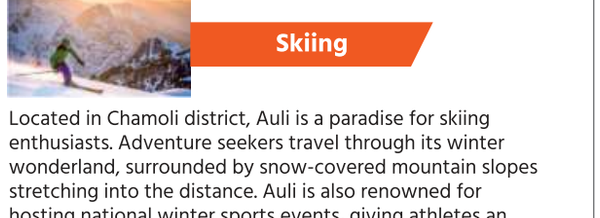
To further strengthen spiritual connectivity, the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Council, in collaboration with IRCTC, has launched the Manaskhand Express under the Bharat Gaurav initiative. This special tourist train connects pilgrims from cities such as Pune, Madurai and Mumbai with prominent and lesser-known religious destinations in Uttarakhand, including Jageshwar, Purnagiri, Badrinath, Kedarnath and Kartik Swami Temple.

The initiative is not only improving access to remote areas but also providing a boost to local tourism, homestay businesses and employment opportunities.

This integrated network of roads, ropeways and air services reflects Uttarakhand's commitment to inclusive development. It is making travel easier while strengthening the state's economy, promoting tourism and bringing the vision of a seamless, safe and welcoming journey closer to reality.

#ExploreUttarakhand
@OIPR_UK

Accelerating Sustainable Development



Unexplored Adventures, Unforgettable Experiences

Uttarakhand – A Global Adventure Destination

When it comes to adventure tourism in India, Uttarakhand stands out as a favourite destination for adventure enthusiasts, thanks to its diverse landscapes and breathtaking natural surroundings. The state offers an abundance of thrilling activities that are sure to fill you with excitement and adrenaline. This is what makes Uttarakhand an exceptional destination for adventure lovers from across the world. Many tourists visit Uttarakhand specifically to experience these exciting activities. For adventure enthusiasts, the state offers a wide range of thrilling sports and experiences, including river rafting, trekking, hiking, bungee jumping, and much more.

Trekking & Hiking

Trekking and hiking offer the perfect way to explore the remote and scenic landscapes of Uttarakhand. The traditional Roopkund Trek takes you through lush green forests and meadows, while the Valley of Flowers offers a breathtaking experience amidst vibrant alpine blooms. For adventure seekers, the Kedarkantha and Gaumukh–Tapovan treks promise unforgettable experiences that stay with you for a lifetime.

Bungee Jumping

Known as the Yoga Capital of the World, Rishikesh is also famous for its thrilling adventure experiences, including one of India's highest bungee jumping sites. Adventure enthusiasts come here to challenge gravity while taking in the spectacular Himalayan surroundings.

Skiing

Located in Chamoli district, Auli is a paradise for skiing enthusiasts. Adventure seekers travel through its winter wonderland, surrounded by snow-covered mountain slopes stretching into the distance. Auli is also renowned for hosting national winter sports events, giving athletes an opportunity to showcase their skills.

River Rafting

The rivers of Uttarakhand not only enhance the state's natural beauty but also offer exhilarating experiences for water-sports enthusiasts. From conquering rapids through white-water rafting to enjoying peaceful canoeing and kayaking experiences, the Ganga, Tons and Alaknanda rivers offer adventure seekers an unforgettable experience on the water.

We come to Dev Bhoomi Uttarakhand from our native places with one or more resolutions in our hearts. In the same spirit, I would like to urge you to take these five pledges
- Narendra Modi

First Pledge – Cleanliness First

Second Pledge – Respect for Nature and the Environment

Third Pledge – Emphasis on Service, Cooperation and Unity

Fourth Pledge – Promote Vocal for Local

Fifth Pledge – Follow Discipline, Safety and Dignity

Welcome to Devbhoomi Uttarakhand

Centre leaves it to EC to decide on holding bypolls to 5 Assembly constituencies in T.N.

Additional Solicitor General tells High Court that he has been asked by Union Ministry of Law and Justice to leave the matter to be argued by the EC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Centre on Tuesday informed the Madras High Court that it had decided to leave it to the Election Commission of India (EC) to take a call on the conduct of byelections to five vacant constituencies – Tiruchi East, Perundurai, Ambasamudram, Viralimalai, and Karur – in Tamil Nadu.

Appearing before the first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, Additional Solicitor General AR.L. Sundaresan said he had received a two-page note from the Union Ministry of Law and Justice asking him to leave the case to be argued by the EC.

Advocate General Vijay Narayan, representing the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly Secretary, said he cannot take sides and therefore, he also had nothing to argue on the public interest litigation petition filed by K. Venkatachalapathy of Tirunelveli for not conducting the bypolls until the disposal of related election petitions.

Senior counsel G. Masilamani, representing Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who had won from two constituencies but resigned as the MLA from Tiruchi East and retained Perambur, argued that the EC must revise its decision not to conduct the bypolls to the five constituencies until the disposal of the election petitions.

Senior counsel G. Masilamani, representing Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, argued that the EC must revise its decision not to conduct bypolls until the disposal of the election petitions.

He contended that the question of the election petitioners or another candidate getting declared as the returned candidate, if an election petition is allowed, would arise only if just two candidates had contested an election, and not if there had been a multi-cornered contest.

The senior counsel said there was a multi-cornered contest in all the 234 Assembly constituencies in Tamil Nadu during the general elections held this year, and hence, there was no possibility of any constituency having two representatives if a byelection was conducted before the disposal of an election petition.

He also questioned the locus standi of the petitioner to file the present case, and pointed out that none of the election petitioners had approached the court to stall the byelections.

Senior counsel Satish Parasaran and Gopal Sankaranarayanan made their submissions on behalf of Esakki Subaya and M.R. Vijayabhaskar, both MLAs who had resigned.

Thereafter, the judges adjourned the matter to Wednesday to hear the arguments of senior counsel Dama Seshadri Naidu, assisted by Niranjan Rajagopalan, for the EC.

Veeramani booked for abetting suicide of minor in 2004

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Police have booked Gem Granites owner R. Veeramani on charges of abetting the suicide of a minor in 2004, police sources said on Wednesday.

Investigators also invoked provisions under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act against the octogenarian businessmen, his associate Shanti and others, the sources said.

The death of the minor girl came to light recently when the police accessed a message sent by Shanti to Veeramani asking if he remembered his involvement in the death of a girl.

R. Veeramani

> There is information that the accused gave ₹1 lakh to the family or their close relatives on two occasions. We are verifying this claim
> **A POLICE OFFICER**

Victim identified

A special team formed to investigate the veracity of the message conducted inquiries and identified the victim. Her mother lodged a complaint alleging her daughter was sexually abused by Veeramani and died by suicide. She claimed that though the family lodged a complaint with the local police at that time no action was taken.

"There is an information that the accused gave ₹1 lakh to the family or their close relatives on two occasions. We are verifying this claim," a police officer said. The Special Investigation Team (SIT) comprising senior women police officers was expediting investigation and charge sheets were expected to be filed next month in the designated court. City Police Commissioner A. Amalraj reviewed the progress made in the case with SIT officers on Wednesday evening. Police were probing the financial transactions of the accused and others suspected to be involved in the case to check if there was any proceeds of crime angle in the offences.

In one of the cases, a bank balance of more than ₹20 crore was found in the account of a suspect and steps were taken to freeze it, the officer said without going into details.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-2464 0050)

Chief Minister announces ₹75 lakh for Vithya Ramraj

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday announced a cash prize of ₹75 lakh for athlete Vithya Ramraj for winning a gold medal in the 4x400-metre relay at the Asian Games in Japan.

In a social media post, he said it was her third medal at the Asian Games and a matter of pride for India and Tamil Nadu. On Monday, he announced a cash prize of ₹30 lakh for her bronze medal in the 400-metre hurdles.

28-year-old man hacked to death by unidentified persons in Triplicane

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 28-year-old man was hacked to death by two unidentified persons on Monday night, after he was asked by two women to step out of his house in Triplicane for a chat.

The victim has been identified as Ajith, a resident of Venkatarangam Pillai Street. He was employed as a technician with a private mobile operator.

On Monday night, he was speaking with his father Natarajan and mother Sarasammal inside their house, when two women appeared at the door and asked him to step out of the house for a chat.

Ajith

When Ajith went outside with them, two unidentified men pulled him away and attacked him with knives.

Ajith suffered injuries to his head and face. His parents rushed to his rescue. The assailants threatened them with knives, and Sarasammal suffered an injury to her hand while attempting to help her son.

The four suspects escaped on two-wheelers. The Ice House police recovered Ajith's body and sent it for a post-mortem. Sarasammal was admitted to the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital for treatment.

The police registered a case of murder. Investigators are examining whether the attack was linked to a previous dispute.

Drive against habitual offenders carried out in Avadi Commissionerate

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A three-day special drive against history-sheeted offenders and persons involved in activities disturbing public peace was held in the Avadi Police Commissionerate from September 26 to 28.

The drive, carried out on the directions of Avadi Police Commissioner T. Senthilkumar, covered the Avadi and Red Hills police districts as part of preventive measures to curb crime. In the Avadi police district, personnel checked 508 people and registered 29 cases. A total of 38 persons, including history-sheeted offenders, were arrested. Of them, 20 were remanded in judicial custody, while 18 were released on station bail.

In the Red Hills police district, 221 people were checked and 48 cases were registered. As many as 29 persons were remanded in judicial custody and 19 released on station bail. The police also obtained good-behaviour bonds from 58 persons.

भारत सरकार/GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
अंतरिक्ष विभाग/DEPARTMENT OF SPACE

रिक्ति परिपत्र / VACANCY CIRCULAR

उत्तर पूर्वी अंतरिक्ष उपयोग केंद्र (उ.पू.-सैक), उमियम - 793103, मेघालय (भारत सरकार, अंतरिक्ष विभाग के तहत एक स्वायत्त निकाय) में निदेशक के पद के लिए भर्ती।

RECRUITMENT FOR THE POST OF DIRECTOR, NORTH EASTERN SPACE APPLICATIONS CENTRE (NE-SAC), UMIAM – 793103, MEGHALAYA (AN AUTONOMOUS BODY UNDER DEPARTMENT OF SPACE, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA)

दिनांक 30.09.2026 का विज्ञापन सं. डी.एस._8सी.-12012/1/2026-अनु. VIII

Advertisement No. DS_8C-12012/1/2026-Sec.VIII dated 30/09/2026.

उत्तर पूर्वी अंतरिक्ष उपयोग केंद्र (उ.पू.-सैक) में स्तर-14 में निदेशक का एक पद तत्काल आमेलन के आधार पर भरा जाना है।

One post of Director in the North Eastern Space Applications Centre (NE-SAC), in Level-14 is to be filled on immediate absorption basis.

अर्हता, अनुभव, आयु, आवेदन पत्र आदि, जैसे अन्य विवरणों के लिए "करियर" लिंक के तहत इसरो की वेबसाइट www.isro.gov.in पर लॉग-ऑन करें।

For other details like Qualification, Experience, Age, Application form etc., log on to ISRO website www.isro.gov.in under the link "Careers"

आवेदन प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि 31.10.2026 है।

The last date for receipt of application is 31.10.2026.

सुधार/परिशिष्ट, यदि कोई, केवल उपर्युक्त वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।

Corrigendum/Addendum, if any will be published in the above website only.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Our Client proposes to purchase the Properties being (1) Land measuring a total extent of 2.16 Acres or thereabouts comprised in (i) Old S.No.17/5 (Part) and R.S.No.75/2 (Part) and as per Patta Punjai S.No.75/2A (measuring 0.60 Acre), (ii) Old S.No.17/4 (Part) and R.S.No.76/2 (Part) and as per Patta Punjai S. No. 76/2B (measuring 0.56 Acre) and (iii) Ayan Punjai S.No.17/5 and as per Patta S.Nos.76/1A and 76/1B (measuring 1.00 Acre) together with the Residential Buildings therein situated in part of Door No. 7/7, Navarkulam Main Road, Pattanur Village, Vanur Taluk, Villupuram District, from Mr K. Kaarthikeyan, S/o. R. Kirubhakaran, residing at the aforesaid address, and (2) Land measuring a total extent of 1.00 Acre or thereabouts comprised in (i) Old S.No.17/5, R.S.No.75/2 (Part) and as per Patta Punjai S.No.75/2B (measuring 0.40 Acre) and (ii) Old S.No.17/4, R.S.No.76/2 (Part) and as per Patta Punjai S.No.76/2A (measuring 0.60 Acre) together with the Residential Buildings therein situated in the aforesaid address, from Vajragad Agro Farms Private Limited, having its Registered Office at Office No. 9 & 10, 5th Floor, Akshay Complex, ITI Road, Aundh, Pune - 411007. The aforesaid Mr K. Kaarthikeyan represents to our client that the Original Sale Deed dated 07.05.1963 executed by Mrs. Jayammal in favour of Mrs. Gengammal (who is the mother/grandmother of the Vendors of Mr K. Kaarthikeyan) conveying Land measuring One Acre in S.No.17/5 situated in Pattanur Village and registered as Document No.739 of 1963 in the Office of the Sub-Registrar, Vanur, was lost and inspite of his best efforts the same could not be traced out as on date. The aforesaid Owners represent that they are the absolute owners of their aforesaid respective properties and except the aforesaid Owners no one has any right, title, interest, demand or claim of whatsoever nature over the same, and that the aforesaid properties are free from all encumbrances, mortgages, litigations, court/tribunal/debt/revenue proceedings, awards, claims, acquisition and requisition proceedings and that the Owners are in absolute possession and sole enjoyment of their aforesaid properties as its absolute owners.

If anybody is in possession of the aforesaid original Sale Deed or having any right, title, interest, lien, charge, demand or claim of whatsoever nature, upon or to the aforesaid properties or any portion thereof, he/she is requested to hand over the aforesaid document to the undersigned or bring to the notice of the undersigned his/her/their interest or claim or demand along with supporting documentary evidence by Speed Post Acknowledgement Due or in person within 15 days from the date of this publication, failing which it will be presumed that there is no claim, right, title, interest, charge or encumbrance over the aforesaid properties by any person and our Client will proceed with the purchase of the said properties without any risk and any subsequent claim or objection shall be deemed to have been waived.

N. SRINIVASAN, B.A., LL.B.
N.S. BALACHANDHAR, M.Com, LL.B.
Advocates
Flat No.5, Raaga Apartments
Door Nos.66 & 68, Venkatakrishna Road
Mandaveli, Chennai - 600 028
Cell: 98840 20722

Date : 30.09.2026
Place: Chennai

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For & on behalf of President of India, Chief Engineer (CON)/II/Garden Reach, South Eastern Railway, invites E-Tenders for the under mentioned work. Following tender has been uploaded on website **www.ireps.gov.in**. The tender will be closed at 12:00 Hrs on 19.11.2026. **e-Tender Notice No. : 4679-GRC-CE-C-II-44-2026; Pre-Bid Meeting : Date:** 09.10.2026 **Time :** 12:00 hrs **Venue:** Office of the Chief Administrative Officer (Con), 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043 **Brief Description of Works:** Construction of 3rd line work including earthwork, blanketing, minor bridges, important bridges and other miscellaneous works for 25.0T of Indian Railway Standard Loading, execution of indoor & outdoor S&T works, execution of general electrical works, installation and commissioning of 2x25 KV overhead equipment (OHE) for traction and power supply in connection with the 3rd Line work of Madhukunda-Damodar section in Adra Division of South Eastern Railway on Engineering, Procurement & Construction (EPC) Mode. **Approx. Cost :** ₹442.17 Crore; **Bid Security:** ₹8,84,34,000.00/-; **Period of Completion:** 36 months. Interested tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. **NB:** "Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all other tenders." **(PR-821)**

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

INVITATION FOR BIDDING (IFB) E-TENDER (RFx) NOTICE

Notice for submission of online bids (RFx) for following

S.N.	RFx/Tender No. & Description
1	**RFx No. 7000041636 (Eighth Call)** Work of installation, Testing and commissioning of new 5 x 50 MV Ar, switchable 400kV Line Reactors against replacement of old 5 x 50 MV Ar, line reactor at 400 kV Girwali Substation under EHV PC O&M Zone Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar. **Estimated Cost:** Rs. 16,15,30,896.35/- Only (Including GST & Labour cess). **EMD:** Rs. 16,15,308/- **Tender Fees:** Rs. 25000/- (Including GST) **Contact No:** Executive Engineer (8554995266) **Submission Date:** 09.10.2026.

For further details, visit our Website
https://srmetender.mahatransco.in

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, EHV PC & O&M Zone
MSETCL, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
(CIN:U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Engineering Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
E-mail ID: dgm.ia@jbvnl.co.in

Time Extension Notice (EOI Notice No.: - 244/PR/JBVNL/2026-27)

Due to unavoidable circumstances date of EOI Notice No.: - 244/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 dated 09.09.2026 has been extended as below:-

Sl. No.	Particulars	Revised Date & Time
I.	Date of Publication of EOI	09.09.2026
II.	Date of Downloading	12.09.2026 from 10:00 AM
III.	Last Date/Time of Receipt of EOI	23.10.2026 up to 5:00 PM
IV.	Date & Time for Opening of Technical Bid	24.10.26 at 3:00PM
V.	Opening Financial Bid	To be intimated after technical evaluation.

All prospective bidders are requested to take note of the above revision. The extension shall from an integral part of the EOI document.(For detailed information, please contact the office @ 9386451778 or visit the website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in)

PR No. 389285

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेन्टर) पर दर्ज करायें

Sd/-
General Manager (IA)
JBVNL

PR 390735 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd (26-27) D"

SUPPLY WORKS

E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work:

E-Tender No.:TS265621, **Dated**: 25-09-2026; **PL Code (Group):** 5717018200121; **Description:** Parcel Scanners and onsite supply, installation, testing and commissioning at 03 stations over Tinsukia Division N.F. Railway, namely Mariani, New Tinsukia and Dibrugarh stations along with 05 (five) years comprehensive warranty and maintenance. Make-KritiScanTM-Model '150180D' or Superior (Technical Specifications is attached). [Warranty Period: 60 Months after the date of delivery]. **Total Qty**.: 3 Nos;

PL Code (Group): 5717018200122; **Description:** Parcel Scanners and onsite supply, installation, testing and commissioning at 03 stations over Katihar Division N.F. Railway, namely Katihar, New Jalpaiguri and Siliguri stations along with 05 (five) years comprehensive warranty and maintenance. Make-KritiScanTM-Model '150180D' or Superior (Technical Specifications is attached). [Warranty Period: 60 Months after the date of delivery]. **Total Qty**.: 3 Nos;

PL Code (Group): 5717018200123; **Description:** Parcel Scanners and onsite supply, installation, testing and commissioning at 01 station over Alipurduar Division N.F. Railway, namely Dhupguri station along with 05 (five) years comprehensive warranty and maintenance. Make-KritiScanTM-Model '150180D' or Superior (Technical Specifications is attached). [Warranty Period: 60 Months after the date of delivery]. **Total Qty**.: 1 Nos;

Earnest Money: ₹14,39,380/-; Date and time of **closing** of E-tender at **14:30** hrs. on **23-10-2026**.

For details please visit IREPS website **https://www.ireps.gov.in**.

Dy. CMM/DBRG
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Serving Customers With A Smile

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU | the hindu businessline | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | The Hindu Young World | THE HINDU

Municipal Corporation, Bharatpur
Near Mathura Gate Bharatpur – 321001
Telephone: +91-05644-222170 email: -bhartpur.jaipur@gmail.com, bsfozdar@gmail.com

No.:-BMC/Technical/Drainage/2026-26/13858 Dated:- 25.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING NIB
NIB No.:19/2026-26

Online Bids are invited from 29.09.2026to 21.10.2026 time 6.00 PM and Pre-Bid Meeting 09.09.2026 time 11.00 AM Technical Bid Opening date 22.10.2026 time 3.00 PM Rejuvenation and lining of RNFCD (Ranjeet Nagar Flood Control Drain) from Kumher road to Jagheena Gate, Bharatpur(Risk & Cost). Estimated cost of Rs 1006.34 lacs.The Last date of for applying bid and making Payment RTGS/NEFT favour Commissioner Nagar Nigam Bharatpur up-to 6.00 PM of 22.10.2026. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office and the State Public Procurement Portal website **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in**, and **www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** **(UBN No.) DLB2627WLOB20503**

To participate in the bid, bidder has to be:

1. Tender Cost and Processing Fees deposited through RTGS/ NEFT in the account of Commissioner Municipal Corporation Bharatpur having account number 685601701018 with ICICI Bank, Mathura Gate KanniGurjarChauraha payable at Bharatpur, Rajasthan (IFSC CodeICIC0006856)
2. Registered on e-Procurement Portal of Government of Rajasthan www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in for online e-Bid submission.

Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Bharatpur

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10948

WESTERN RAILWAY
MATERIAL MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT
VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/57/2026 Date 25.09.2026

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Short Description	Quantity	T.O.D.
450	18255009	M.S. Plate 10 mm thick of size 2500 x 10000 mm	140 MT	23-Nov-26
451	18255008	M.S. Plate 16 mm thick of size 2500 x 10000 mm	285 MT	16-Nov-26
452	29265007A	2 D - Electrophysiological Study Part of DSA Cath Lab	2 Nos	6-Nov-26
453	22265072	Set of axle box assembly complete	50 Set	2-Nov-26
454	26265641	Running Contract of One year for supply of Rail Screw Galvanized conforming to RDSO Drg. No. T-4153	99500 Nos	30-Oct-26
455	28262424A	Human Albumin 20 percent Inj - 100 ml	2830 Nos	30-Oct-26
456	11255035D	Oil Fired interconnected Boiler of capacity 4000 Kg/Hr and 2000 Kg/Hr confirming to IBR norms	1 Nos	30-Oct-26
457	28261308A	Inj. Meropenem 1 gm	24875 Nos	30-Oct-26
458	18255006	M.S. Plate 20 mm thick of size 2500 x 13500 mm	265 MT	29-Oct-26
459	15261943	Secondary spring outer for LHB NAC coach	142 Nos	28-Oct-26
460	22263018	Eight Wire Rod Reinforced Leather Bellow for Traction Motor	865 Nos	26-Oct-26
461	22265066	Tri plate panel mounted brake system	60 Set	26-Oct-26
462	15262500	Spherolastic rubber bearing	357 Nos	26-Oct-26
463	03263304A	Aluminium chequered sheet for flooring with five ridges pattern of size - 3200 mm X 775 mm X 2.00 mm MIN	28599 KG	26-Oct-26
464	22265062	Single Phase to Three Phase	70 Nos	26-Oct-26
465	9265010	HMI with 7" Touch Screen Panel	340 Nos	23-Oct-26
466	29255017	Advance Surgical Operating Microscope for Neurosurgery	2 Nos	23-Oct-26
467	18255003	M.S. Plate 32 mm thick of size 2500 x 12500 mm	370 MT	22-Oct-26
468	10263003	3 Phase Measuring and Monitoring Relay Rated Voltage	1389 Nos	22-Oct-26
469	10263041	Contactor for Net 1 & 2 Rated Voltage: 1000 V A. C	355 Nos	22-Oct-26
470	22265067	Suspension tube and its assembly components	480 Set	22-Oct-26
471	06261711A	Sealed Horizontal Scroll Compressors	60 Nos	19-Oct-26

CORRIGENDUM

Please read the quantity as "2300000 Nos" and due date as "30.10.2026" for the Tender Notice No. S/54/2026 dated: 09.09.2026 at Sr. No. 432

Please read the due date as "21.10.2026" for the Tender Notice No. S/51/2026 dated: 02.09.2026 at Sr. No. 414

Please read the quantity as "270 Nos" and due date as "08.10.2026" for the Tender Notice No. S/46/2026 dated: 13.08.2026 at Sr. No. 380

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.ireps.gov.in and wr.indianrailways.gov.in 0644

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Agriculture Research Station
(Sri Karan Narendra Agriculture University, Jobner)
Navgaon-301025, Alwar (Raj.) Email: zdr.navgaon@sknau.ac.in

No. :- F. ( )/ARSN/Store/E-Bid/2026-27/224 Date :- 26/09/2026

NOTICE INVITING BID

Bids are invited up to 05.00 P.M. of 21.10.2026 for Supply & Erection of Protected Structures at Agriculture Research Station, Navgaon (Alwar). The details are available in the Bidding Documents which can be availed from the office of the Zonal Director Research, Navgaon (Alwar) 301025 or can be accessed or downloaded from State Procurement Portal website **"sppp.raj.nic.in"** or **"https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in"** or university website **"www.sknau.ac.in".** The technical bids will be opened at 11:00 AM on dated 22.10.2026 by Tender & Purchase Committee of the station.

UBN No. : SKN2627GLOB00240, NIB Code: SKN2627A0213

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10897 **Zonal Director Research**

பாங்க் ஆஃப் பரோடா / बैंक ऑफ़ बड़ौदा / Bank of Baroda

RAJAJI ROAD BRANCH
J C House, New No.70, (Old No.28),
Rajaji Salai, Chennai - 600 001
Ph: 044 23454 243/244/245/246/247/248

NOTICE TO BORROWERS / GUARANTOR
(UNDER SUB-SECTION (2) OF SECTION 13 OF THE SARFAESI ACT 2002)

To

Borrower: M/s Anand Enterprises, Represented by its Prop: L. Vivek S/o.Lakshmikandan, Office address at No. 34/39, Venkatesa Nagar, Virugambakkam, Chennai-600092 **Shri L. Vivek,** S/o Lakshmikandan, R/o.Flat No-5K, 5th Floor, Princeton Block, Marutham Neptune, 51 NT Patel Road, Nerkunram, Tiruvallur, Chennai-6000107

Dear Sir / Madam,

Re: Credit facilities with our Rajaji Road Branch.

1. We refer to our letter no. BOB/ADV/2025-26/ANANDEN01 DATED 30.06.2025 conveying sanction of cash credit facilities and the terms of sanction. Pursuant to the above sanction you have availed and started utilizing the credit facilities after providing security for the same, as hereinafter stated. The present outstanding in Cash Credit facility accounts and the security interests created for such liability are as under:

Nature & Type of Facility	Limit (Amount in Rs.)	Rate of Interest	O/s as on 22.09.2026 (in Rs.) (inclusive of interest upto 22.09.2026)
Cash Credit Facility 05290500000153	₹ 8,00,00,000/-	10.15%	₹ 8,23,65,314/-

Security agreement with brief description of securities

Item-1 (Residential Flat): Schedule – A: All that piece and parcel of the **landed property bearing Door No. 51, N.T. Patel Road, Nerundram, Chennai-600107,** comprised in Survey No. 268/1 part (Plot No-A part), 281/15 Part, 268/2A1A1, 263/43 Part, 267/18 Part, 269/10 all put together a total extent of 6412.09 Sq.mrs (69020 Sq.ft) equal to 154.40 cents of **Nerkumdram Village, Madhuravoyal Taluk, Chennai Dist, within Greater Chennai Corporation Limit** and being: Land bounded on the: North By: N.T.Patel Road & 30 Feet Road gifted to CMDA & 268/1 part (sub divided as plot No. B) & 270 part & OSR land & Muneeswaran Street, South By: Land in Sy.No 263 Part & 267 part & VOC Street & OSR Land & 281 Part & 268 Part East By: 30 Feet Road gifted to CMDA & 268 / 1part (Sub-Divided as Plot No-B) & 269 Part & OSR Land & 263 Part & Thiruvallur Street, West by: Annai Therasa Street & Land in Sy. No: 266 Part & 267 Part & 268 Part & 281 Part Lying within the Registration District of Chennai South an Sub Registration District of Virugambakkam.

Schedule – B: Land an extent of 642 Sq ft of undivided share of land out of the land more fully described in the Schedule-A herein above.

Annexue – C: Apartment Residential **Flat bearing No."5K", having carpet Area of an 1057 Sq.ft with super Built up area of an 1467 Sq.ft (which includes common area) in the "Fifth Floor", of "PRINCETON BLOCK" in the residential complex known as "MARUTHAM NEPTUNE" together with "One Reserved Covered Car Park" (earmarked as One Reserved Covered Car Park as "5K").**

Item-2 : Vacant Land All that piece and parcel of vacant house sites, **bearing Plot No.181 measuring an extant of 3600 Sq.ft in the layout named as " VELANKANNI NAGAR"** (Approved layout No.D.D.T.P.254/1973) comprised in Old Survey Nos 525/1 & 525/2, New Patta No.21200 as per Patta Sub Division Survey No. 525/41, **situated in Vardharajapuram Village, Kundrathur Taluk, Kancheepuram District** Registration District of South Chennai and Sub-Registration District of Padappai. Bounded by: North By: Plot No 180, South By: Plot No.182, East By: Road, West By: Plot No.173.

2. As you are aware, you have committed defaults in serving the interest and other amount due in the aforesaid cash credit facility. Further, the credits in Cash Credit Account during the previous 90 days has been insufficient to cover the interest and charges debited during the said period, as a result of which the account has reminded "out of order" in terms of applicable reserve Bank of India guidelines on Income recognition and Asset Classification (IRAC).

3. Consequent upon the aforesaid defaults by you and the account having remained "out of order" as stated above, your cash credit account has been classified as **non-performing asset on 22.09.2026** in accordance with the Reserve Bank of India directives and guidelines. Despite our repeated requests, remainders and demands, you have failed to regularize the account by bringing in the required funds/credits and maintaining the stipulated drawing power/adequate turnover in the cash credit account, including serving the interest and other charges debited thereto.

4. Having regard to your inability to meet your liabilities in respect of the credit facilities duly secured by various securities mentioned in para 1 above, and classification of your cash credit account as a non-performing asset, we hereby give you notice under sub-section (2) of section 13 of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, and call upon you to pay in full and discharge your liabilities to the Bank aggregating to **₹8,23,65,314/-** (Rupees Eight Crores Twenty Three Lakhs Sixty Five Thousand Three Hundred and Fourteen only) as on 22.09.2026. You are also liable to pay future interest with effect from 23.09.2026 at the contractual rate on the aforesaid amount together with incidental expenses, cost, charges etc as stated in para 1 above, within 60 days from the date of this notice. We further give you notice that failing payment of the above amount with interest till the date of payment, we shall be free to exercise all or any of the rights under sub-section (4) of section 13 of the said Act, which please note.

5. Please note that, interest will continue to accrue at the rates specified in para 1 above for each credit facility until payment in full.

6. We invite your attention to sub-section 13 of the said Act in terms of which you are barred from transferring any of the secured assets referred to in para 1 above by way of sale, lease or otherwise (other than in the ordinary course of business), without obtaining our prior written consent. We may add that non-compliance with the above provision contained in section 13(13) of the said Act, is an offence punishable under section 29 of the Act.

7. We further invite your attention to sub section (8) of section 13 of the said Act in terms of which you may redeem the secured assets, if the amount of dues together with all costs, charges and expenses incurred by the Bank is tendered by you, at any time before the date of publication of notice for public auction/inviting quotations/tender /private treaty. Please note that after publication of the notice as above, your right to redeem the secured assets will not be available.

8. Please note that this demand notice is without prejudice to and shall not be construed as waiver of any other rights or remedies which we may have, including without limitation, the right to make further demands in respect of sums owing to us.

Place : Chennai **Authorised Officer**
Date : 24.09.2026 **Bank of Baroda**

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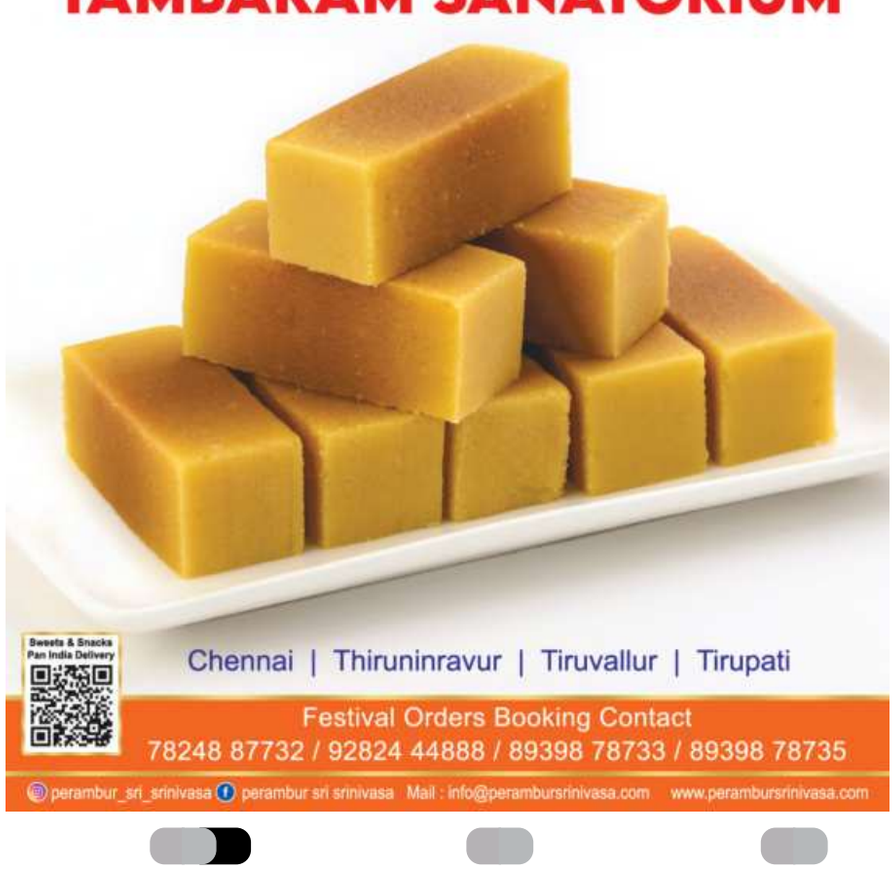
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(Established by the Act of Legislative Assembly of National Capital Territory of Delhi

RECRUITMENT NOTICE FOR NON-TEACHING POSTS

No. AUD/55-1(127)/Rect./2026/1008 **Dated: 28.09.2026**

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University Delhi, a State University established through an Act by the Legislature of the National Capital Territory of Delhi invites online applications from eligible candidates for the following Non- Teaching post on Direct Recruitment/Deputation basis:

Sr. No.	Name of Post	7th CPC Pay Level	No. of Posts	Age Limit	Type of Recruitment
1.	Internal Audit Officer	Level-12	01	Not exceeding 56 years	Deputation
2.	System Administrator (IT)	Level-10	01	Not exceeding 56 years	Deputation
3.	Section Officer#	Level-7	04 (ST-1, Re-advertise: OBC-2, EWS-1)	Not exceeding 35 years	Direct
4.	Senior Assistant#	Level-6	06 (UR-1, OBC-2, EWS-1, Re-advertise: ST-1, EWS-1)	Not exceeding 35 years	Direct
5.	Staff Nurse	Level-6	02 (UR-2)	Not exceeding 30 years	Direct
6.	Sports Coach (Female-1)	Level-5	01 (Re-advertise: UR-1)	Not exceeding 35 years	Direct
7.	Junior Library Assistant	Level-3	01 (UR-1)	Not exceeding 27 years	Direct
8.	Junior Assistant/ Junior Assistant cum Caretaker*	Level-2	40 (UR-15, OBC-11, SC-6, ST-3, EWS-5)	Not exceeding 27 years	Direct

01 Post of Section Officer out of 04 posts and 01 Post of Senior Assistant out of the 06 Posts, is reserved for Person with Benchmark Disabilities (PwBD) on horizontal reservation basis. The functional requirements and suitable category of Benchmark Disability shall be regulated as per the Gazette of Indian Notification dated 07.01.2021 notified by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, along with the other instructions issued From time to time by the Govt. of India (DoPT OM dated 15.01.2018)/ GNCT of Delhi.

* 03 Posts of Junior Assistant/ Junior Assistant cum Caretaker out of the 40 posts are reserved for Person with Benchmark Disability (PwBD) (01 post for OH, 01 post for VH and 01 Post for HH).

Note:

1. For Qualifications, Eligibility Criteria, General Instructions, Online Application Form, Payment of Fee & other details,Please visit University website **https://aud.delhi.gov.in**
2. The online applications will commence after publication of this advertisement in "Employment News".
3. The Last date to apply online is three (03) weeks from the date of publication of this advertisement in "Employment News".

REGISTRAR

https://aud.delhi.gov.in
Lothian Road, Kashmere Gate, Delhi -110006, Email: careersnts@aud.ac.in

Directorate of Higher Education, Govt. of NCT of Delhi DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0232/26-27

From Page One

Charge sheet against two accused in Kavin murder case quashed

Besides, Krishnakumari had contacted Kavin's mother over phone, informed her about the relationship and warned her. On July 27, 2025, Surjith had informed his father about Kavin's murder and the latter also informed his wife Krishnakumari. The police's final report said they met Surjith near a college and instructed him to destroy his clothes and mobile phone, and remove the number plate of the two-wheeler. Saravanan had also furnished false information to the police.

However, Justice R. Vijayakumar said there was no eyewitness to the meeting. There was no CCTV camera footage, photograph, video recording, or statement of any independent witness. There was no recording, transcript, message, or any other electronic material disclosing what transpired between them, the judge added.

Relying on a Supreme Court verdict, the judge said mobile tower information corresponds only to the operational range of the tower and not to the exact location of the mobile phone. It would, therefore, be unsafe to rely solely upon such material to prove the presence of an accused at a particular place.

"It is the prosecution's own case, as recorded in the final report, that Saravanan proceeded to the scene of occurrence within 16 minutes of receiving information from Surjith and spoke to the police there. It is also the prosecution's case that he informed a head constable that the murder had been committed by his son. Where the prosecution's own material shows that the person accused of screening had, within minutes, gone to the police and named the offender as his own son, the very intention which forms the essential ingredient of the offences stands negatived by the prosecution's own narrative. The two versions cannot coexist," the judge held.

In a statement, VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan on Tuesday urged the State government to appeal against the quashing of the charge sheet and said the court's move had set a "wrong precedent".

Teachers oppose govt. plan to build memorial

Consequent to this announcement, the portion of the university grounds was identified for constructing the memorial. Incidentally, Chennai already hosts expansive memorials to Ambedkar on Greenways Road, Periyar at Vepery, and Kamaraj on Sardar Patel Road.

Sources at the university informed *The Hindu* that a plot of land on the northeastern edge of the ground, which housed a tennis court till about three decades ago and was used for other sports activities subsequently, was the proposed spot.

"Our apprehension is that once the complex is constructed, the pathway for access to the memorial will have to be laid through the ground, thereby encroaching upon the space used by athletes and sportspersons," a Physical Education Director of an affiliated college said. A section of Physical Education Directors met on Tuesday to discuss the issue and voiced their disapproval of the government's proposal. They felt the memorial could be established elsewhere on government land in Chennai, instead of taking up the space belonging to the university.

The teaching staff at the university said the focus should be on developing facilities at the grounds rather than constructing memorials. Besides, they cautioned that the university should not take any decision on handing over the plot to the government without a wider discussion, not only within the Syndicate and Senate of the university, but also with other stakeholders.

Court reserves orders on bail pleas of co-accused in POCSO Act case against Veeramani

Prosecution alleges that Shanthi and her husband Mahendra Simhan had aided the Gem Granites proprietor in committing the sexual offences, and that bank transactions indicated financial links

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Special Court for Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act cases on Tuesday reserved its orders on the bail petitions filed by Shanthi and her husband Mahendra Simhan, co-accused in the case filed against Gem Granites proprietor R. Veeramani, who was arrested on charges of sexually assaulting minor girls.

On August 29, the Immoral Trafficking Prevention Unit (ITPU) of the Greater Chennai Police arrested Veeramani, 84, Shanthi, 60, and Mahendra Simhan, 63, for abetting the crimes committed by Veeramani. The police said the accused had sexually assaulted several minor girls, and the victims' statements had been recorded under the relevant provisions of law.

Opposing the bail petitions, the police said in their counter that Veeramani had kept children at Shanthi's house and sexually assaulted them. Shanthi had allegedly attempted to destroy evidence, they said.

The police also alleged that she had access to bank accounts maintained by Veeramani, and was involved in financial transactions. According to the counter, ₹24.63 crore was transferred from Veeramani's bank account to that of Shanthi. Subsequently, ₹2 crore was transferred from her account to one allegedly maintained by Mahendra Simhan, it added. The prosecution alleged that the accused were involved in the offences, and that the transactions indicated financial links among them.

Deep involvement: Opposing the bail petitions, the police said in their counter that Veeramani had kept children at Shanthi's house and sexually assaulted them. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The police said Shanthi and Mahendra Simhan had aided Veeramani in committing the offences. Electronic devices and other articles seized during the investigation were being examined to determine whether other minor girls were involved, they said. "If the couple are released on bail, they may tamper with witnesses or evidence. The accused may abscond or evade the investigation," the police said in the counter, seeking the dismissal of the bail petitions.

The bail petitions came up for hearing before POCSO Special Court Judge S. Padma on Monday. Appearing for the petitioners, their counsel argued: "The petitioners were not properly arrested. An arrested person must be produced before a court within 24 hours. However, the police did not do so. The petitioners have already been taken into police custody and questioned. There is no further need to keep them in custody. Therefore, bail should be granted to both."

Appearing for the police, the counsel strongly opposed the petitions, arguing: "The police can take the accused into custody and interrogate them as many times as required for up to 40 days from the date of arrest. The investigation is currently at an initial stage. Granting bail at this stage would affect the investigation. Therefore, bail should not be granted to the petitioners, and their petitions should be dismissed."

After hearing the arguments from all sides, the judge reserved orders on the bail petitions.

Charge sheet next week

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the POCSO Act case against Veeramani is likely to file its charge sheet before the Special Court for POCSO Act cases next week, police sources said.

Ask SIT to summon CM, two Ministers in Veeramani case, DMK urges court

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The DMK has approached the Madras High Court, seeking a direction to the Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the POCSO Act case against R. Veeramani to ascertain whether Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar had any material in their possession to prove the party's alleged attempt to shield the Gem Granites founder from the child sexual abuse case.

The DMK, represented by its treasurer T.R. Baalu, filed the petition seeking a direction to the all-women SIT to act upon a representation made to it on September 27 for summoning the Chief Minister and the two Ministers for an inquiry.

In an affidavit filed on behalf of the party, Mr. Baalu said it was the duty of every individual who possessed information regarding the POCSO Act case to share it with the SIT. However, instead of doing so, the Chief Minister and the two Ministers had been making comments on public platforms, accusing the previous government, led by the DMK, of having shielded the prime accused, he said.

The deponent also claimed that failure to share any available information with the SIT would amount to the criminal offence of concealment.

He said the SIT, too, was duty-bound to summon the individuals concerned and collect all material evidence, if any, in their possession. Therefore, a representation was made to the SIT on Sunday for summoning the Chief Minister and the two Ministers, he added.

Source of information

Claiming to have marked a copy of the representation to the Director General of Police/Head of Police Force as well, Mr. Baalu said: "My representation also raised the issue as to the source of the information forming the basis of the statements made by the aforesaid persons, and whether they had access to any investigation-related material which was not legitimately to be made available to them."

He also contended that the public statements made by the Chief Minister and the two Ministers, levelling the grave charge that the DMK had shielded the prime accused in the POCSO Act case, could not be considered merely as political statements, especially when they concerned an ongoing investigation into a serious offence under the POCSO Act involving numerous child victims.

No bar on conducting byelection in Perundurai, EC tells HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The legal bar on conducting a byelection to the Perundurai Assembly constituency has ended owing to the rejection of an election petition related to the constituency on September 8, the Election Commission of India (EC) has submitted before the Madras High Court.

In its written submissions, filed in response to a public interest litigation petition pending before Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, the EC said the Perundurai bypoll could be conducted before November 24, if the Supreme Court does not grant a stay.

All clear: The bypoll could be conducted before November 24 if the Supreme Court does not grant a stay, the EC says.

It said the conduct of a bypoll would also be subject to the Chief Justice's Bench exempting Perundurai from an interim order passed by it on July 10, restraining the EC from notifying bypolls to five vacant constituencies with respect to which election petitions were pending in the High Court.

In so far as the other four constituencies – Tiruchi East, Ambasamudram, Viralimalai and Karur – were concerned, the EC said the byelections cannot be notified until the election petitions, filed along with a plea to declare either those petitioners or other candidates as the returned candidates, are decided.

Though Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who had vacated Tiruchi East and retained Perambur after winning from both the seats in the general elections, had contended that he had resigned even before the filing of an election petition by DMK candidate S. Inigo Irudayaraj, the EC said the timing of the resignation was immaterial.

It said it would not matter whether an election petition was filed before or after the resignation because either way, a constituency might end up in an anomalous situation of being represented by two individuals if someone else is declared as the returned candidate by the election tribunal (High Court) after the conduct of the bypolls.

Claiming that the deferment of the bypolls was "neither indefinite nor indiscriminate", the EC said the bar would come to an end immediately after the election tribunal disposes of a plea made along with an election petition to declare either the petitioner or some other candidate as the returned candidate.

"This has already happened for Perundurai constituency," the Commission said, and underlined that Section 86(7) of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, requires every election petition to be disposed of as expeditiously as possible with an endeavour to conclude the trial in six months.

"The Commission fully recognises the importance of every constituency being represented...The Commission would welcome any direction this court considers appropriate for the expeditious disposal of the pending election petitions," the EC's written submissions said.

DFSI calls for global alliance on diabetic foot survival and limb preservation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Diabetic Foot Society of India (DFSI), under the aegis of its national president V.B. Narayanamurthy, has written to Zulfiqarali G. Abbas, president of the Pan-African Diabetic Foot Study Group (PADFSG), proposing the formation of a global alliance on diabetic foot survival and limb preservation.

The letter, a copy of which was shared with *The Hindu*, says diabetic foot ulceration is an under-recognised cause of premature death, major amputation, recurrent illness, disability, and social exclusion. Available evidence shows that its five-year mortality is comparable to that of some cancers. And yet, global investment, policy attention, organised pathways, and post-amputation support remain substantially below the scale of the problem, it adds.

The DFSI has proposed that institutions, including itself, King's College London, International Association of Diabetic Foot Surgeons, D-Foot International, American Limb Preservation Society, Federation of International Podiatrists, and PADFSG, come together to form a Global Alliance for Diabetic Foot Survival and Limb Preservation, to create a sustained, scientific, and policy platform for prevention, limb preservation, improved survival, rehabilitation, surveillance, research, and engagement with governments and WHO.

The letter said DFSI would announce the shared intention to form the Alliance at its next national conference, slated for October 2. This, it said, would be an announcement of intent rather than a representation that the Alliance had been legally constituted.

The letter urged PADFSG to provide in-principle concurrence with the formation of the Alliance and the proposed conference announcement. It also contained a draft Joint Global Declaration for joint consultation and unveiling, and sought comments on the proposal and draft declaration from PADFSG.

The DAFSI said that, subject to PADFSG's concurrence, it proposed to convene the first founding meeting of the Alliance within 30 days of its conference.

Houses of six 'caliphate sympathisers' searched in Thanjavur district

The Hindu Bureau
THANJAVUR

Inquiries revealed that the six persons were actively involved in the activities of the movement named Hizb-ut-Tahrir

Special Intelligence Unit (SIU) personnel conducted searches at the houses of six persons, who are allegedly 'sympathisers' of a global movement to establish an Islamic State and Caliphate, in Thanjavur on Tuesday.

Inquiries revealed that the six persons were actively involved in the activities of the movement named Hizb-ut-Tahrir (HuT), whose aim, according to the police, was to establish a global Islamic State and Caliphate, including in India, by overthrowing democratically elected governments "through jihad and terrorist activities involving citizens".

As the movement's intention was a grave threat to the democratic setup and internal security, since HuT promotes radicalisation youth to join terrorist organisations such as ISIS and raise funds for terror activities, the Ministry of Home Affairs had declared HuT a terrorist organisation under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act in 2024, the police said.

The searches were conducted by a team of SIU personnel led by the Deputy Superintendent of Police, Thanjavur, Charles, after obtaining search orders from a court.

CM felicitates policeman who held onto gutkha smugglers' car for 40 km to prevent their escape

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Tuesday felicitated head constable M. Velmurugan from Coimbatore, who hit the headlines for clinging onto the roof rails of an SUV for over 40 km to prevent three gutkha smugglers from escaping.

Mr. Vijay appreciated Mr. Velmurugan, who is attached to the Kovilpalayam police station, in the presence of Director General of Police and Head of Police Force Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal.

A press release from the Coimbatore District (Rural) Police said Mr. Velmurugan displayed exceptional courage and commitment to duty by risking his life to foil a bid by the three men from Rajasthan to smuggle gutkha on Sunday, September 27. He had climbed atop the SUV and remained on the roof for over 40 km, determined to prevent the accused from escaping.

Due recognition: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay with head constable M. Velmurugan and DGP Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal.

Through coordinated police action, the SUV was intercepted near Avinashi in Tiruppur district. The police arrested the three smugglers and seized 231 kg of gutkha.

The release said the Chief Minister personally called on Mr. Velmurugan and conveyed his appreciation of his efforts, recognising his exceptional courage, presence of mind, and dedication to duty.

Mr. Aggarwal also personally appreciated and congratulated Mr. Velmurugan for his exemplary courage and commitment.

Form 7 objections in Karnataka SIR mostly against Muslim voters

In Congress's Babaleshwar seat, 1,363 applications, filed by just 10 electors, sought deletions largely against Muslim voters; similar pattern seen in BJP's Basavakalyan and Belthangady seats; bulk petitions made a day ahead of deadline, data show

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

Bulk Form-7 applications seeking removal of names, largely Muslim voters, have been filed across several Assembly constituencies in Karnataka, with more than 4,000 deletions being sought in the ongoing special intensive revision, according to Form-10 statutory report, which consolidates details of Form-7 objections.

In a few cases, the applications were found to have the details of the voters "already printed", with only the objectors' names handwritten.

In Babaleshwar alone, 1,373 Form-7 applications were received on September 22. Of these, 1,363 were filed by just 10 people, seeking deletions largely against Muslim voters outside their own polling stations. Babaleshwar is represented by Congress Minister M.B. Patil.

Between September 22 and 23, Huchappa Ganiger, an elector in Babaleshwar Assembly constituency, filed 493 Form-7 applications seeking deletions, largely against Muslim voters, across 30 polling stations. Of these, 423 were filed on September 22, a day before the deadline for claims and objections ended. On September 23, Mr. Ganiger filed another 70 applications, while several other individuals also appeared in the data as having filed multiple objections. On the same day, another elector, Govindaraj Mundur, filed 413 applications across 33 polling stations.

Paper trial: In some cases, details of the voters were 'already printed' in the applications, with only the objectors' names handwritten. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Bhalki seat

Data suggests similar pattern at Bhalki in Bidar district, represented by Minister Eshwar Khandre. At least 30 people filed objections seeking the deletion of more than 1,700 names on September 23. Several of those who filed bulk objections that day had also submitted multiple Form-7 applications the previous day. An elector named Santosh filed 120 applications on September 23, after filing 54 on September 22.

In Basavakalyan, an elector named Siddappa filed 32 of the 37 Form-7 applications received on a single day. All the objections were against Muslim voters within a single polling station (Part No. 163). At Belthangady in Dakshina Kannada, an elector named Umesh Bangera filed 21 applications, again all targeting Muslim voters in a single polling station (Part No. 47). Both Basavakalyan and Belthangady are represented by the Bharatiya Janata Party.

The reason cited against the electors in the applications is "Absent/Permanently Shifted".

Already printed

The applications in Bhalki also raise questions about how some of the objections were prepared.

In two cases, the details of the objectors were handwritten, while the names of the voters whose deletion was being sought were already filled in and printed on the forms.

For instance, multiple Form-7 applications listed "Vishnuvardhan Kote", an elector at Booth 129, as the person filing the objection. When contacted by *The Hindu*, however, the person said he was not Vishnuvardhan and identified himself as "Suresh". The EPIC (voter ID) details mentioned in the applications, when cross-checked, were linked to an elector named Vishnuvardhan.

The Hindu obtained photographs of the physical Form-7 applications. In these, only Vishnuvardhan's details were handwritten, while the details of the voters whose deletion was being sought were already printed on the forms. This was also seen in applications bearing the name "Santosh Eshwar", who had filed more than 170 Form-7 applications.

However, when *The Hindu* cross-checked the physical applications against the Form-10 data available for download on the website, Vishnuvardhan's name could not be found in the list of those shown as having filed objections, while Santosh's name was listed. Officials in Bidar said many applications had been filed offline and might not have been digitised yet.

Before September 22, Form-7 applications seeking deletion on the ground that a voter had shifted were generally few in number, usually around two or three per polling station. In these cases, mostly electors had filed applications seeking deletion of their own names on the ground that they had shifted. Bulk applications began appearing on September 22, a day before the deadline.

When contacted, officials in Bidar and Vijayapura said such objections would be scrutinised before any action is taken, to ensure that no eligible voter was deleted. They also said those who filed objections in bulk had been instructed that submitting claims without valid grounds, if proved, could invite punishment.

Civil society groups, Cong. seek FIRs over 'bulk Form 7s'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Civil society groups and the Karnataka Congress have demanded that the Election Commission lodge criminal complaints over bulk Form 7 applications submitted in constituencies across the State, allegedly targeting predominantly Muslim voters.

Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president B.K. Hariprasad on Tuesday wrote to the Karnataka Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), demanding "*suo motu* action" to rein in unscrupulous elements for the "large-scale fraudulent action of misusing Form 7 to delete *bona fide* voters".

Noor Sridhar, coordinator, SIR Virodhi Okkuta, demanded that the CEO conduct an inquiry into these Form-7s and lodge a criminal case against those behind the Form-7s found to be fraudulent.

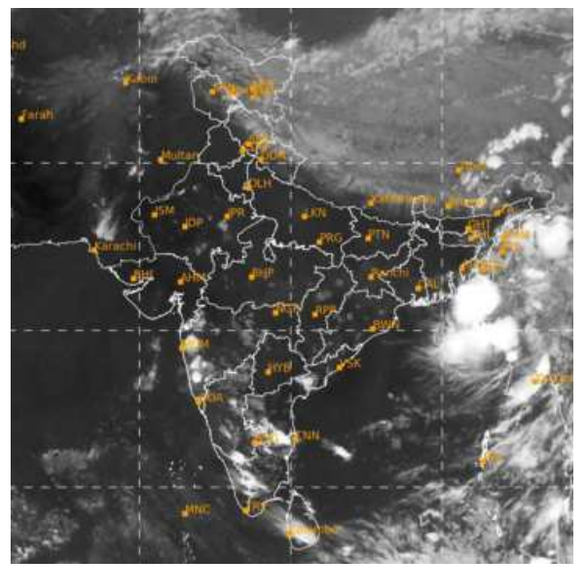
EC complaint

Only authorised election officials can file criminal complaints regarding issues with electoral rolls under the law. No private individual can file a case, nor can the State government take up *suo motu* action.

In the Aland case, unidentified individuals filed Form-7s seeking deletion of 5,994 voters. Following a complaint by Congress candidate B.R. Patil, the CEO ordered a probe and, based on the findings, the then Returning Officer (RO), Aland, filed a police complaint leading to the FIR.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh and Rayalaseema

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	35.0	27.5	Kurnool	—	36.5	26.4
Ahmedabad	—	34.8	24.9	Lucknow	—	32.2	23.8
Aizawl	—	32.5	24.0	Madurai	—	39.0	26.7
Bengaluru	23.5	30.0	20.5	Mangaluru	—	32.5	24.1
Bhopal	—	33.6	19.8	Mumbai	—	33.5	25.4
Bhubaneswar	0.1	35.2	24.8	Mysuru	—	33.0	19.2
Chandigarh	15	32.6	20.2	New Delhi	—	32.4	21.0
Chennai	—	37.2	28.4	Patna	—	32.5	26.0
Coimbatore	—	35.4	23.9	Port Blair	—	31.6	25.6
Dehradun	7.3	31.0	18.2	Prayagraj	—	34.2	24.8
Gangtok	—	26.0	16.8	Puducherry	—	34.3	28.0
Goa	—	31.8	25.2	Pune	17.1	32.2	20.2
Guwahati	—	35.1	25.9	Raipur	—	33.2	24.0
Hubballi	—	31.0	21.0	Ranchi	—	29.7	20.0
Hyderabad	—	33.4	22.6	Shillong	—	27.0	17.0
Imphal	—	30.3	22.3	Shimla	4	24.5	12.6
Jaipur	28.9	34.0	20.8	Srinagar	—	26.7	9.9
Kochi	—	31.8	26.2	Thiruvananthapuram	—	33.5	24.8
Kohima	—	24.2	19.2	Tiruchirappalli	—	37.9	26.6
Kolkata	—	33.8	27.2	Vijayawada	—	38.8	26.8
Kozhikode	—	35.2	25.8	Visakhapatnam	10.1	32.8	23.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.44	..29	42	... 157	...235	
Bengaluru	.27	..29	68	 58	90	
Chennai	...6	..10	59	... 108	...112	
Delhi	.12	..49	56	 63	...105	
Hyderabad	.10	..11	13	 73	70	
Kolkata	...7	..66	26	... 117	...118	
Lucknow	..—	9	40	... 123	82	
Mumbai	...8	..33	51	 27	68	
Pune	.13	..68	66	 63	...154	
Visakhapatnam	.10	..55	19	 67	...109	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Bikaner, Rajasthan recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 227 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 17

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

INBRIEF

Pollution board to close two prawn processing units in A.P.

The Andhra Pradesh Pollution Control Board has begun action to close two prawn processing units in SPSR Nellore district – the Water Base Limited unit at Ananthapuram village and the Abaad Overseas unit at Kudithipalem village – after its inspectors found them releasing untreated wastewater into drains and burning their solid waste. The action is part of a Statewide check on 131 aqua processing and pre-processing units after Deputy Chief Minister K. Pawan Kalyan ordered the board to enforce the rules strictly.

Madrasa teacher sentenced to life for sexually assaulting boy

A 30-year-old teacher at a madrasa was sentenced to life imprisonment by a special court in Rangareddy district, Telangana, on Tuesday for sexual assault of a 13-year-old boy. The Fast Track Special Judge for Trial and Disposal of Rape and POCSO Act Cases at L.B. Nagar convicted Mohammed Munawar Hussain, a teacher at a madrasa in Mamidipally village, and imposed a fine of ₹25,500 on him and awarded ₹2 lakh as compensation to the victim. The case came to light after the boy disclosed to his mother that the teacher sexually assaulted him.

Soldiers booked for allegedly harassing woman on train

The Kannur Railway police filed a case against four soldiers for allegedly harassing a woman aboard the Thiruvananthapuram Central-Rajdhani Express. The accused–K. Mithun and Pratheesh Kumar M., both from Kannur, and C.M. Hansilem Boney of Mukkam, Kozhikode–work for the Territorial Army, Kozhikode, while the fourth accused, J. Vishnu of Kallambalam, Thiruvananthapuram, serves in the Army. The Kannur Railway police registered a case against the four under Section 119(1)(a) of the Kerala Police Act, 2011.

Ruling UDF suffers setback in Keralam local body bypolls; LDF gains ground

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Four months into its term, the United Democratic Front government in Keralam appeared to have received a setback in the byelections in 38 local body wards across 12 districts, with the Opposition Left Democratic Front wresting seven wards from the UDF.

The UDF won 19 seats, while the LDF secured 18. Twenty20, a constituent party of the National Democratic Alliance, won in Kolenchery East ward of the Poothrikka grama panchayat in Ernakulam district. The results were declared on Tuesday.

The UDF retained 15 wards and wrested four wards, while the LDF retained 11 wards and wrested seven wards.

Victory march: LDF's Sunny Varghese celebrates his win in the Pampady grama panchayat's Ward 10 byelection. R.K. NITHIN

In the Chittur-Thathamanagalam municipality in Palakkad district, the LDF won after the results were decided by drawing lots, since both the UDF and LDF candidates ended up with 423 votes.

Another setback for the UDF was in the Chirayinkeezhu Assembly constituency, from where Ramya Haridas had won. LDF candidate Bijimol S. won in the Anchuthengu ward in the Chirayinkeezhu block panchayat by a margin of 359 votes, while the LDF's Ramya V. Thulasi won from the Mundakkal ward in Mangalapuram panchayat.

The recent scuffle between Ms. Haridas and district panchayat member Sajith Muttappalam seems to have negatively affected the UDF in the region.

The LDF had gains in Thiruvananthapuram, Kottayam and Kannur districts, while the UDF secured wins in all four seats in Pathanamthitta district.

Public disapproval

CPI(M) State secretary M.V. Govindan said the results reflected the public disapproval of the Congress-led UDF government. He listed daily power cuts, controversies over Ministers' sponsored foreign trips, ailing public health sector, and rising cost of living as key reasons voters rebuked the V.D. Satheesan administration.

In the previous local body elections in 2025, the UDF had won 22 seats, LDF 15, and NDA one.

'Shivakumar illegally acquired land parcels'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Union Industries Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy on Tuesday accused Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and his family members of illegally acquiring land parcels around Bengaluru that had been notified for Bengaluru-Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor Project (BMICP).

The Chief Minister, who was the Chairman of BMICP Authority in 2004, has been accused by the Union Minister of being instrumental in modifying the original framework agreement to re-allocate land within the project.

The Union Minister showed documents to back his claims that besides Mr. Shivakumar, his parents, daughter Abharana, and brother D.K. Suresh acquired land in B.M. Kaval, which had been notified by the State for the project.

APPOINTMENT

Advetisement No.106/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprise Selection Board
Invites applications for the post of
Director (Technical)
in
Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)
Last date of submission of online application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on **21st October, 2026**.
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on **30th October, 2026**.
For details Login to Website **https://pesb.gov.in**
Link for registration of nodal officers / competent authorities is available on PESB website.

PMO reviews Ambedkarite writings in varsity curricula after 'poison' post

Swathi Vadlamudi
HYDERABAD

Works of prominent intellectuals and academics recommended as readings in several higher learning institutions are under the scanner of the Higher Education Department, following an inquiry by the Prime Minister's Office, which was triggered by an anonymous social media post terming these works 'poison'. The authors/editors of the works include B.R.Ambedkar, Jyoti Rao Phule, Gail Omvedt, Braj Ranjan Mani, and Sharmila Rege, among others.

Higher Education Department seeks 'comments' from central universities on curricula.

An urgent online missive from the Department to all the central universities on September 27 referred to communication received from the PMO regarding the post and sought their 'comments'. Further, the email sought details about enrolment in the courses mentioned in the post.

"All the Central Universities are requested to furnish comments on the above. Further, enrolment in the courses mentioned in the tweet may also be apprised to the Ministry," the communique said.

The anonymous social media post was shared on the platform X on September 26. "From patriarchy to Caste Annihilation to Debrahmanising the history to Curse of Manu, we are feeding young minds with a poison which our leftist cabal use a apprenticeship for grooming their future rank and file" the post said, looping in a thread of six more posts on the subject.

Writer Kancha Ilaiah Shepherd, whose three works, including the trailblazing 'Why I am not a Hindu', were listed among the 35 readings attached with the post, said: "Ambedkarism was always opposed to the leftist idea of class war. If the PMO stands for opposing Phule, Ambedkar being taught, then it stands against SC/ST/OBCs when the Prime Minister himself is an OBC and the President is ST. If the PMO stands for Patriarchy and Manudharma, then it is against man-woman equality".

State of anticipation

J&K should be given its Statehood without any further delay

In a resolution passed on September 28, the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly called upon the Government of India for the "immediate and urgent restoration of full Statehood" to the nearly seven-year-old Union Territory (UT). The erstwhile State of J&K was downgraded and carved out into two UTs in 2019 when the Centre decided to end the region's close to 70 years of special constitutional status. Chief Minister Omar Abdullah moved the resolution with a reminder of the past resolutions adopted by the Assembly over the demand of special status. It mentioned the greater autonomy resolution of June 26, 2000, and the special status resolution of November 6, 2024. Other than the 29 BJP legislators, the members of the 90-member House broadly supported the resolution after an intense and high-pitched debate on Statehood and special status. It was a rare bid by Mr. Abdullah on Statehood since he won the election two years ago. Both the ruling alliance parties, the Congress, CPI(M) and Independents, as well as the Opposition parties, including the Peoples Democratic Party, J&K Peoples Conference, Aam Aadmi Party and Awami Ittehad Party extended their support to the demand. The Centre itself laid down a three-step path for the restoration of Statehood: delimitation, election and Statehood. The Supreme Court of India had sought the restoration of Statehood "as soon as possible", while Prime Minister Narendra Modi had promised the same "at the appropriate time", both in Parliament and outside it. Still, the wait has been too long for not only the people of J&K, but for all those who value democracy and federalism.

Ideological positions aside, the downgrading of J&K from a full-fledged functional State to a UT was unprecedented and unhealthy. No doubt, J&K went through three decades of tumultuous times, as militant violence and deaths became the order of the day. However, the 2024 elections were an unprecedented departure from the past. Voters in Kashmir shunned boycott politics and J&K recorded 63.88% voting. It was the most peaceful election with not a bullet fired, a first in the past three decades, The Centre should have reciprocated the people's faith in the democratic set-up by empowering the legislature they voted for. The first step in that direction is the restoration of Statehood. The scarred and painful past of J&K needs healing. It is high time that the Court's direction on Statehood be respected and implemented without delay. An empowered legislature rather than the streets, should become the space for conversation with the Centre on J&K. J&K should not be allowed to drift away from the federal and democratic process in India. To predicate restoration of Statehood on the end of militancy is, as Mr. Abdullah indicated, equivalent to giving Pakistan and its strategy of state-sponsored terrorism a say in the matter.

Silver lining

In Chess Olympiad, India coming second to Uzbekistan should not be dispiriting

When the Indian men finish as the runner-up and the women secure third place in one of the world's biggest sporting events, it calls for celebration. But, when the fact is that those performances did not quite live up to the expectations, it says a lot about the reputation India enjoys as a chess giant. The Indians' show at the Chess Olympiad, which concluded at Samarkand on Sunday, is no doubt commendable, as they retained the Gaprindashvili Trophy, awarded to the best country overall, and claimed six individual medals as well. In a tournament in which more than 200 countries took part, that is no small feat. Still, for a nation that had won both the open and women's titles two years ago in Budapest, the failure to defend even one is a bit of a disappointment. The Indian men were seeded second, while the women had the top billing. So, the men played according to their ranking, as the host Uzbekistan, the only country that could challenge India when it comes to the depth of young chess talent, emerged as the champion. The clash between the two teams was the most anticipated one at the tournament, and it was always going to be crucial. So it proved.

Uzbekistan beat India in the sixth round, moved into the sole position, and inched towards the gold; not even a shocking defeat to Germany mattered in the end. The Indian women's winning run had been stopped in the fifth round, by Poland. They had to fight hard then to win even bronze. The Chinese women were the deserving winners, even though they had not fielded some of their best players. That four Indian women – out of the five – won individual medals proves it was a fine team effort, and yet B. Savitha Shri stood out. The Chennai teenager was making her Olympiad debut, coming in place of the vastly experienced D. Harika, who chose to stay away this time, and she was brilliant right through the event. Of her 10 games, she won eight and drew the other two. Savitha deserves all the support she requires to make further progress on the chessboard. Remember, India does not have the kind of bench strength in women's chess that it possesses in the men's game. D. Gukesh, though playing on the fourth board, could not have timed his individual silver better: after becoming the youngest World champion in history in 2024, he has had a tough time. He is defending his crown against Uzbekistan's Javokhir Sindarov in the match starting in Geneva on November 24. The Olympiad would only have helped him recover some of his confidence and persistence.

Indian academia's drift from reason to ritual

C.P. Rajendran

Geoscientist and a communicator on science, politics, environment and education

Academic institutions must remain spaces for scepticism, dissent and fearless inquiry

At their core, educational institutions are intended to be 'temples of empiricism'. Their entire legitimacy rests on a single, unforgiving premise: that truth is discovered through observation, experimentation, and peer-reviewed verification, not through revelation, tradition, or charismatic authority. The scientific method thrives on questioning, falsifiability, and rigorous doubt – virtues that stand in direct opposition to belief, spiritualism, and uncritical reverence. This is not a mere aesthetic choice or a harmless nod to cultural heritage; it is a profound philosophical contradiction. This raises a disquieting question: when an academic institute prioritises spiritual performance and political deference over intellectual rigour, does it erode the very foundation of its own mission?

Reason versus reverence

Knowledge advances not by revering the past, but by challenging it. Newton's famous "shoulders of giants" line was half-jest—not a call to worship, but to build critically on past work. History shows this: Galileo, Darwin, and Einstein each overturned once-sacred truths. This relentless, iconoclastic spirit is the engine of human knowledge. When a university or research body such as the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) introduces feudalistic, socially hierarchical etiquette – requiring students to bow before dignitaries and formal functions such as convocations suffused with religious incantations – it transmits a deeply corrosive message.

Consider the 2026 convocation ceremony, in August, at IIT Delhi, where Prime Minister Narendra Modi was the chief guest. Reports surrounding the ceremony highlighted two practices that drew criticism: students were reportedly instructed on how far to bow while receiving medals from the Prime Minister, and were reportedly asked to stand during Vedic chants.

In a secular, democratic republic, these are ideological statements with far-reaching consequences. By doing so, the institution subtly endorses the idea that the state and its functionaries operate under a supernatural mandate, a concept antithetical to the rational, evidence-based framework of a modern republic.

The bowing protocol resurrects a pre-modern, courtly hierarchy that has no place in an institution ostensibly committed to meritocracy and intellectual emancipation. It infantilises the graduating students, reducing them from autonomous, critical thinkers to supplicants seeking the favour of a political figure. Yet, it is precisely here that the ceremony reveals its deepest irony: the Prime Minister – a self-avowed votary of his religious practices – used his address to urge students to question conventional wisdom and challenge accepted traditions. The dissonance between the ritual performance and the rhetorical exhortation could hardly be more pronounced. This performative contradiction reveals the ceremony for what it is: a carefully orchestrated spectacle of power, where the substance of the message is sacrificed for the optics of reverence. The spirit of the Constitution requires us to value democratic equality over feudal submission.

Implications for institutional integrity

By reintroducing ritualised submission into academic life, we are resurrecting an intellectual straitjacket. When a student is compelled to bow before a political figure on a dais, the message is that authority is to be obeyed, not interrogated. When a scientific convocation opens with a religious prayer, it is implied that the supernatural has a seat at the table of empirical inquiry.

Defenders will call these practices mere "cultural flourishes" – innocent tributes to India's ancient past, meant to ground students and teach respect. But that argument falters the moment we examine it. The old *guru-shishya* paradigm, for all its reverence, demanded unquestioning obedience – the student absorbing the master's word without debate. Modern pedagogy has moved on. It is built on Socratic dialectic – on the clash of ideas; on rigorous, respectful dissent.

The performative traditionalism often serves a political function. By wrapping themselves in the cloak of ancient culture, institutions deflect scrutiny and discourage dissent. Critics can be branded as "westernised", "anti-national" or a recently added epithet, "*Dimagi* Naxal (intellectual extremist") for objecting to what is, in essence, a breach of academic ethics. This rhetorical strategy is intellectually dishonest; it conflates so-called cultural pride with uncritical obedience, and tradition with truth. The result is a climate of fear – where academics and students self-censor, wary of being branded traitors for defending institutional integrity. Most Indian researchers today are too afraid to question government overreach, including their academies, for fear of retaliation.

The "Free to Think 2026" report published by Scholars at Risk (SAR) – an international network that monitors education communities worldwide – presents a comprehensive assessment of the challenges confronting India's academic landscape. Based on data from July 1, 2025, to June 30, 2026, the report assesses academic freedom in India as "severely restricted." The report says that India's Academic Freedom Index score fell from 0.38 in 2022 to 0.14 in 2025, leaving it in the "severely restricted" category.

This is attributed to deterioration to systematic government interference in university governance, suppression of dissent among faculty and students, and a pervasive climate of fear and self-censorship across Indian campuses.

The report says that the central government, led by the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party, has expanded its authority over higher education through the University Grants Commission (UGC). Measures include relaxing academic qualification criteria for Vice-Chancellors and accelerating the casualisation of the academic workforce by removing the 10% cap on non-permanent or contract-based faculty appointments. These policy shifts eliminated the previous limit on contractual faculty positions under the 2018 regulations. The report highlights that government interference in university operations – such as exerting influence over administration, curricula, and management – undermines institutional autonomy and standards of teaching; it also cites police violence against student protests as instances of direct repression of critical voices on campuses and outside.

A call for vigilance and the Tagorean ideal

The presence of spiritual rituals and hierarchical protocols in research institutions is no trivial matter. It is a canary in the coal mine of academic freedom. If a scientist can be compelled to bow to a politician, or to sit through religious chants before a lecture, we must ask: what other compromises await? Will research agendas be steered by political piety rather than public need? Will funding be allocated based on ideological alignment rather than scientific merit, thereby rewarding sycophants?

If we are to preserve the integrity of scientific inquiry, we must insist that our universities remain sanctuaries of scepticism, not stages for spiritual theatre or political sycophancy. The future of knowledge, and indeed the future of a free and democratic society, depends on it.

If we truly wish to honour India's legacy of cultural renaissance and critical thought, we need only turn to Rabindranath Tagore. His poem "Where the Mind is Without Fear" – written under British rule – is not a relic of nostalgic pride, but an invocation for a future world: one where people think with courage, seek truth fearlessly, and live without narrow walls of division. That is one traditional link worth defending – and perhaps even chanting at a convocation. It is a hymn to intellectual courage and the relentless pursuit of truth, not the hollow verse used to silence and intimidate. Let us reclaim the free spirit of inquiry, ensure our academic landscapes remain true to their secular purpose, and help resurrect an education sector currently in a shambles – largely due to doctrinaire rigidity, corruption and misgovernance.

The United Nations' long road to restoring trust

Raja Karthikeya

Adjunct Fellow, Takshashila Institution

The UN, one of humanity's greatest achievements, needs to confront its deepening crisis of trust

As world leaders gathered in New York for the high-level week of the 81st United Nations General Assembly, they debated an increasingly urgent question: trust. This year's theme, chosen by wide-ranging consultations, was: "Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: a UN that delivers for all" – with "restoration" suggesting a collapse of trust. The world has historically been a low-trust society. Mistrust between nations has fuelled conflict throughout history. The UN was hence established after the Second World War to make the actions of nation-states more predictable, by creating a space for dialogue and an elaborate scaffolding of international law. The game of thrones would still be played, but with some rules. The UN has been one of humanity's greatest achievements precisely because of its ability to build and channel trust between nations.

Surveys about the UN

But over the past three decades, that ability has frayed. Where once UN staff designed and seeded "trust-building" approaches between conflicting parties as part of peacebuilding, today the organisation is in a place where it needs to restore trust in its own approaches. Two surveys conducted last year by Edelman Trust and Pew found that both trust in and favourability towards the UN had declined in the countries surveyed.

A new poll by the non-profit UN Foundation found that 52% of respondents feel the UN is struggling to deliver results and want deep structural reform. Well over half believe that it has struggled to enforce international law and protect human rights, and that it is dominated by a few powerful countries. Another poll by the Rockefeller Foundation and Focaldata suggests that only 58% think that the UN can lead efforts to solve global problems, potentially a historic low for the organisation. There are at least four reasons for this situation. First, the persistent deadlock in the UN Security Council (UNSC) has eroded the General Assembly's trust in the UNSC, so much that a resolution was passed (A/76/262) requiring the UNSC's permanent members to explain each new use of veto to the Assembly.

Second, questions persist about the integrity and oversight of the UN's internal processes ranging from recruitment, procurement to allocation of resources. When high-profile controversies such as a procurement scandal in Afghanistan (2013) or sexual exploitation and abuse cases involving peacekeepers (2017) or contracts for non-existent housing projects in Ghana and India (2021) broke out in the UN, the blame was placed on individuals but systemic accountability was seldom addressed. Consequences for individual malfeasance have been limited.

Financial muscle is a factor

Third, a few countries have come to prevail over the UN system on the strength of their financial contributions. They wield influence through advocacy for their nationals to be recruited into the system, extra-budgetary grants for cherry-picked UN programmes or a combination of the two. For instance, a 2024 report of the UN's highest financial oversight body (ACABQ) pointed out that in one UN agency, eight out of nine technical experts recruited were sponsored by a single government. In such a case, can the policies recommended to a beneficiary country by the entity be deemed completely neutral? The UN development system's transparency about its own programme spending too is increasingly limited to these donor governments and not to the public of their beneficiary countries. When it comes to preventing conflict, a fear of upsetting these powerful countries – which in turn could affect contributions as well as individual careers – has made the UN bureaucracy increasingly risk-averse and hesitant.

Fourth, though the bulk of the UN's programme delivery is in the Global South and trust in the UN is higher in the Global South (UN Foundation poll), only a fraction of the decision-making power rests with the Global South. Developing nations, which account for 84% of the world's population, hold only 44% of UN civil service leadership positions. Only a third of the UN leadership in Africa is African. Only two-fifths of the cities in which various UN entities have headquarters are cities in the Global South. When, as part of a cost-cutting measure, thousands of posts were moved out of New York and Geneva in 2025, cities in the Global South (except those mentioned) got a miss despite their cost advantages.

Reverse the shrinking space

The UN commendably delivered global humanitarian assistance and protection in 2025-26 to 98 million people, or roughly 1.1% of the world population. But aid effectiveness and the proportion of funds transferred to local actors remains an issue.

In wars such as Ukraine, Gaza and Iran, the UN made tactical interventions such as keeping grain exports flowing through the Black Sea, or preventing an oil spill in the Red Sea, but could not build on the goodwill thus earned to create mechanisms for the belligerents to sit and talk. Taking the initiative to facilitate peacemaking has become untenably centralised at the highest rungs of the organisation's bureaucratic ladder.

It is time that the UN moved to enhance its transparency and remake its ties with the people of the world, and not just the governments. The United Nations is more than an inter-governmental organisation. It reflects the best of humanity's hopes for itself. The "transformation" that the 81st General Assembly aims for, would indeed have to start, by restoring trust.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A failure to protect women

Recent reports in *The Hindu* of minor girls being molested and assaulted (September 22, 24, 25 and 28), along with other reported incidents, raise deeply troubling concerns about the continuing insecurity faced by women and girls in modern India. It is noteworthy that the top court has taken *suo motu* cognisance of grave cases of assault in the National Capital Region (Page 1, September 29). Women's safety must never be compromised. It is a matter of national dignity and a basic test of democracy. This is not merely about criticising one government or turning individual incidents into political arguments. It reflects a wider failure of society, which takes pride in its culture and traditions but still struggles to ensure women's safety. There ought to be a dedicated women's safety police force across India, with strong representation of women officers, whose primary responsibility would be to protect women.

Lavindar Singh,
Purkal, Dehradun, Uttarakhand

Women and children should be able to move freely without fear in public places. Poor lighting, inadequate CCTV coverage and insufficient patrolling can increase safety risks. I appreciate the Supreme Court's intervention.

Albin Thekkethala,
Kallur, Thrissur, Keralam

Women should not have to calculate the safety of every road, park or journey before stepping outside. Authorities must move beyond statements of concern and ensure visible, preventive action. Better lighting, regular patrolling, functional CCTV systems and prompt responses to complaints must become basic safeguards, rather than measures introduced only after a tragedy.

Shruti Dutta,
Bengaluru

Food loss and waste

In India, food grains worth several crores are lost annually due to poor storage and transport. Ironically, the food we waste is enough to feed everyone. We must adopt a national mission to conserve food and food grains. With climate change a reality, we must also adopt sustainable practices in managing water and soil.

H.N. Ramakrishna,
Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Surveillance is not the only privacy issue

Pankhuri Agarwal

Lecturer and Leverhulme Early Career Fellow at King's Business School, King's College London. Author of 'Fictions of Freedom: Migration, Modern Slavery and Bureaucracy in India' (2026)

In August 2026, the Supreme Court disposed of a public interest litigation on doxxing and deepfakes, asking the Union Ministries to take remedial measures. Earlier in July, A.A. Rahim, a Rajya Sabha member, petitioned the top court against the Delhi Police's use of facial recognition and biometric surveillance during the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protests. And in May, the SC upheld the Election Commission's (EC) Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, though critics had warned that it could exclude a large number of eligible voters.

While these may look like three unrelated stories, read together, they form a pattern connecting the state, private firms, online networks and the citizens caught among them.

Three kinds of watching

Facial recognition is the most visible; the State watches people in public and tries to establish who they are. Mr. Rahim's petition alleges that the police used facial recognition, AI-enabled smart glasses, drones and a mobile command vehicle at Jantar Mantar, and that the data was hosted by two private firms.

The CJP protests revealed a second layer. Women who took part were later targeted online: their personal details were published with reported rape and death threats. Public identification as punishment is not new; in March 2020, the Uttar Pradesh administration put up hoardings in Lucknow with the photographs and addresses of people protesting against the Citizenship Amendment Act. The Allahabad High Court ordered them removed, calling the display an "unwarranted interference in privacy". Today, a hoarding is not needed; a photo can be uploaded, identified, amplified and linked to an address within hours.

> Who is responsible when a protester is identified by a camera, doxxed by anonymous accounts, and then threatened at home? Which safeguard applies when data gathered by the police is held by a private company?

The SIR is a third kind of watching, wherein identity checks decide who stays on the electoral roll. The top court has held that the EC may examine citizenship for this limited purpose, though it cannot decide upon citizenship itself. But the scale is considerable: Bihar's SIR began with about 7.89 crore electors and ended with a final roll of 7.42 crore.

India's privacy jurisprudence has a powerful foundation. In *K.S. Puttaswamy vs. Union of India* (2017), a nine-judge Bench held privacy to be a constitutionally protected right. However, *Puttaswamy* was decided in a case against the state, and its test is framed around state action. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 lets the Union government exempt any state instrumentality from the Act by notification, on grounds which include the security of the state and public order. Consider Pegasus then, the spyware made by an Israeli firm and allegedly used against journalists, activists and others. A court-appointed independent expert committee reported malware in some phones which it examined in 2022, but could not say for sure if it was Pegasus; it also noted that the Union government had not cooperated. Later in 2025, the SC indicated that parts of the report would not be made public.

The result is, therefore, a legal landscape in which the strongest constitutional protection may apply at one point in the chain, while the same person's information passes through other hands beyond it. Who is responsible, then, when a protester is identified by a camera, doxxed by anonymous accounts, and then threatened at home? What happens to privacy when an electoral-roll decision determines whether someone can vote? Which safeguard applies when data gathered by the police is held by a private company? India does not have clear answers to these questions.

None of this is new. The state's interest in identifying individuals predates Aadhaar by more than 150 years. In 1858, William Herschel, a British magistrate, began taking handprints on contracts. The technique was later developed into a fingerprint classification system in Bengal. The technology has changed, but the impulse to make a population identifiable has not. It shows up in Aadhaar, in Delhi's cameras, and in the SIR.

What is different today is the scale and speed. The state's cameras, the private companies that operate them, social media accounts that spread deepfakes and the bureaucratic exercises that decide who counts on the rolls are not separate stories that happen to unfold in the same summer. They are connected.

Therefore, the current moment calls for a different starting point: one that treats surveillance not as a discrete act by an identifiable actor against an identifiable person, but as a diffuse act spread across states, companies, and foreign vendors at once.

Muthanga verdict: whose death counts?

Abhilash Thadathil

Associate Professor, Centre for Development Studies, Thiruvananthapuram

On July 31, the Principal Sessions Court in Wayanad delivered its verdict in the Muthanga case. The Muthanga agitation was a land occupation from early January to February 19 in 2003 at the Muthanga Wildlife Sanctuary, led by the Adivasi Gothra Maha Sabha (AGMS) under C.K. Janu and M. Geethanandan, demanding the government to fulfil its 2001 promise to distribute land to landless Adivasi families. On February 19, the government evacuated the protesters through police action, in which one Adivasi and one policeman died. The court found only one man, Ashokan, who has since died, responsible for constable Vinod's death; the other 56 who were accused were held not guilty. Four leaders, including Mr. Geethanandan, were convicted on a conspiracy charge related to the assault on a surviving officer and sentenced to five years' rigorous imprisonment. On August 21, the Kerala High Court suspended their sentences and granted them bail pending appeal.

However, this case has effectively buried the death of Jogi, an Adivasi man killed on the same morning, in what officials termed as a 'death in police operation'. In the judgment's opening statement, Jogi appears not as a victim but as one of the accused, alleged to have tortured hostages "under the direction of Geethanandan" and to have caused, with others, Vinod's death. His death entered the file in an adversarial role, before any question of his own killing was raised.

The Muthanga struggle exposed how Keralam's much-vaunted development story ran up against a harder truth: its Adivasis had waited decades for the land the government had promised but never delivered, and when they finally asserted that right, the government moved to silence them. Twenty-three years produced a trial, 47 witnesses and a 217-page judgment for Vinod's death. For Jogi, they produced nothing – not a charge, a witness, or a line of inquiry.

> Twenty-three years produced a trial, 47 witnesses and a 217-page judgment for Vinod's death. For Jogi, they produced nothing — not a charge, a witness, or a line of inquiry

The questions this trial was asked to settle were drawn up in the 2004 chargesheet. It asks who conspired against Vinod, who assaulted the officers and who caused his death. It does not address Jogi's death. This silence was fixed in place when investigators first decided what the case would and would not be about.

The special prosecutor told the media that Jogi's death fell outside what the CBI had been asked to investigate, since police were "discharging their official duties" that day. That may describe the case's legal boundaries. But it is also an admission that those boundaries were drawn to leave Jogi out from the start. An Adivasi died in police action during an Adivasi movement, and his death was absorbed into a file built to answer for everything except that.

Lack of questioning

This raises a further question: who was heard in court? Of the 47 prosecution witnesses, roughly half were police, forest officials or investigators; none were Adivasis. The defence, representing the 57 accused, could produce only a single witness, whose testimony concerned the movement's welfare work, and not the eviction itself. When defence lawyers asked a police witness whether the eviction team had set fire to huts and beaten Adivasis as they fled, the answer was a flat no. No one from the community was in court to say otherwise.

It would be easy to read the Muthanga incident as standard police action against protesters, but the reality is more revealing. Vinod came from a Dalit family, and so did Geethanandan. The line the law drew that day was not about community; it was about who wore a uniform and who did not. The judgment recommends compensation for Vinod's family and the two surviving officers; it recommends nothing for Jogi's family, because the rule being applied was never going to cover him. In the end, recognition followed the government's chain of command – not who was harmed, and not who held the stronger claim to the land that started it all.

To give Jogi justice, no one needs to reopen the case. The government just needs to formally ask what happened to him. Moreover, nothing in this verdict stops Jogi's family from claiming compensation under the State's scheme for victims of police violence. He was included in the case only to be blamed, never accounted for. Muthanga happened under a Congress-led government. Two decades on, Keralam is again governed by another Congress-led government, and it carries the responsibility its predecessor left behind. Adivasis had come to Muthanga in 2003 because of a promise the government never kept. That promise is still unkept.

Sulphur prices rise due to Russia-Ukraine, West Asia wars

The rising demand for a commodity, which is largely produced as a by-product, is because of metals processing, linked to the production of batteries

DATA POINT

Devyanshi Bihani

The international price of sulphur has risen nearly four-fold in one year from $280 per tonne in July 2025 to $1,050 in July 2026, adding to India's import burden.

The prices started climbing from late 2025 onwards, driven by rising demand and the Russia-Ukraine war. While the prices climbed steadily, crossing $500 per tonne by December 2025, it has skyrocketed since March 2026 after the U.S. and Israel launched attacks on Iran **(Chart 1)**.

Sulphur supply is strongly tied to oil and gas production, as about 92% of global sulphur production comes from petroleum refining and natural gas processing. Only 8% is mined directly from natural deposits or sulphur-rich minerals such as pyrites.

China is the largest producer with an estimated production of 19 Million Metric Tonnes (MMT) in 2025, followed by the U.S. (8.1 MMT), Russia (7.5 MMT), Saudi Arabia (7.2 MMT) and the UAE (6.3 MMT) **(Chart 2)**.

Despite being among the top 10 producers of sulphur with 3.7 MMT, India relies on imports to meet its demand. India's imports have grown over the years, with West Asian producers contributing to about 90% of its total imports **(Chart 3)**. In 2025, India imported 2.25 MMT of sulphur, of which 2.02 MMT came from West Asia. Russia accounted for 0.15 MMT (6.5%). A majority of India's demand is from the fertilizer industry with the Fertiliser Association of India estimating that 52% of the sulphur required for the industry came through imports in 2024-25.

The first major supply shock came from Russia, the third largest producer, with Ukrainian drone strikes targeting oil and gas-processing plants. This led to Russia restricting the export of industrial sulphur to maintain domestic supplies. The restriction announced till December 2025, has since been extended till December 31, 2026.

While this contributed to a global escalation of prices, the bigger disruption came in February 2026 from West Asia when the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran. West Asia not only accounts for roughly 90% of India's sulphur imports, but also for more than 45% of global seaborne sulphur trade. Meanwhile, China also restricted sulphuric acid exports in 2026 to meet domestic needs, further tightening the global market.

The sharp increase in prices has led to India's import cost of sulphur going up 2.5 times from $248 million in 2024 to $638 million in 2025 **(Chart 4)**.

Demand on the rise

The shortened supply has had such a huge impact as the demand for sulphur was already on the rise. As per the CRU Group, the global market had moved into a structural deficit by 2024. It estimated the demand to be 72.8 MMT in 2025, against a supply of 70.8 MMT – a deficit of about 1.9 MT. Stock releases from Kazakhstan and Saudi Arabia helped bridge the gap, but those inventories were also being drawn down.

A major reason for the increasing demand is because of metals processing, linked to production of batteries. Sulphuric acid is used in High-Pressure Acid Leach (HPAL) plants to extract nickel from laterite ores, which is then used in products including EV batteries **(Chart 5)**. Indonesia has become a key player in this industry with both its nickel-related sulphuric acid demand and imports roughly quintupling between 2021 and 2025. While its demand went from 3.5 MMT to 16 MMT in this period, its imports increased from 0.23 MMT to 1.09 MMT.

With global uncertainties showing no signs of abating, India's burden due to increased import costs may continue for the near future.

Price surge

The data for the charts were sourced from the Department of Fertilizers, United States Geological Survey, UN Comtrade, and the CRU Group which studies global commodity markets, specialising in mining, metals, and fertilizer industries

Sulphur squeeze: Imported sulphur is seen at a port in Nantong, Jiangsu province, China, in March 2018. Sulphur is a key raw material in fertilizer production and is increasingly used in nickel processing. REUTERS

CHART 1: Monthly international sulphur prices ($ per metric tonne) from July 2025 to July 2026. The prices have risen nearly four-fold. Values are in $

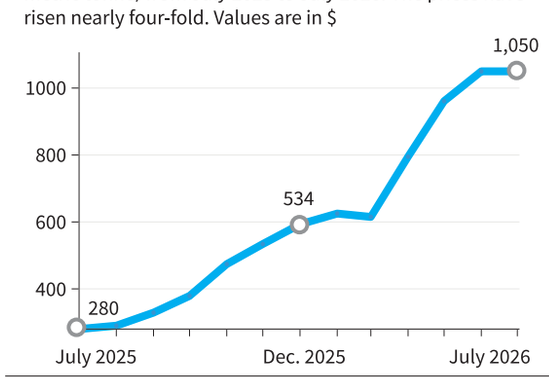


CHART 4: Value of India's sulphur imports (in $ million) from 2021-2025. It increased 2.5 times between 2024 and 2025

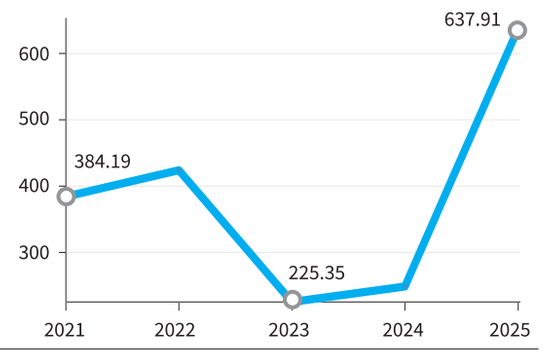


CHART 2: The top 10 sulphur producing countries in 2025. India was the eight biggest producer of sulphur. Values are in million metric tonnes

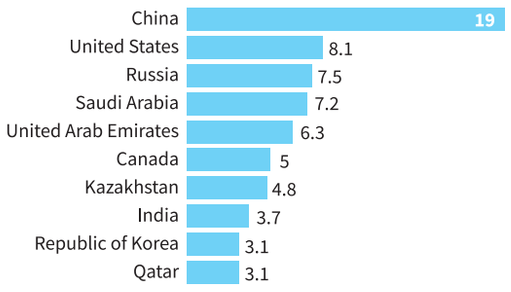


CHART 5: The industries and processes where sulphur was in high demand in 2025 (in million metric tonnes)

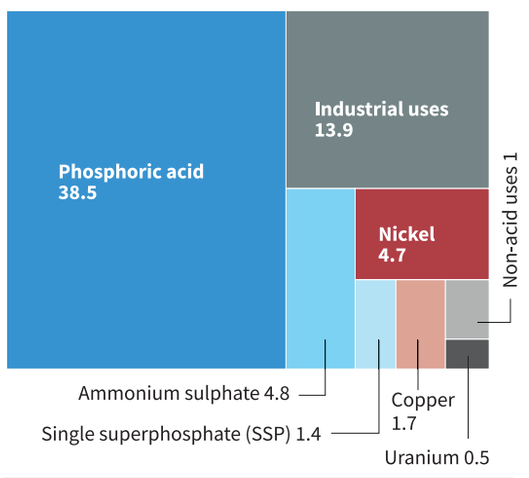
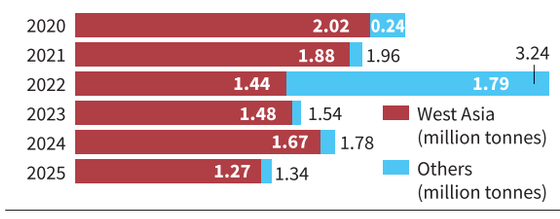


CHART 3: India's sulphur imports (in million metric tonnes) from 2020 to 2025. West Asia accounted for nearly 90 % of the imports



A major reason for the increasing demand is because of metals processing, linked to production of batteries. Sulphuric acid is used in high-pressure acid leach (HPAL) plants to extract nickel from laterite ores, which is then used in products including electric vehicle batteries

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 30, 1976

Britain to seek IMF loan

London, September 29: Britain to-day announced its intention to "apply" to the International Monetary Fund (IMF) for a stand-by loan from its remaining credit at the Fund.

This decision to apply to IMF follows a rapid slide of the sterling on the foreign exchange markets this week culminating in a fall of four U.S. cents yesterday, the biggest fall-over in one day.

Britain is seeking a new IMF credit totalling $3.9 billions or £2.3 billions.

Sterling immediately jumped two cents in value to $1.6650 on the foreign exchange markets following the announcement.

The IMF credit will allow Britain to repay borrowing under an international stand-by credit of $5.3 billions provided last June by nine other nations. This stand-by credit expires in December.

The Chancellor of the Exchequer, Mr. Denis Healey, decided on the approach to IMF after emergency talks with the Governor of the Bank of England, Mr. Gordon Richardson, following yesterday's crash by the pound on world money markets.

The aim of to-day's announcement appeared to be to remove uncertainties in the foreign exchange markets over how Britain will repay some $1.1 billions drawn in June from the $5.3 billions central banks' credit, which helped to tide Britain over a run on the pound in June.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 30, 1926

Indian Railway Conference

Simla, September 29: The annual session of the Indian Railway Conference Association will open here on the 7th of October under the presidency of Colonel Walton, Agent, N.W. Railway.

A majority of the subjects to be discussed are of a technical nature in connection with the interchange of rolling stock and through booking of passenger goods and military traffic.

Among subjects of a more general interest which will be discussed, are local taxation of railways, application of the Geneva convention to railways, publicity, vacuum brake working, and passengers travelling without tickets.

About sixty officers representing all railways in India will attend the meeting which it is expected will last about a week.

From Page One

Suspend SIR as its validity doubtful: Cong.

Addressing a joint press conference with Jairam Ramesh, Congress general secretary (organisation), senior leader K. C. Venugopal said that since the government was not listening to the people, the only way for parties that believed in democracy was to resist.

"Gyanesh Kumar is only a tool. Whenever dictators lose the confidence of common voters, they will try to find special ways to stay in power. This exercise (SIR) could not happen without the concurrence of Modi and Amit Shah," Mr. Venugopal said. "There is a moral responsibility for the PM on this issue. We are demanding resignation from the PM on moral grounds," he said.

Mr. Venugopal said the INDIA bloc meeting on Wednesday would chalk out a further course of action to resist what the Congress has termed *vote chori* (vote theft). "The Congress wants to hold a massive agitation to save democracy in the country with the help of all political parties. There will be valuable suggestions from leaders of the INDIA bloc tomorrow; after that we will sit and formalise the clear action plan for the future agitation," he said.

In his opening remarks to the CWC, Mr. Kharge put forward five demands, including making the complete data on every major change made to the electoral rolls public, and providing political parties with the electoral rolls and relevant data in a simple format and in a timely manner. He also demanded an independent and time-bound inquiry wherever evidence of serious discrepancies emerges.

"We do not view this issue merely as a battle to win or lose an election," the Congress chief said, adding, "We must convey to every citizen that in a democracy, the most powerful person is the ordinary voter – not the Prime Minister, the Chief Minister, or a leader in power."

Opposition lambasts 'diabolical' questions

"When we demanded of the Modi government that it gather data on the educational, social, and economic conditions of Muslims, the government would instantly turn its face away. Amit Shah's 'Demography Commission' is now asking States for data on how many vehicles people of which religion have bought, how much land they own, and so on. The agenda of this commission is not to formulate better policies based on the foundation of data, but rather to twist and distort the data in such a way that Muslims can be targeted and even their remaining scraps of rights can be snatched away from them," Mr. Owaisi said on *X*.

Mr. Sidhu, the former bureaucrat, cited the right to privacy, the Allahabad High Court's 2025 ruling against caste profiling in police records, and the ongoing Census 2027, which already records religion confidentially.

"No sub-registrar asks a buyer's religion before registering a sale deed, so these data can now be produced only by assigning a religion to each citizen from his name, and that is profiling... If a committee has asked the wrong question, the States need not compound the error by guessing the answer," he said.

On Tuesday, *The Hindu* reported that a High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes, constituted by the Ministry of Home Affairs, has sent State governments a 35-point questionnaire seeking extensive data on demographic changes over the past 15 years. A significant portion of the information has been sought district-wise and religion-wise, covering Hindus, Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists and Parsis.

The questions seek a religion-wise break-up of birth registrations, school enrolment, ration cards, vehicle registrations, property transactions, and voter registration. The committee has also asked States to identify unusual increases in Aadhaar enrolments, voter IDs and ration cards, and furnish information about forged identity documents. It was constituted on May 26 to study demographic changes arising from illegal immigration and other "abnormal" reasons, and recommend measures to address them.

SC flags steep mark-ups on essential drugs

The Bench also pointed to the impact of inflated prices of essential drugs on public finances, observing that when treatment is covered under government-funded health schemes such as Ayushman Bharat, the cost is ultimately borne by taxpayers. "Suppose the patient is taking treatment through government services... The government doesn't pay, the taxpayer pays. This affects a larger section of society," the Bench remarked.

Mr. Mehta sought time to place before the court details of the existing mechanisms governing drug pricing and assured the Bench that he would make his submissions on the next date of hearing. The Bench accordingly posted the matter for further hearing on October 12, 2026.

The petitions have sought directions to make drug formulations more affordable by curbing alleged overpricing of essential medicines by pharmaceutical companies and retailers. They have also sought stricter enforcement of price controls under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013 to prevent violations of the prescribed pricing mechanism and disproportionate profit margins across the drug supply chain.

Two held for seeking bribe from NGO for FCRA approval

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Two government officials were apprehended by the Special Cell of Delhi Police on Monday, following specific information received by the Union Home Ministry on alleged corruption linked to the processing of registrations under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act.

The FCRA registration is mandatory for NGOs to receive funds from outside India.

The arrests were carried out in coordination with Central agencies, according to a statement by the Home Ministry. The two officials, one serving as a senior accountant and the other as an accountant, are accused of approaching an association and seeking illegal gratification in exchange for facilitating its pending FCRA registration.

One of the accused is currently posted in the Ministry's Foreigners Division, which handles matters related to the FCRA. The second official is presently posted in a Pay and Accounts Office but had previously served in the Foreigners Division. Investigators are examining the extent of their activities.

Indian delegation attends SCO meeting in Pakistan

First such official visit by Indian delegation since Operation Sindoor; senior Home Ministry official leads team at 3-day meet; India rejects Erdogan's Kashmir comments as Türkiye eyes SCO entry

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

Pakistan announced that it would host the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in August 2027, as an Indian delegation led by a senior External Affairs Ministry official attended a preparatory meeting in Islamabad– the first such official Indian visit to Pakistan since Operation Sindoor last year.

The three-day meeting of SCO National Coordinators that began on Monday comes days after India and Pakistan sparred with each other over the issue of terrorism and the Kashmir dispute at the UN General Assembly (UNGA). External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar and Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif traded allegations in their national addresses, while Indian and Pakistani diplomats exercised their rights of reply to the speeches on the global stage last week.

On Tuesday, India also rejected Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan's reference to Kashmir in his UNGA speech.

The SCO National Coordinaters meet in Islamabad. India was represented by senior official Alok Dimri.

The participation of Joint Secretary (Multilaterals and Economic Relations) Alok Dimri marked a higher level of Indian representation than at the past few meetings held under Pakistan's Chairpersonship of the SCO this year. In mid-September, a meeting of SCO-Regional Anti-Terror Structure in Islamabad was attended by the Indian Charge d'affaires in Pakistan Satyapal Pandey, without a delegation from India.

In a statement, the Pakistan Ministry of Foreign Affairs said that Pakistan's SCO Chairship would promote the theme of "Turning Vision into Action: Connectivity, Innovation and Shared Prosperity," for 2026-2027.

Indian officials made it clear that the SCO coordinators' meet was being held in a multilateral format and hence had no particular significance for India-Pakistan bilateral ties. However, the participation does leave the path open to higher-level attendance at the Ministerial-level events and the Heads of Council meet, to which Prime Minister Narendra Modi has been invited. Thus far, New Delhi has avoided the leaders' meetings in both Delhi and Islamabad.

In 2023, Mr. Modi hosted the SCO Heads of Council Summit virtually, while External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar hosted Pakistani Foreign Minister Bilawal Bhutto in person for the SCO Foreign Ministers' meeting in Goa. In 2024, Mr. Jaishankar travelled to Islamabad to attend the SCO Heads of Government meeting as well. The Ministry has thus far declined to comment on whether Mr. Modi would travel to Pakistan next year, but has not ruled it out either.

At a briefing on Tuesday, Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal brushed aside a question about whether India would oppose the induction of Turkiye to the 10-nation SCO.

Turkish President Erdogan had told journalists earlier this month that Türkiye would pursue a "higher level" of engagement with the SCO than its observer status, indicating he could ask for full membership next year, particularly given close ties and the military pact with SCO host Pakistan.

"As and when any issue of membership comes it is for [SCO] members to collectively decide as to how to go forward on that," Mr. Jaiswal said. He also criticised Mr. Erdogan for referring to Kashmir in his UNGA speech last week.

CISF constable guns down 4 colleagues in J&K's Kathua

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Four Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) personnel, posted at the Sewa-II Hydroelectric Project unit in Kathua district of Jammu and Kashmir, were allegedly shot dead by a colleague in an apparent case of fratricidal violence on Tuesday evening.

Preliminary reports suggest that the incident took place at the power project close to the Himachal border. A Head Constable of the 2009 batch had reportedly argued with his colleagues. Subsequently, he charged into an office and allegedly opened fire with an AK-47, leaving four personnel injured. The injured men succumbed at the NHPC Hospital in Himachal Pradesh.

"The accused Head Constable has been handed over to the police," an official said. The CISF is setting up an internal inquiry into the incident, he added.

Among the deceased are an Assistant Commandant, a Sub Inspector, and two constables.

The police have not disclosed the exact circumstances surrounding the killing.

Opposition members seek more time from JPC chief on FCRA Bill

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Ten Opposition members of the Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) reviewing the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, have written to committee Chairman and BJP leader Sanjay Jaiswal seeking a postponement of the panel's October 12 meeting by at least four weeks to allow more time for inviting public comments on the Bill.

In the letter dated September 29, the Opposition MPs said that, given the wide-ranging implications of the proposed legislation, it is essential that the members be given more time to study the Bill and related documents before examining it. The period for receiving comments, suggestions and representations from the public and stakeholders should stay open for a minimum of four weeks, so that organisations, experts and members of the public can examine the provisions and submit views, the opposition MPs said. The additional time, they said, would also let members consider the representations before deliberating on the Bill.

The letter was signed by DMK's A. Raja and P. Wilson, Congress's Christopher Manickam, Hamdullah Sayeed, Viriato Fernandes and Anto Antony, Samajwadi Party's Javed Ali Khan and Zia Ur Rehman Barq, MAITC's Kalyan Banerjee and NPP's James P.K. Sangma.

Will contest U.P., Punjab polls with or without BJP, says Chirag Paswan

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Ahead of the Assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh and Punjab scheduled for early next year, key NDA ally and Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) president Chirag Paswan, in an interview to *The Hindu*, said his party would contest in both States "with or without the BJP".

His assertion comes on the heels of his recent remarks that he feels ashamed to be part of the government in Bihar in the context of molestation cases involving minor girls in Jamui, Samastipur, Banka and other districts.

Earlier, he had also questioned the Election Commission's handling of concerns surrounding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Union Minister Chirag Paswan

These statements, read alongside his new Generation Z outreach campaign, "*Youth Bole Toh*", launched in Patna on September 24, and followed by another rally under the banner in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, three days later, point to Mr. Paswan's decision to maintain a nuanced distance from his senior ally, the BJP.

Mr. Paswan said his party had been working in both States.

"I am in alliance with the BJP both at the Centre and in Bihar. Naturally, I would want this alliance to extend to the two States. Having said that, considering the hard work we have put in to build our organisation in both States, we are not willing to bow out of the contest. If a seat-sharing arrangement cannot be arrived at in the two States under the NDA banner, then we are willing to contest alone," Mr. Paswan said. In such a scenario, the party would contest all 117 seats in Punjab and all 403 seats in Uttar Pradesh.

Dalit party

In both States, the LJP (RV) is seeking to occupy the space of a Dalit party, though Mr. Paswan often positioned himself as an acceptable face across castes instead of being seen solely as a Dalit leader.

In Uttar Pradesh, the party is particularly targeting Passi voters, who are present in significant numbers in eastern and central Uttar Pradesh, the two regions where the BJP faced setbacks in the last Lok Sabha election.

Mr. Paswan said that while he wanted to take his "*Youth Bole Toh*" campaign across the country, for now he would focus on election-bound States. He sees it as a pressure valve that allows students to air their grievances about paper leaks and related issues, describing it as an attempt to contain the "volcano of complaints".

Country has lost its way, but it always corrects course: Murli Manohar Joshi

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Amid the recent controversies regarding the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Gen Z protests, and the alleged theft of donations made to the Ram temple in Ayodhya, Bharatiya Janata Party veteran Murli Manohar Joshi has raised concerns over accountability and the weakening of public trust in the country.

In an interview with *The Hindu*, Mr. Joshi argued that development and governance must remain rooted in responsibility.

Asked about the Ram temple donation theft allegations, he said corruption had become deep-rooted in society, but declined to discuss any specific instance. He noted that the BJP had backed the temple movement, hoping for a consensus solution rather than litigation. Since the Supreme Court directed that the temple be built by a trust, and the government formed that trust, "whatever is happening in the trust is the responsibility of the government", the BJP veteran said.

Murli Manohar Joshi

Regarding the controversy about a music concert organised near the Badrinath shrine in Uttarakhand, he said Adi Shankaracharya had chosen the site with care. Recalling Kalidasa's description of the Himalaya as "*devatatma*", Mr. Joshi asked what was done to its divine soul, citing multi-level parking and DJ concerts. "Tourism brings money, but India never sold mother nature," he said.

He compared the Himalayas to a child who cannot carry a school bag beyond a limit. He cited the cracked homes of Joshimath and said Switzerland's model cannot be applied to a mountain range this fragile. On the all-weather road, Mr. Joshi said he had asked at the highest level whether such width was needed and was told it was not. The BJP leader said he was not against development but was calling for sustainable development.

On the BJP's transformation since his time alongside Atal Bihari Vajpayee and L.K. Advani, Mr. Joshi said change was inevitable, but weakening fundamental principles was unacceptable. He felt the country had "lost its way", though history showed India had always corrected its course, sooner or later.

Asked about the SIR, he said every government wanted to stay in power. Democracy works, he said, only if elections are fair, governments accountable and bureaucracy transparent, and the Opposition must offer a credible alternative.

On youth protests, Mr. Joshi invoked Ashtavakra to argue that established authority should not suppress new voices. Gen Z's anger, he said, stemmed partly from aspirations created by society and unfulfilled promises. "You promised jobs. Where are the jobs?" he asked. If promises were not fulfilled, he said, the government should acknowledge it and tell young people: "Son, we failed to deliver what we had promised. But we will work on it."

CJI sets up Special Bench to hear CAPF officers' petition

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

A Supreme Court Bench of Justices Ujjal Bhuyan and Atul S. Chandurkar has asked the top court's Registry to explain why a contempt petition related to the implementation of its May 2025 judgment on cadre issues in the Central Armed Police Forces was "struck off" the cause list, despite a specific judicial order directing that it be listed for hearing at 2 p.m. on September 29.

The Bench directed that the case be listed again on September 30. Later in the day, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant constituted a Special Bench to hear the plea by retired CAFP officers. It will now be presided over by Justice Manoj Mishra and Justice Bhuyan.

APPEAL

Sujith Raj is 13 years old suffering from "B - Cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia". He needs Chemotherapy and Radiation Therapy at Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai. The total expenditure is **Rs. 8,00,000/-**. His father is an electrician in a private company. The family is very poor and cannot afford this huge cost. Please support him for the treatment. Donations sent by Ch/D.D. favouring **Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre, Madurai will be acknowledged.** The donations sent through Ch/D.D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN'S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT.

All correspondence is done through **WWS,** Regd Public Charitable Trust, **Flat No, GF 1, Corddel Apartments, O.No.13, N.No. 29, Pycrofts Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 044-42137401/ 31523781/ 7338978027.**
E-mail ID: womenswelfaresyndicate@gmail.com
Website: www.womenswelfaresyndicate.org

WWS

SC to hear plea for CEC's suspension next week

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to list and hear early a petition challenging allegations regarding Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's unilateral exercise of authority in the name of the Election Commission, and seeking his suspension from office.

Appearing before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocate Vikas Singh and advocates Sudeep Chandra and Mudit Gupta, representing petitioner Rakesh Kumar Singh, made an oral mentioning for early hearing of the plea which urged the court to direct that Mr. Kumar should not exercise the functions of Chief Election Commissioner, pending final hearing of this petition.

The petition said the two Election Commissioners must conduct the business of the Election Commission through unanimous decisions.

The petition said any further appointment of CEC must be taken on the recommendation of a committee which includes the Chief Justice of India.

The CJI agreed to list the petition next week.

Rahul recalls Modi remark: 'when we go, you will come'

At Congress Working Committee meeting, Leader of Opposition tells party colleagues what Prime Minister Modi once said to him; he also urges party to raise the issue of 'vote chori' more forcefully

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Mallikarjun Kharge, Rahul Gandhi, Sonia Gandhi, and K.C. Venugopal during the CWC meeting in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in a closed-door meeting with Rahul Gandhi in his capacity as Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, told him that the Congress would return to power once the Bharatiya Janata Party was out of power, Mr. Gandhi told his colleagues at the Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting on Tuesday.

Mr. Gandhi, who spoke for 20 to 25 minutes at the CWC meeting, focused on the principle of resistance within the party and asked his colleagues to remain confident, sources said.

Recalling a Selection Committee meeting with the Prime Minister and Home Minister for a constitutional post, Mr. Gandhi said that when he questioned Mr. Modi about pushing through a candidate he had opposed as the Leader of the Opposition, the Prime Minister said he was acting in the manner adopted by previous Prime Ministers, including Indira Gandhi, sources told *The Hindu*. Mr. Gandhi then reminded him that she had lost the subsequent election, the sources said.

"You don't believe me, but the Prime Minister and Home Minister, in the [closed-door] meeting, told me, 'When we go, you will come'... So you should trust me," Mr. Gandhi told CWC colleagues with a smile.

Asked about Mr. Gandhi's remarks, Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal declined to comment.

Mr. Gandhi also asserted that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will have to resign, saying the Congress would "fight to finish".

On the campaign against the alleged vote *chori* (vote theft), Mr. Gandhi said only 20% of people had believed the issue when the campaign was launched, but more than 80% now agreed with him. He urged the party to raise the issue more forcefully.

Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh said Mr. Gandhi told the meeting that the latest "expose" was the result of the sustained Congress campaign on alleged vote chori.

"Rahul*ji* spoke about both *virodh* (opposition) and *pratirodh* (resistance). We will oppose inside Parliament and resist outside on the streets," Mr. Ramesh said.

Suggestions in the closed-door meeting centred on mass mobilisation, with proposals for rallies and campaigns around slogans such as *Chalo Delhi, Vote Bachao* (March to Delhi, Save Your Vote). Several suggestions were made on the way forward.

When Shashi Tharoor suggested that the party could hold a mass dharna on Gandhi Jayanti on October 2, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said Mr. Tharoor should be present at such a programme rather than merely write an article in a newspaper. Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan briefed the meeting on Mr. Gyanesh Kumar's record as a Kerala-cadre bureaucrat and the questionable decisions he had taken during his tenure, sources said.

Digvijaya Singh, who advocated the restoration of ballot papers in elections, was countered by the party leadership when he argued that the Congress should have been able to retain Janata Dal (United) leader Nitish Kumar. Senior leader Sonia Gandhi said Mr. Kumar "betrayed" the Opposition bloc and that it was good he left soon.

Congress-ruled States to adopt 'action plan' against RSS agenda in education

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress Chief Ministers D.K. Shivakumar, Revanth Reddy, and Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu at a meeting in New Delhi. PTI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi met the Chief Ministers and Education Ministers from Congress-ruled States here on Tuesday.

The leaders are learnt to have advised them against implementing the Sangh Parivar's agenda in the education sector and instead follow student-centric educational policies in their States.

In a statement, Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said discussions in the meeting were on how to push back against the RSS's efforts to drive their "divisive agenda" through the education sector, and on how the Congress-ruled States could emerge as model States in the field of education.

Apart from Mr. Kharge and Mr. Gandhi, Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi, and general secretaries and party leaders in charge of the respective States attended the meeting.

Mr. Venugopal said that at the meeting, they decided to hold State-level education seminars with guidance from reputable education experts and stakeholders.

"Within a month, Chief Ministers will prepare a thorough action plan based on inputs from these seminars, to ensure reforms in education sectors and to become model States for education," he said.

A national-level seminar with experts would be held to chalk out the mechanism to roll out these plans. "Chief Ministers will hold presentations on how the RSS's poisonous agenda is polluting our young minds through the education system, and how the RSS-backed Vice-Chancellors are being appointed to further this dangerous agenda," he said. The Congress has been maintaining that the Union government's National Education Policy (NEP), 2020, is for centralisation, commercialisation, and communalisation of education.

While the Congress government in Karnataka had constituted a panel to study the NEP and find ways to replace it with the State's own policy, the new Kerala government had to face controversies over the implementation of the Centre's policies such as the PM SHRI (Prime Minister's Schools for Rising India) scheme. Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan drew flak for saying that there is no provision for the State to withdraw from the agreement with the Union government on implementing the PM SHRI.

Recall split verdict in CEC appointment case: petition

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The petitioner says she learned about the alleged details concerning judge's son from media

The lead petitioner who challenged the Election Commissioners' appointment law has filed a curative petition in the Supreme Court on Tuesday to recall the September 23 split verdict in the case, citing "reasonable apprehension of bias" while alleging that the son of one of the presiding judges, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, serves as standing counsel for the Election Commission of India.

The judgment saw Justice Dipankar Datta, the lead judge on the Division Bench, decline a reference of the case to a five-judge Constitution Bench. Justice Sharma, on the other hand, held that the petitions ought to be heard by a Constitution Bench.

The split verdict stalled the immediate hearing on the merits of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023.

The Act had replaced the Chief Justice of India with a Union Minister on the three-member selection panel, giving the government a dominant role in the appointment process of the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners.

The petitioner said she came to know of the alleged details about the judge's son after the judgment and from media reports, following which she had verified it herself from the High Court's website.

Declaration with Form 6 now only in SIR States

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

While Form 6 is used for new voter registrations, it was also used to re-enlist voters deleted during enumeration. J. ALLEN EGENUSE

In States where the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is not currently ongoing, the Election Commission (EC) has reverted to allowing the online submission of Form 6, which is used for fresh voter registration, without having to complete an attached declaration that had been brought in for the SIR.

While Form 6 is normally used for new voter registrations, during the SIR process, it was also used for re-enlisting those who had been deleted during the enumeration phase. A separate declaration had been added to the physical form regarding the mapping of self or parents with electoral rolls from the period of the previous SIR.

However, while filling the form online, applicants could not submit the online form without completing the declaration attached. It is this issue that the Election Commissioners had reportedly flagged in separate notes and letters in May 2026 and August 2026. Form 6 is attached to the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. Only the Central government has the power to amend the Rules, and by extension, Form 6.

On Saturday, the EC said in a press release that the declaration accompanying Form 6 would now be used only during the period of the SIR.

The Hindu found that on Tuesday, the EC had removed the fields requiring parents' and grandparents' details in the online Form 6. Also, the declaration was found in a separate category, which was to be filled only by those in States where the SIR process was still ongoing.

EC officials maintain that adding a separate declaration form with Form 6 and Form 8 (used for changing particulars) had been approved by the full commission when the SIR process began in Bihar last year and was again ratified in the second and third phases.

They said that Form 6, in itself, was never amended and that the declaration was merely added along with it. According to the officials, the issue with the online submission of the form occurred due to changes made by the IT department so that a person filling the form does not have to e-sign twice – both in Form 6 and separately in the declaration.

Congress is undermining democratic institutions: BJP

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The BJP on Tuesday accused the Congress of undermining India's democratic institutions by attacking the Election Commission over voter roll issues instead of addressing duplicate or deceased voter entries and assessing its electoral setbacks.

"The Congress party that was created to protect the British Empire is today attacking India's Election Commission by referring to the Lahore Congress Session. Nothing could be more shameful than this," alleged senior BJP leader Smriti Irani at a press conference.

The remarks came after the Congress Working Committee (CWC) demanded immediate removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, suspension of the special intensive revision (SIR), restoration of over 13.30 crore names deleted from electoral rolls, and the resignation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Ms. Irani said that in 2019, the Prime Minister had repeatedly asked the Congress to attack him, but not the constitutional institutions and democracy in the country. "However, the Congress leadership is leaving no stone unturned in undermining India's constitutional institutions," she alleged.

The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking),Sankaramangalam,Kollam 691583
Phone : 0476-2651215 to 217, E-Mail :md@kmml.com

TENDER NOTICE

For more details, please visit E-Tendering Portal, https://etenders.kerala.gov.in or www.kmml.com

Sl No	Tender Id	Items
1	2026_KMML_873297_1	Fabrication, welding, laying, painting, testing & Commissioning of LPG pipelines to ARP
2	2026_KMML_874365_1	Supply of Squirrel cage Induction Motor

Chavara 29.09.2026 Sd/- Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

राजस्थान राज्य कृषि विपणन बोर्ड
कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विपणन भवन जालोरी गेट-जयपुर
क्रमांक :- 24767241 दिनांक :- 29/09/2026
बिड आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 02/2026-27
राजस्थान राज्य कृषि विपणन बोर्ड, खण्ड–दौसा, के अन्तर्गत विभिन्न निर्माण एवं मरम्मत कार्यों हेतु ऑन–लाईन बिड ई–प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट (www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in) के माध्यम से उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत बिडर्स से आमंत्रित की जाती है। बिड से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण बोर्ड की वेबसाईट www.agriculture.rajasthan.gov.in/rsamb एवं www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in पर देखा जा सकता है।
UBN No. AGM2627WSOB00880 से 884
राज.संवाद/सी/26/10943 अधीक्षण अभियंता, वृत-जयपुर

WESTERN COALFIELDS LIMITED
(A SUBSIDIARY OF COAL INDIA LIMITED)
COAL ESTATE, CIVIL LINES, NAGPUR – 440 001, MAHARASHTRA, INDIA.
WEBSITE: westerncoal.in
NOTICE
All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of **Coal India Ltd. www.coalindia.in**, respective subsidiary Company (**Western Coalfields Limited) https://westerncoal.in**, CIL e-Procurement portal **https://coalindiatenders.nic.in** and Central Public Procurement Portal **https://eprocure.gov.in**. Procurement of goods and services (if available on GeM Portal) are done through GeM portal only **https://gem.gov.in.**

कार्यालय जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, जोधपुर
क्रमांक :- JDA/2026-27/CMAJY/1227 दिनांक :- 17/08/2026
ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या - मुख्यालय/27/2026-27
जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण, जोधपुर की ओर से प्राधिकरण एवं राजकीय विभाग में उपयुक्त श्रेणी मे पंजीकृत संवेदक जिनका पंजीयन नियमानुसार पुनरावलोकन (Review) किया हुआ हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र मे ई–प्रोक्युरमेन्ट प्रक्रिया से ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। जो निम्नलिखित दिनांक अनुसार डाउनलोड तथा खोली जायेगी। इन कार्य की अनुमानित लागत, निविदा बेचे जाने तथा प्राप्त करने की दिनांक, निविदा शर्तें आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाईट **www.jodhpurjda.org, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** एवं **www.sppp.raj.nic.in** पर देखी जा सकती है।
UBN No. :- JOD2627WSOB00294, JOD2627WSOB00295
राज.संवाद/सी/26/10826 अधिशाषी अभियंता

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA, "e"- PROCUREMENT NOTICE
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KHORDHA (R&B) CIRCLE, KHORDHA
WORKS DEPARTMENT
Tender Call Notice E-mail: rbcirclekhurda@gmail.com
Bid Identification No. CCE-Khordha (R&B) Circle - 09/2026-27 Memo No -2423 Dt.17/09/2026
The Chief Construction Engineer, Khordha (R&B) Circle, Khordha on behalf of Governor of Odisha inviting percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Bridge works as detailed in the table below:

1.	Nature of Work	: **Bridge Work**
2.	No of Work	: **1 No.**
3.	Tender Cost	: **Rs.10000.00 (On-Line)**
4.	Class of Contractor	: **A & Special Class**
5.	Available of Bid document in the Website	: From **10.00 AM of Dt.30.09.2026** to **05.00 PM of Dt.13.10.2026**
6.	Date of opening of Bid	: **Dt.14.10.2026 at 11.30 AM**

7. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the Website:**https://tenderodisha.gov.in**. Any Addendum / Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

Chief Construction Engineer, Khordha (R&B) Circle, Khordha
34001/838/2627 OIPR-34001/34127/1/26-27/0012

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
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(Telephone No. 0471-2945600,),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No.KMSCL/ED/33/2026 Date : 28.09.2026
RE- TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Drugs for Multiple Sclerosis Under SID of KSSM for the year 2026 - 2027.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. Drugs
1.	KMSCL/ED/MULTI-SCLE/RT//2026/024 dtd. 28/09/2026	01

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 12.10.2026, 5.00 pm.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 14.10.2026 11.00 am.
Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.** (Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

NATIONAL BOARD OF EXAMINATIONS IN MEDICAL SCIENCES
(Autonomous body of the M/o. Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
NAMS Building, Medical Enclave, Ansari Nagar
New Delhi – 110029
DNB FINAL EXAMINATION – DECEMBER 2026 SESSION
NOTICE
National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) shall conduct the **DNB Final Theory Examinations** on **19th, 20th, 21st and 22nd November 2026.**
The online applications are being invited from **23-09-2026 (**05:00PM onwards**) to 12-10-2026 (**till 11:55 PM**)** at NBEMS website:
https://natboard.edu.in/viewnbeexam?exam=dnb
There is no other method for submitting the application other than the above online method. Applications submitted through any other medium will be summarily rejected.
Candidate Care Support: +91-7996165333
• Helpline Portal on applicant login page
• Communication Web Portal on NBEMS Website

INBRIEF

Madhya Pradesh clash: search on for five AI video creators

Fourteen people have been arrested and more than 30 booked so far in connection with the violence in Madhya Pradesh's Ujjain over the demolition of a portion of a mosque, even as members of the Muslim community continued to remove the necessary portions amid tight police security, officials said on Tuesday. The police are also searching for five social media content creators, who have been booked for allegedly circulating videos generated with artificial intelligence (AI), which are believed to have provoked people to march to the Shahi Masjid and clash with the police.

Soldier patrolling Myanmar border killed in Arunachal

Suspected extremists attacked Assam Rifles personnel patrolling the India-Myanmar border in Arunachal Pradesh's Changlang district on Tuesday, killing a havildar and injuring four others. Officials said the incident occurred around 6.30 a.m. near Nampong Nallah, where personnel of the 21 Assam Rifles were deployed for patrolling amid the ongoing border fencing work. Havildar Jankhokai Kuki, 42, was killed when suspected members of the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (Khaplang-Yung Aung) fired at the patrolling team. Security agencies said they were trying to ascertain the identities of the attackers.

El Niño won't impact crop production, says Chouhan

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday said the country's rainfall deficit is currently around 12% but it is unlikely to impact crop production.

Addressing pressperson after a two-day national agricultural conference on Rabi crops here, the Minister ruled out any "major crisis" at the national level due to El Niño.

However, he said the Centre has set a foodgrain production target of 373.93 million tonnes for 2026-27, which is 2.63 million tonnes less than the actual production of 376.56 million tonnes in 2025-26. Mr. Chouhan said that while Kharif harvest will be better than last year's, the new target is based on a scientific assessment of El Niño conditions and includes a target of 177.72 million tonnes for the Rabi season. While the actual production in 2025-26 was 376.56 million tonnes, the target was 362 million tonnes.

The Centre will hold discussions with the States to inform the farmers about the benefits of various free trade agreements, he said.

Centre moves SC to stay Nicobar project hearings

Centre asserts in top court that the petitioner has no *locus standi* to move court in the matter, and calls the petitions 'abuse of process'; Calcutta High Court had rejected this argument in May

Abhinay Lakshman
NEW DELHI

A tribal reserve area on the Great Nicobar Island where the ₹92,000-crore mega infrastructure project is planned. AFP

The Union government has approached the Supreme Court to stay further proceedings in the petitions pending final hearing before the Calcutta High Court, which allege that provisions of the Forest Rights Act (FRA) were violated in obtaining consent for its ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar Island (GNI) project.

On May 6, the High Court overruled the Centre's preliminary objections to the petitions. The Centre had argued that Meena Gupta, the petitioner, had no *locus standi* to approach the court. The Bench of then Chief Justice Sujoy Paul and Justice Partha Sarathi Sen had dismissed this argument and had cleared the way for a final hearing.Ms. Gupta, a retired IAS officer, had served as Secretary in both the Environment and Tribal Affairs Ministries.

In a special leave petition (SLP) before the top court, the Union government, through the Ministry of Environment, Forests, and Climate Change, has sought a stay on the High Court order and the pending proceedings. The Centre has reiterated that Ms. Gupta had no *locus standi*, saying the challenges to the project filed before the High Court were an abuse of process and that the government was duty-bound to ensure that the country's growth is not stopped by claims of private individuals, *The Hindu* has learnt.

While Supreme Court records showed that the SLP was filed on July 24, the High Court records revealed that, as of September 24, the Centre had consented to the matters being posted for final hearing on November 25 and 26. The Supreme Court website showed that the Centre's SLP is listed for tentative hearing on October 5.

'Sufficient interest'

In May, the High Court noted that the petitioner had "sufficient interest in the matter" and was "espousing the cause of the vulnerable tribal community". It said she was involved in drafting the Bill that eventually became the FRA.

On the Centre's arguments, the court ruled, "So far, argument regarding the cost and importance of project is concerned, at this stage we are not inclined to enter into the merits of the case. A project involving huge expenditure must proceed in accordance with governing laws holding the field and it is not beyond the scope of judicial review on permissible parameters."

Several petitions

Over the past two years, Ms. Gupta has filed several petitions challenging the Gram Sabha resolutions consenting to the diversion of forest land for the project under the FRA, the constitution of a sub-divisional level committee under the same law, and the notifications reducing the buffer zones for both the Campbell Bay and Galathea Bay National Parks. The petitions question the validity of a certificate issued by the Andaman and Nicobar Islands administration claiming that all rights under the FRA have been identified and settled.

SC quashes NSA detention of Sambhal case accused

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday quashed the preventive detention of a man under the National Security Act (NSA) in connection with the November 2024 Sambhal violence, finding that the nexus between the material on record and the detention order was "conspicuously absent". It also imposed a cost of ₹10 lakh on the Uttar Pradesh government.

The ruling came on a petition filed by Mulla Afroz, who was arrested in connection with the violence that broke out during a court-ordered survey of the Shahi Jama Masjid in Sambhal on November 24, 2024. Four people were killed in the clashes.

A Bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu set aside the October 2025 detention order passed by the Sambhal District Magistrate against Afroz under the National Security Act, 1980, holding that the detention had assumed a character that was "more punitive than preventive". "We are unable to persuade ourselves to sustain the detention order as legal and valid," the Bench said.

NIA arrests 13 for links with Bangladesh terror outfit

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

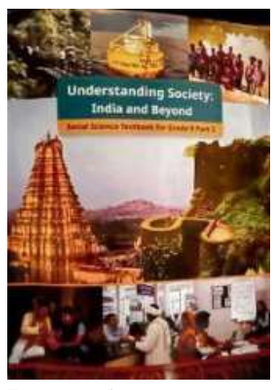
The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has arrested 13 people in connection with a subversive conspiracy by an offshoot of the Jama'atul Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB), a banned terrorist group.

The suspects were arrested during searches in Assam, Kerala and West Bengal, the agency said on Tuesday. Of the 13 accused, eight were from Assam, four from West Bengal, and one from Kerala.

The case is linked to online radicalisation module operated through the Purva Akash Telegram group by Bangladesh-based handlers of Imam Mahmuder Kafila, a JMB offshoot. "The conspiracy involved radicalisation of vulnerable youth and expansion of the outfit's network in India," the NIA said.

NCERT prioritises Indian resistance events over European revolutions

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI



The cover of the new social science textbook for Class 9.

The new social science textbook for Class 9 students released by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) on Tuesday has removed several chapters on European revolutions and has instead prioritised India's medieval history, regional resistance movements, and the impact of successive foreign invasions in its new edition.

The new textbook, *Understanding Society: India and Beyond - Part Two*, replaces the previous edition's chapters on European revolutions, particularly the French and Russian revolutions, with a detailed exploration of Indian sovereignty and resilience.

The new textbook introduces a comprehensive framework detailing the Indian subcontinent's response to expansionist powers between 1,000 and 1,700 CE. It says that from the 7th century, the Indian subcontinent faced successive phases of invasions driven by "territorial expansion and religious motives".

India's historic wealth, the textbook says, was a primary catalyst for these incursions. It notes that the surplus agrarian produce generated by the fertile plains of India's perennial river systems contributed to the region's economic well-being, effectively making it a prime target for foreign forces.

Mughals and Sikhs

A chapter titled "Resistance and Resilience" turns a sharp lens on the relationship between the Mughal state and the Sikh Gurus. The textbook describes "the brutality of the Mughal state" against the Gurus as having "few comparisons in history". As evidence, it cites the execution of Guru Arjan Dev and the detention of Guru Hargobind under Emperor Jahangir, as well as the execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur under Emperor Aurangzeb.

The book argues that this political pressure and persecution catalysed the Sikhs' transition toward collective armed resistance. It traces this evolution through Guru Hargobind's establishment of the Akal Takht and the subsequent rise of Sikh military confederacies.

The revised textbook also allocates a separate section to regional kingdoms and communities that defended their sovereignty, under the chapter titled, "Safeguarding Sovereignty: Resistance, Alliances and Confederacies".

For instance, it highlights the Jats of the Ganga-Yamuna Doab, who rebelled in the Jat Uprising of 1669, and attributes their uprising to severe economic exploitation, heavy Mughal taxation, and resentment toward Aurangzeb's religious policies. According to the textbook, the peasants were heavily burdened by the Sultanate's *iqta* system, while military campaigns often involved the demolition of sacred local sites.

Japan calls on India to fast-track internal process on naval radar agreement

Kallol Bhattacherjee
TOKYO

The pact for transfer of technology was signed when PM Sanae Takaichi visited India in July

Japan on Tuesday called on India to fast-track internal official processing of the agreement on the UNICORN (Unified Complex Radio Antenna) naval radar system that the two sides signed during Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's July India visit.

In an exclusive chat with *The Hindu* on Tuesday, a senior official of the Ministry of Defence of Japan said the next naval exercise of Quad member-states will be held near the Sea of Japan before the year-end.

The senior official called for closer military collaboration between India and Japan. Referring to the UNICORN project, the official said, "We have a basic agreement on the transfer of the technology and now we are waiting for the internal processing of the agreement within the Indian establishment and hope they will fast forward the internal process."

The official further said Japan will soon overhaul major policy documents related to defence, national security and military supply plans, in view of the ongoing conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine.

Note of concern

The Defence Ministry official pointed at activities involving China, Russia, and North Korea that appear "concerning" to Japan and said "Japan is monitoring their military activities". "China's non-transparent and rapidly increasing military expenditure and its activities in areas around Japan as well as China-Russia joint bomber flights in areas near Japan are concerning for Tokyo." The official noted that North Korea is helping Russia in its campaign in Ukraine and in return Pyongyang is "receiving technology from Russia." He, however, said that despite the new challenges on the security front, "Japan will not strike anyone first".

(The correspondent is visiting Japan as a guest of the Foreign Press Center Japan, a leading Japanese foreign policy think tank, to participate in the '2026 International Journalists' Conference' to be held on October 1 in Tokyo)

TH CROSSWORD + 14911

(set by Dr. X)

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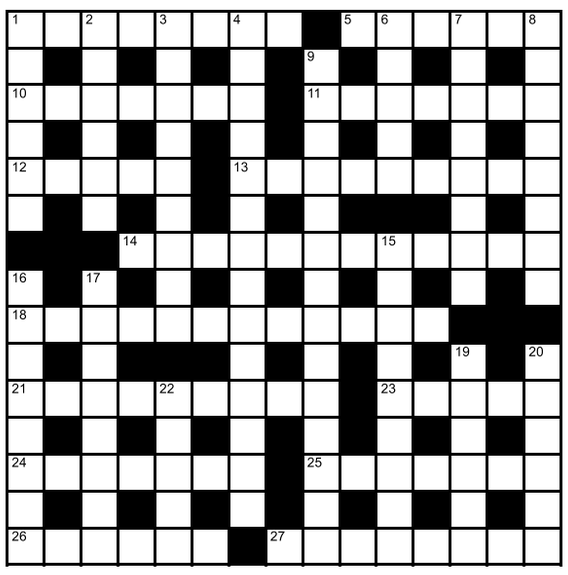
SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Left enthralled by great retired star, most suave (8)
5 Revealed love to woman in shack (6)
10 Champion seen tottering outside retro bar (7)
11 Wanting new cultural fair (7)
12 Aristocrat welcoming a British billionaire (5)
13 Desiring hot girl in T-shirt (9)
14 Facing a difficult situation at home with a sozzled son on cannabis (2,1,5,4)
18 Very small amount of hard cash found in a tattered shirt (5-7)
21 Most important law announced (9)
23 Screw in beam is eroded (5)
24 One who helps in a venture on hill (7)
25 Ecstatic with grand success, breaking record (7)
26 Stud picking up model is Polish officer (6)
27 Dear me! Worried after street gets flooded (8)

Down

1 Environmentalist beginning to embrace English writer (6)
2 Young socialite entering popular bar is owing money (2,4)
3 Most basic details of babe cavorting with Senhor when husband's away (4,5)
4 Top actress performed before opening game watched by many (9,5)
6 Associate enthralled by hash dances and laughs (2-3)
7 Native American huts in hamlet on island in a higher position on top of slope (8)
8 Assign escort to entertain European member (8)
9 Understanding result of opening curtain in the morning (6,8)
15 Tribal emblem and mysterious tome found in abandoned plot on base (5,4)
16 Start to help after wife slipped - has lip and neck injury (8)
17 Earnest model dieting after gaining pounds (8)
19 Mouth-like opening is unusually moist, filled with pus essentially (6)
20 Hard after fellow becomes passionless (6)
22 Short surplice of Catholic, dressed to a T (5)

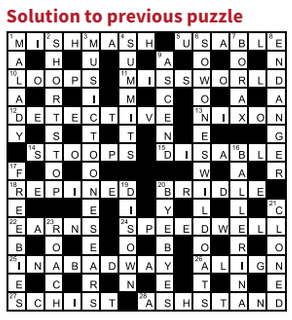
SUDOKU

8				1		5		
			3	8	5		9	
							7	3
	8		2	5	9		1	
	9		8	6	1		5	
7	2							
	5		6	3	2			
		6		9				8

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★☆☆

No.SS7018 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

6	8	3	9	2	1	7	5	4
5	7	2	4	3	6	8	9	1
9	4	1	5	8	7	2	3	6
8	1	5	6	9	4	3	2	7
3	6	9	2	7	8	4	1	5
7	2	4	1	5	3	9	6	8
1	3	6	7	4	2	5	8	9
4	5	8	3	1	9	6	7	2
2	9	7	8	6	5	1	4	3

FAITH

Siva Maha Puranam

What are puranas? Not clearly understood by many, they are loosely translated as mythology, legend, history, literature, culture, tradition, etc. History records events of a geographical location but mythology records the impact, the emotions of the people of a particular area and location. In other words, it reflects what occurred eons ago, with lessons to be derived from the learning of the same by successive generations. Introspecting and processing such knowledge is the stepping stone to attaining gnana, said Dr. Sudha Seshayyan.

Siva Maha Puranam is one such work, which explains the emergence of the Supreme Being (Paramporul) with the well-known story of the contest between Vishnu and Brahma, but with a difference. Popular versions say Brahma and Vishnu argued as to who was greater of the two, when a spectacular light shone, the head and tail of which was unfathomable. Brahma took the form of a swan, flew high to find the head of the source of light, while Vishnu took the form of a boar and plumbed the depths to find the end. Vishnu returned without finding the end. Brahma meanwhile came across a flower falling from the top and when it said it was coming from the head of the light, Brahma persuaded it to falsely certify that he had seen the head himself. For this lie, Brahma lost his fifth head. Scholars say this is a parable, showing the lack of development of knowledge into gnana. Siva Maha Puranam states that when the light emerged, both Brahma and Vishnu stood at attention, meditating on it for many years. Then they heard a huge noise. It was the emergence of light. The Siva lingam appeared, in the form devotees worship.

INBRIEF

Essar comes back in steel with $18 bn U.S. manufacturing bet

Essar Group is making a major comeback in the steel sector, announcing an $18 billion investment in the U.S. to build a fully integrated steel manufacturing plant through its American arm Mesabi Metallics. The project, described by Essar as the largest single-location investment in an integrated steel complex in U.S. history, marks a significant return to the steel business for the Ruias after the group exited its flagship Essar Steel India business via IBC process in 2019. U.S. President Donald Trump announced on Monday that Mesabi Metallics would develop a fully integrated American steel company. The investment includes a proposed $15 billion integrated steel complex in Iowa, along with the existing $3 billion investment in an iron ore mine and pelletising facility in Minnesota.

NCLAT notice to creditors on Subhash Chandra's Plea

The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) on Tuesday issued notices to creditors on a plea filed by Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra and scheduled the matter for hearing on October 29 and 30. Mr. Chandra had challenged before the appellate tribunal an order passed on September 1 by a five-member larger bench of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), which had stayed the order of a third tie-breaker judge in his personal insolvency matter and restrained him from alienating his assets. The NCLAT has directed the creditors, who opposed the maintainability of Mr. Chandra's petition, among others, to file their reply within a week. A three-member bench of NCLAT also granted a week's time to Subhash Chandra to file a rejoinder to the creditors' reply. "Let the notice be issued... will file the reply (over maintainability and stay) within a week," said the bench. PTI

OpenAI unveils GPT-6.1 Sol and 'Dots' AI agents at DevDay

CEO Sam Altman unveils lower-cost model at the company's conference, as OpenAI showcases always-on AI agents powered by GPT-6 Astra

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

Cost and capability: OpenAI CEO Sam Altman unveiled GPT-6.1 Sol at the company's DevDay conference on Tuesday. AP

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman on Tuesday unveiled GPT-6.1 Sol at the company's DevDay conference in San Francisco, positioning it as a lower-cost model that delivers "very near-Astra-level intelligence at a fifth of the price" for coding and building.

Mr. Altman said the model offers a balance of cost and capability and would make it cheaper for agents to reuse context, iterate on solutions and work through longer tasks.

He said Sol was "smarter than Astra in some ways" and would become a "daily workhorse".

OpenAI's developer documentation says GPT-6.1 Sol is designed to offer a trade-off between capability and cost. The model is priced at $2 per million input tokens and $10 per million output tokens, while supporting reasoning levels from low to maximum. It has a 1.05-million-token context window and can generate up to 1,28,000 tokens in a response. The model supports tools including web search, file search, code interpretation, hosted shell, computer use, image generation, skills and Model Context Protocol (MCP). It can be accessed through OpenAI's Responses API, with function calling and structured outputs also supported. OpenAI also launched UltraFast across its API, ChatGPT and Codex. Mr. Altman said it can reach 300 tokens a second, with eight times the speed and six times the price of the standard offering. UltraFast is available with Astra and will soon be offered with GPT-6.1 Sol.

At DevDay, OpenAI also showcased Dots, always-on AI agents powered by GPT-6 Astra. The company says Dots have their own cloud computers, can connect to more than 4,000 applications, and can work across multiple projects without requiring users to direct every step. They can be accessed through ChatGPT, Slack and Microsoft Teams. OpenAI is also beginning enterprise pilots of specialist Dots, which can have their own identities, credentials and access to company systems to perform defined responsibilities. The company said it is working with Microsoft to integrate the agents with governance and security controls in Agent 365.

The announcements come a day after OpenAI confirmed that it had shelved GPT-6.1 Astra, which had been planned for an October release.

In his closing remarks, Mr. Altman said he found the description of AI as a new industrial revolution "quite off-putting", arguing that its best version should not be about making people "cogs in a giant machine". Some parts of life, he said, "cannot and should not" be automated. If developed correctly, he said, AI could instead usher in "a new renaissance", giving people more power over their own lives and more tools to create, learn, discover and expand knowledge.

Tata Trusts within right to seek merger, but Tata Sons can challenge, says lawyer

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Tata Trusts' proposal to merge two operating companies of the Tata Group – Tata Electronics Systems Solutions Private Ltd and Tata Consulting Engineers – with Tata Sons to avoid a listing could trigger a governance and legal battle if the holding company's board refuses to approve it, according to legal experts.

"Tata Sons can legally challenge such a direction if what is asserted goes beyond the rights conferred under the Articles [of Association] or the Companies Act," said Sooraj Sharma, Partner at Clavius Legal.

However, he added that if Tata Trusts has only placed a proposal before the board, "there may presently be nothing to challenge."

A legal dispute would arise only if either side claims governance powers that the other disputes. For instance, if Tata Trusts asserts that the board is bound to implement the restructuring regardless of its statutory decision-making process, Tata Sons could contest that position.

"Any such dispute would primarily depend on the interpretation of Tata Sons' Articles, the respective powers of shareholders and the board, rights of Trust-nominated directors, and directors' statutory duties," Mr. Sharma said. Depending on the nature of the claim, proceedings before the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) could follow, he added.

A view of Bombay House, the headquarters of the Tata Group

On whether Tata Trusts has the right to propose such restructuring, Mr. Sharma said "as the controlling shareholder, Tata Trusts is entitled to propose restructuring and exercise shareholder and governance rights available under the Companies Act, 2013 and Tata Sons' Articles of Association."

However, he clarified that Tata Trusts has sought the board's approval rather than issuing a binding directive.

Section 179(3)(i) of the Companies Act requires the board to approve amalgamation, merger or reconstruction proposals through a resolution. That power, however, remains subject to the Act and the company's Articles, according to him.

Tata Sons' Articles provide Tata Trusts with significant governance rights, including nomination rights under Article 104B and affirmative voting provisions under Article 121.

"In Tata Consultancy Services Ltd. v. Cyrus Investments Pvt. Ltd. (2021), the Supreme Court described Article 121 as conferring a limited right regarding the manner in which matters before the board are decided," Mr. Sharma said.

Therefore, while Tata Trusts cannot replace the board's decision-making role, the board must also operate within the governance framework laid out in the Articles. Trust-nominated directors, meanwhile, remain bound by their statutory duties, including exercising independent judgment under Section 166 of the Companies Act.

If Tata Sons challenges the proposal, the restructuring process could become prolonged. Any merger would still require multiple approvals, including board approval, member and creditor approvals under Sections 230-232 of the Companies Act; NCLT sanction; and regulatory clearance, including from the Reserve Bank of India where applicable.

The proposed restructuring aims to ensure that the reorganised Tata Sons no longer falls under the NBFC/Core Investment Company (CIC) framework. However, whether that objective is achieved would depend on the final structure and RBI's regulatory assessment, not on a unilateral decision by either Tata Trusts or Tata Sons, Mr. Sharma said.

Missing India means missing large chunk of 21st century: Muniz

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Manuel Muñiz

If firms miss India in terms of investments, they will miss a large chunk of the 21st century, former Secretary of State for Global Spain in the Spanish Ministry of Foreign Affairs, European Union (EU) and Cooperation Manuel Muñiz said in an interview.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Muñiz, also Rector, IE University in Madrid, added while the India-EU trade deal was likely to double trade about half of this rise would be in services, which reflects the maturity of the partnership.

The India-EU Free Trade Agreement is likely to be signed in December and implemented in early 2027 once the European Parliament passed it.

Services also gain

"I think it is a strategic deal, it will double trade," Mr. Muñiz said. "Within that doubling, about half of that trade will be in services, telling you of sophistication of the relationship."

"And I think the impact on technology is going to be very big as both actors bring very valuable things in technology and innovation supply chain to the table and that will now be enhanced by the agreement."

On whether EU firms would invest in India even as the FTA lacked a chapter on investments, Mr. Muñiz said he thought "there was an immense case for that."

The reason for this were projections for the next 50 years show the four largest economies by a large margin would be the U.S., China, India, and the EU.

He went on to say that India and the EU had real synergies in technology.

"India is clearly very strong on human-capital component of technology," Mr. Muñiz said. "A lot of strong STEM profiles are being trained and coming out of India. I think they would benefit from this agreement as they are going to find a larger market in Europe and the trade will also increase."

He added there was also growing entrepreneurship in India that would benefit from clearer and cleaner access to EU markets, which will give start-ups and others more scalability and easier access.

He also said the EU offered India several benefits in addition to being one of the largest consumer markets in the world.

"We have a world-class research ecosystem built by universities like IE but also many, many others working on technology innovation and transfer," he said. "And we have a lot of regulatory expertise and a large public sector that is a big consumer of technology and innovation."

"I think that might be of interest to Indian technology companies and Indian entrepreneurs," he added.

ZEISS Group sees India's arduous operating terrain as global test lab

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

India's extreme operating conditions – from high humidity and intense heat to power fluctuations – are emerging as a real-world testing ground for technologies meant for some of the world's most demanding industries, said Andreas Pecher, president and CEO, ZEISS Group.

"Systems, devices and technologies capable of withstanding rigorous conditions in India will be robust enough to be exported globally for high-stakes sectors such as aerospace, maritime defence and heavy manufacturing," Mr. Pecher told *The Hindu* in an exclusive interview.

The German technology company. which designs and manufactures high-precision medical devices, opto-electronic systems and advanced optical solutions, is looking at India as a source of globally-scalable innovation.

Harsh-environment optics

A key focus area under the initiative is harsh-environment optics– optical systems designed to deliver precision performance despite exposure to heat, dust, vibration and corrosive environments. Such technologies are increasingly critical in industrial quality assurance, manufacturing inspection and field applications.

India's challenging environment provides a unique opportunity to develop solutions that are locally relevant but globally applicable, Mr. Pecher said. Technologies emerging from areas such as frugal engineering, robotics and advanced optics could eventually be integrated into ZEISS's global operations across more than 50 countries.

The company believes India's cost-conscious innovation ecosystem can help redesign product architectures without compromising precision or reliability.

ZEISS reported a revenue of about €12 billion in September 2025 and invests almost 15% of annual revenue in research and development. It recently-unveiled a innovation hub at IIT Madras, which could be the critical link between research and commercial applications.

"Successful technologies developed via the collaboration could enter ZEISS' global product development pipeline," he added.

ମୁଖ୍ୟ ନିର୍ମାଣ ଯନ୍ତ୍ରୀଙ୍କ କାର୍ଯ୍ୟାଳୟ
ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ନିର୍ମାଣ ମଣ୍ଡଳ, ବ୍ରହ୍ମପୁର
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po :- Ambapua, Near Income Tax Office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
(E-Mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com; Tel No.:-0680-2404287)

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement E-Mail/ E-despatch
Bid Identification No. Online Tender/22-2026-27/BPR

Identification No.	Name of work	No. of Works	Approx. Estimated Cost (In lakh)	Class of Contractor	Period of Completion
Online Tender / 22 - 2026-27/ BPR	Buildings Works	12 Nos.	From Rs.140.02 to Rs.141.26 Lakhs	"B" Class & "A" Class as applicable	Period of Completion as provided as per Col.No.5 of Annexure of NIT

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender online for bidding	
		From	To
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Berhampur.	Online Tender / 22-2026-27/BPR	30.10.2026 at 10.00 A.M.	16.11.2026 upto 5.30 P.M.

(i) EMD / Bid Security, Cost of Bid document is to be transferred through Online as per the procedure mentioned in the DTCN.
(ii) Non-submission of the information/documents through online by the bidder as per the items mentioned in the eligible criteria of the DTCN will also liable for rejection of his tender.
Further details & Corrigendum if any can be seen from the website: - www.tendersodisha.gov.in
25001/1227/2627
Chief Engineer, R.W.Circle, Berhampur
OIPR-25001/25071/1/26-27/0036

OREDA LIMITED
(Formerly known as Odisha Renewable Energy Development Agency)
(Under Department of Energy, Government of Odisha)
CIN : U35105OD2024SGC045786
Corrigendum
Notice No : 4019 / OREDA Ltd. PD-140 /2026
Date : 23/09/2026
Corrigendum/ addendum is issued with necessary amendments and change in schedule of events for the e-tender notice no-3250/OREDA Ltd., dated 05.09.2026; for Engagement of Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) for supply of Solar PV system components and Discovery of Indicative Supply & Transportation rates for renewable Energy Projects under OREDA Ltd.

Sl. No.	Name of Event	Date and Time	Revised Date and Time
1.	Date of publication of RFE on E-procurement website and OREDA website	05.09.2026	05.09.2026
2.	Due date of pre-bid query submission as per format of NIT	09.09.2026, Time : 5.00 PM	09.09.2026, Time : 5.00 PM
3.	Due date and time for submission of online copy of Technical Bid	21.09.2026, Time : 5.00 PM	28.09.2026, Time : 5.00 PM
4.	Due date and time for submission of hard copies of Technical Bid for select Bid Forms only.	24.09.2026, Time : 5.00 PM	01.10.2026, Time : 5.00 PM
5.	Tentative date and time for the opening of Technical Bid for both online copies and hard copies	25.09.2026, Time : 3.00 PM	03.10.2026, Time : 3.00 PM

Details can be seen from the website www.tenderwizard.com/OREDA or www.oredaorissa.com. Further corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded in these websites only.
28001/29/2627
Sd/- Chief Executive Officer
OIPR-28001/28005/1/26-27/0008

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE : SUNDARAGADA
AT/PO-SANKARA, SUNDARGARH-770020, E-mail address-serw_sundargarh@yahoo.com
No.Tender Online – RWCCESNG–29 of 2026-27, Letter No.5370/ Dtd.28.09.2026
e-Procurement NOTICE

1. Type of the Work : Roads (MMSY)
2. Class of Contractor : As specified in the column-6 of the Annexure
3. Time of Completion : As specified in the column-5 of the Annexure
4. Detail Projects : As per Annexure attached
5. Estimated Cost : As specified in the column-4 of the Annexure
6. Other details:

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of Seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of tender	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada	RWCCESNG-29 of 2026-27	06.10.2026 11:00 AM	26.10.2026 5:00 PM	23.10.2026 5:00 PM	27.10.2026 11:00 AM	Will be intimated separately

● Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in
25001/1219/2627
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sundaragada.
OIPR-25001/25133/1/26-27/0044

GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH
LAW (LA & J SCF) DEPARTMENT
NOTIFICATION No.364/2026-RC

1. This Notification is issued for Ten (10) posts in the cadre of District Judge (Entry Level) under Direct Recruitment.
2. This Notification is issued in terms of the orders of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in Civil Appeal No. 1867 of 2006, dated 04.01.2007.
3. Applications are invited for recruitment of Ten (10) posts of District Judge (Entry Level) under 25% quota under Direct Recruitment in the A.P. State Judicial (Service and Cadre) Rules, 2026.

Class/ Category & Number of Posts:
OC-02, Economically Weaker Section (EWS) - 02 (of which 01 post for woman), BC-B-01, BC-C-01, BC-E-01, SC (Group-III)-01, ST-02 (of which 01 post for woman).
Total - 10 Posts.

4. Further the details viz., detailed Notification, Pro forma Application and Hall Tickets in original and duplicates are available on the website of High Court of Andhra Pradesh and can be accessed at **"https://aphc.gov.in"** from **30.09.2026** onwards.
5. Filled-in applications in prescribed pro forma together with enclosures of the candidates should be submitted in the office of the **Registrar (Recruitment), High Court of Andhra Pradesh at Amaravati, Nelapadu, Guntur District-522239, on or before 15-10-2026 by 5.00 P.M.**

Dated: 30-09-2026
DIPR 21598/CL, Dt: 29/09/2026
G. SAI PRASAD
CHIEF SECRETARY TO GOVERNMENT

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
S.V. Gosamrakshana Shala, Tirupati. e-TENDER NOTICE
NIT No. TTD-30/59/2026-SV GOSHALA Dt:26.09.2026
e-Tenders are invited for procurement of Maize Jowar Silage for a period one year for S.V.Gosamrakshana Shala,TTD, Tirupati. **Download START DATE 29-09-2026 from 2.00 PM and LAST DATE for submission of tender is 08-10-2026 up to 11.30 AM.**
For further details contact Mobile No.:**9281413626.**
TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.197) Dt:29-09-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

RAJASTHAN RAJYA VIDYUT PRASARAN NIGAM LIMITED
NOTICE INVITING e-BIDs
Online E-Bids are invited from interested bidders for Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Class 0.02S Meter Test Bench (20 Meters) with Online UPS (BN-9015002606, UBN- VPN2627GLOB01444).
The detailed NIB and Bid document /specification are available for viewing/downloading on the website **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in.** Details of NIB are available on website **energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rrvpn.**
Any extension in bid submission/opening date (if any) will be floated/uploaded on **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in & energy.rajasthan.gov.in/rrvpn** only.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10878 R.R.V.P.N./TR-7808/2026 Superintending Engineer (Proc-I)

JAIPUR DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Indra Circle, Jawahar Lal Nehru Marg, Jaipur - 302004
JDA/EE Zone-10/2026-27/D-721 Date : 28.09.2026
NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No.: EE-10/11/2026-27, Job No. 184/2026-27
Online Bids are invited up-to 06:00 PM of 21.10.2026 for **"Miscellaneous road repair works at various streches and Rehabilitation of Bhadadeh Puliya in Jaisinghpura Khor, Zone-10, JDA Jaipur".** The last date for Applying Bid and making online payment on JDA portal is up-to 06:00 PM of 21.10.2026. The estimated cost of NIB is Rs. 353.52 lacs. Details may be seen in the Bidding Document at our office or the State Public Procurement Portal website www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda
UBN No.: JDA2627WSOB00328
To participate in the bid, bidder must:
A. Participate in Tender & Deposit Payment on 'Online Tender Participation' Portal of JDA at https://jda.rajasthan.gov.in/jda or by Single-Sign-On at http://service.jaipurjda.org.
B. Submit e-Bid on 'e-Procurement Portal' of GOR at www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in
Raj.Samwad/C/26/10870 **Executive Engineer (Zone-10)**

TEHRAN

Iran threatens new strikes as it awaits U.S. reply to Hormuz plan

AP

Iran threatened on Tuesday to attack infrastructure around the West Asia, intensifying its rhetoric as it awaits a formal response from Washington on a new plan to reopen the Strait of Hormuz. U.S. President Donald Trump has already dismissed the proposal, but Iran's Foreign Minister said he was expecting a formal response. AFP

CASABLANCA

Morocco's King appoints country's first woman PM following election

AFP

King Mohammed VI appointed Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri on Tuesday as Morocco's first woman Prime Minister after her liberal-centrist party came out on top in a September 23 parliamentary election, the royal palace said. The King asked El Mansouri to form a new government, the palace said. REUTERS

BANGKOK

U.S. arms sales to island remain unchanged, says Taiwan Minister

REUTERS

Taiwan's Defence Minister Wellington Koo said on Tuesday that existing U.S. arms sales to Taiwan remain unchanged, and that Taipei remains in talks with the U.S. over individual deals. A record $14 billion arms package, however, remains stalled. Analysts said they expect U.S. arms sales to continue despite China's pressure. AP

JALUD

Settler attack on West Bank village injures Israeli forces, drawing flak

REUTERS

More than 100 Israeli settlers attacked the Palestinian village of Jalud in the occupied West Bank early Tuesday, drawing rare Israeli government condemnation after they injured three members of the security forces. The military said the settlers had blocked roads, set tyres on fire and thrown rocks at security forces. AFP

'U.K. should consider options for EU ties'

'I cannot say to you truthfully, that where we are is good enough. Brexit has done more harm than good,' said the British Prime Minister while addressing the Labour Party's annual conference; he blamed Brexit for a loss in control over immigration and undocumented border crossings

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

U.K. Prime Minister Andy Burnham has said he would lay out options the country had in terms of its long-term future with the bloc, in the coming weeks, as he argued that Britain's exit from the EU (Brexit) in 2016 had caused more harm than good. The move is significant as it could potentially open the door to a full-scale reconsideration of whether to reverse Brexit.

"I cannot say to you truthfully, that where we are is good enough," Mr. Burnham said, adding: "Brexit has done more harm than good." He was addressing the Labour Party's annual conference in Liverpool, his first as the party's leader.

Mr. Burnham said the U.K. needed higher growth, as he promised to share the various options that Britain had in terms of its long-term relationship with the EU, ahead of a U.K.-EU summit later this year. He blamed Brexit for a loss in control over immigration and undocumented border crossings (i.e., via the English Channel on small boats), while emphasizing that net migration was down more than 80% since its peak during the Boris Johnson administration.

Labour is split on how much integration the U.K. should seek with the EU following Brexit. London Mayor Sadiq Khan, who is now also now a member of the U.K. House of Lords, had said Labour should put rejoining the EU on its election manifesto for 2029.

Others, such as Britain's Trade Minister Jonathan Reynolds, have taken a more cautious approach. He warned on Sunday the "constitutional questions" raised by Britain's relationship with the EU were causing uncertainty for businesses, as per a report in *Politico*.

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham on stage at the Labour Party's annual conference in Liverpool, Britain, on Tuesday. REUTERS

During his remarks, Mr. Burnham pushed back against calls for independence by the 'nations' (i.e., Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland) of the U.K. Referring to the comment by Scottish First Minister John Swinney that he (Mr. Burnham) would be the "last" Prime Minister of the U.K., Mr. Burnham said: "Not the last Prime Minister of the United Kingdom, rather the first to rewire it to make it work for all people and places."

Mr. Burnham emphasized his desire to take power from Whitehall (the nerve centre of British bureaucracy in London) and distribute it across the nations and regions of the U.K.

G20 agenda

The Prime Minister said AI would be "centre stage" in the U.K.'s G20 agenda in 2027 when it holds the group's presidency.

The focus would be twofold; harnessing the benefits of AI while also focusing on safety. The Prime Minister's remarks come as leading AI companies and voices have warned that AI could be out of human control in the next few years, with an increasing number of reports of AI breaching secure systems.

Mr. Burnham also pushed for electoral reform in the U.K., as he announced the setting up of a cross-party national commission on electoral reform. "We will all have failed in our public duties if we carry on as we are and open the door of Number 10 to a divisive government on less than 30% of the vote or less," he said.

While he did not explicitly mention proportional representation (PR) in his speech, Mr. Burnham has, for some years now, backed the idea of doing away with Britain's first-past-the-post system to PR.

The bulks of Mr. Burnham's speech was focused on domestic priorities. These included greater public control of Britain's water utilities; being "more pragmatic" about the U.K.'s oil in the North Sea; changes to the U.K.'s pension system; creating a social care service comparable to the National Health Service (NHS) and creating parity between vocational training and academic qualifications in the education system.

Russia's missile and jet-propelled drone blitz hammers Kyiv

Associated Press
KYIV

Andrii Sybiha

Russia fired ballistic missiles and dozens of jet-powered drones at Kyiv, Ukraine's air force said on Tuesday, as Moscow seeks to make Ukraine buckle under the pressure of day-and-night bombardment of its capital and other cities.

The Russian onslaught has used new jet-powered drones that fly too fast and too high for Ukrainian ground-based air defences to shoot down.

Ukraine is scrambling to keep pace by developing faster interceptor drones, in the latest example of how the war has driven military innovation, but making and deploying new weapons takes months.

Russia's ballistic missiles have also got through as Ukraine is desperately short of U.S.-made Patriot air defence interceptor missiles, which are the only reliable way of stopping Moscow's ballistic attacks.

Patriot stockpiles are low, largely because of the Iran war, and Ukraine has received only small numbers of them this year despite President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's pleading.

"Russia's terror against Ukraine is intensifying by the day," Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said on X. "This is Russia's deliberate escalation instead of accepting Ukraine's offers to end the war."

Trump 'surprised' U.K. airbase terror suspects out on bail, praises officials for 'working with U.S.'

Sriram Lakshman
LONDON

U.S. President Donald Trump has said he was "surprised" that the suspects arrested in connection with an alleged plot at U.K. airbase RAF Fairford, in Gloucestershire, were released on bail on Monday.

Five British nationals, all men in their twenties, were arrested on Sunday after Gloucestershire police received a call at 4 a.m. on Sunday morning, about three suspicious vehicles near the base, which is used by U.S. forces to conduct strikes on Iran.

"I'm surprised that they released them," Mr. Trump told reporters, even as he praised the U.K. authorities for working "very closely" with the U.S.

"We know everything about them; we would not have released them," he added.

Asked if the incident was connected to Iran, Mr. Trump said it "might be", later saying he knows the answer (to who is involved) but would rather not say.

Donald Trump

A foreign actor was "clearly involved" in the incident, U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio said.

The Iranian Embassy in London "categorically" rejected the notion that it was planning an attack on the airbase.

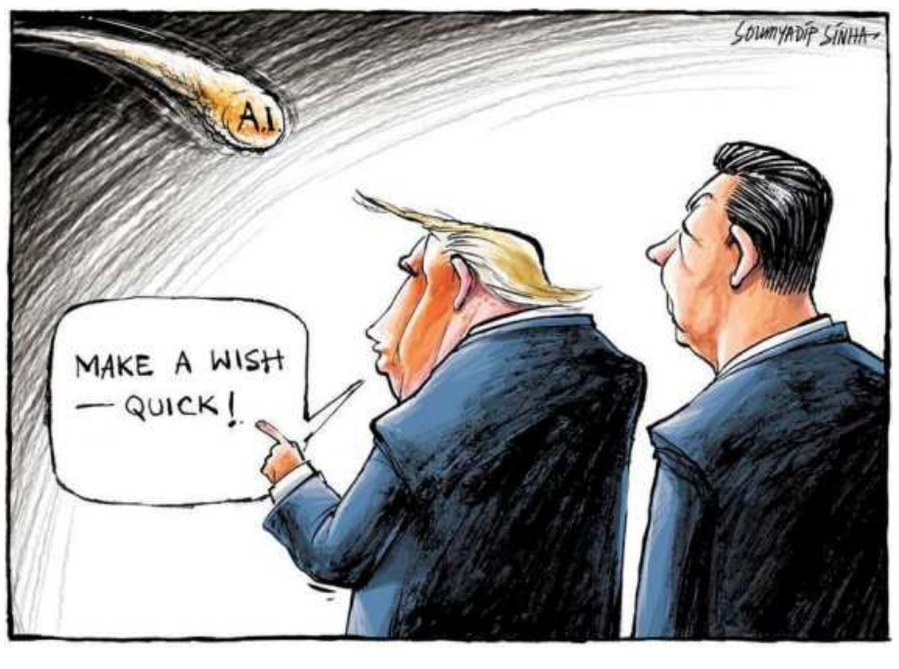
The men, who were arrested first under the Explosives Act and then under the Terrorism Act, still continue to be suspects, Lawrence Taylor, head of U.K. Counterterrorism Policing, said.

The suspects were released subject to conditions on their movement and contacts with others, he added. According to Mr. Taylor, the police were also considering the possibility that the activity might have been undertaken by "proxies", acting knowingly or unknowingly on behalf of a foreign state.

Deputy leader of Labour, Lucy Powell, pushed back against comments from across the Atlantic, saying on Tuesday that she trusted the police regarding decisions on bail. In the U.K., suspects can be released on 'police bail' before they are charged.

Residents of Whelford village which was evacuated on Sunday morning were told they could return home on Monday.

On the draw



Amid stalemate, Trump seeks to bring Iran nuclear file back on the table

NEWS ANALYSIS

Stanly Johny

"I have a big decision to make. Will a deal be made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before? Or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic? Do I drive them into hell with no chance of survival and no hope of future greatness?" U.S. President Donald Trump said in his UN General Assembly address on September 22. "I believe we'll make a deal right after the [midterm] election because it doesn't make sense for them not to," he added. In the speech, in which Mr. Trump vigorously defended his performance as the President of the U.S., there were 10 references to Iran's nuclear programme, which he claimed the U.S. had obliterated after its June 2025 bombing. "I will never allow Iran to have a nuclear weapon," he said. Iran has an advanced nuclear programme but has repeatedly said that it was not seeking to build nuclear weapons.

Changing approach

Mr. Trump's speech signalled a change in the approach of the administration towards the Iran conflict. In June, when the U.S. signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Iran, Washington agreed to make concessions in return for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, while the nuclear talks were pushed to the back burner.

But now, as the stalemate continues, the U.S. seeks to bring the nuclear file back into the negotiations.

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian and Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi were also in New York to attend the UNGA. On the sidelines of the assembly, Mr. Araghchi held indirect talks with U.S. officials, seeking to find a way out of the current impasse.

Tehran submitted a seven-point proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz in return for the U.S. lifting its naval blockade on Iranian ports, issuing sanctions waivers and releasing Iran's frozen funds.

In effect, Iran wants the U.S. to return to the June 17 MoU. While Iran's demands remained unchanged, it offered to fast-track the timeline. If the MoU had promised to reopen the Strait of Hormuz in 30 days, Iran now promises to reopen the waterway, which it blockaded in the initial days of the war, in seven days. But Mr. Trump said he rejected the Iranian offer. Iran, according to Omani Foreign Minister Badr bin Hamad, was ready to make concessions on its nuclear programme on February 27 to avoid war.

Iranian-made Zolfaghar missiles put on display beside a portrait of Mojtaba Khamenei at Baharestan Square in Tehran. AFP

But Mr. Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu chose not to take the deal and started bombing Iran on February 28, killing its Supreme Leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. The war appears to have hardened Iran's position on the nuclear question.

The blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, through which one-fifth of the world's oil and gas moved before the war, provided additional leverage to Tehran. Iran sought to tie the reopening of the strait to concessions from the U.S., while keeping its trump card, the nuclear file, close to its chest.

The U.S. toed this line when it signed the MoU, which was largely seen as favourable to Iran. But after the collapse of the MoU, the U.S. has been trying to rebuild its lost leverage by easing Iran's grip on the strait and adding more pain on Iran through economic squeezing.

Loosening grip

The U.S. attempts to open a safer route along the Omani coast to help tankers get in and out of the Strait of Hormuz have been relatively successful. Whether with Iran's tolerance or not, shipments through the waterway rose to almost 80% of its prewar levels in September.

Before the war, the Gulf region exported nearly 19 million barrels of oil a day through the strait, which fell to a trickle in the first phase of the war, pumping up oil prices. Shipments rose to almost 13 million barrels a day in September, according to ship tracker Huax. While Arab countries, including Iraq, Saudi Arabia and the UAE manage to sell their crude oil out of the strait, Iran's oil exports collapsed as it faces the American blockade in the Gulf of Oman.

As petroleum exports from the Gulf rebound, Mr. Trump believes that Iran is losing its Hormuz leverage. Hence, he insists that the nuclear file be brought back on the table as part of any deal with Iran.

But Iran insists that its core positions have not changed. Even though Mr. Trump said he rejected the Iranian seven-point proposal, Mr. Araghchi said on Tuesday Tehran was expecting an official American response.

Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei, in a statement released on Monday, hailed the "defenders of Hormuz" and added that U.S. forces would be forced out of the Arabian Sea. It is true that Iran is facing the economic heat of the U.S. blockade, but Tehran seems prepared to take the pain and not to submit to U.S. demands. And if Iran believes it is losing its leverage, it could also escalate the crisis militarily.

The Hormuz dilemma

This leaves Mr. Trump in a dilemma. He would like to see whether Iran would buckle under economic pressure. But sooner or later, he would face two key questions: Is the U.S. blockade of Iran, along with its guided assistance to vessels in Hormuz, for which Washington has committed enormous military resources, sustainable in the long term? And what should the U.S. do if Iran refuses to buckle under the economic pressure?

BRIGHT FUTURE

Our performance shows there is no limit to what we can do: Vithya

R.V. MOORTHY

Vithya Ramraj feels that Indian women track and field athletes' performance at the Asian Games has provided hope for the future. "It's for all the women out there. On the track, it's the Indian women who have won more medals. It shows there is no limit to what we can do," Vithya said after winning the 4x400m relay gold.

TARGET ACHIEVED

Winning gold the only motivation for the last three years: Prachi

R.V. MOORTHY

Vithya [Ramraj] and I were part of the team last time and we got a silver. We had spoken about returning only with gold next time. That has been the only motivation for the last three years. This will be an inspiration to us as well as our juniors — India's Prachi Chaudhary after regaining the women's 4x400m relay gold.

FIGHTING TILL THE END

India rallies to beat Qatar, enters quarterfinals with perfect record

FILE PHOTO

The India men's volleyball team bounced back from two sets down to defeat Qatar 3-2 and enter the Asian Games quarterfinals with a perfect record in Nagoya on Tuesday. The Jerome Vinith-led side, which saved multiple match points in the fifth set, won 26-28, 25-27, 25-23, 25-20, 24-22 for its third successive Pool C triumph.

ULTIMATE AIM

Everyone knows which is the biggest medal, says Neeru

PTI

"Both (the World Cup triumph and Asian Games trap gold medal) are equal but everyone knows which is the biggest one. These are only steps leading up to that and I am preparing for that only now — Indian shooter Neeru Dhanda making it clear that her ultimate goal is Olympic glory.

Women's 400m relay quartet to the fore as wait for athletics gold ends

Gulveer becomes the first Indian man to win three individual medals from the track and field in a single edition of the continental event; the men's quartermilers, 4x100m mixed relay team, and high jumper Pooja secure a bronze each on the final day of the competition

Finishing on a high: Kiran, Prachi, Poovamma and Vithya are ecstatic after regaining the 4x400m relay gold. Jaykumar, Manu, Dharamvir and Vishal ended third in the men's 4x400m relay while Gurindervir, Harita, Animesh and Sneha made it to the podium in 4x100m mixed relay. Pooja bagged a bronze with an effort of 1.84m and Gulveer capped a memorable campaign with a bronze in 5,000m. R.V. MOORTHY

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

In the end, it was left to the women, yet again, to spare Indian athletics' blushes.

For a week, the men and women on the track and on the field had come close, only to falter and stumble at the finish line. The threat of ending the Asian Games without a gold medal for the first time in 32 years was getting real with every passing day. Until four women stepped up, in the penultimate event of the Aichi-Nagoya edition at the Paloma Mizuho Athletics Stadium on Tuesday, to regain the top spot that they have traditionally held in the 4x400m relay and had to cede last time around to Bahrain.

Kiran Pahal set the tone to ensure the Indians would not be outrun right at the beginning. M.R. Poovamma, the seniormost in the side, silenced her critics and proved her longevity. Poovamma, who was part of the gold medal-winning quartet in the same discipline in 2014 and 2018, also showed that she deserved her spot with a blazing second leg.

It was Prachi Chaudhary, a member of the silver-winning team last time around, who started the fightback against the insane pace of Bahrain and China, climbing to second place. It was left to Vithya Ramraj, who set a new National record in 400m hurdles the other day and already had a silver in the 4x400m mixed relay, to finish it off and the 28-year-old duly obliged. She first overtook Zuo Siyu on the final bend and then held off the legendary Salwa Eid Naser as the Indians clocked 3:29.69s.

Until then, however, it looked like the final day of athletics competition would end the way it started for India – waiting in vain for the National anthem to play, not for want of effort, though. National record holder Gulveer Singh added a bronze in the 5,000m to his two silvers in 10,000m and 1500m to become the first Indian man to win three individual athletics medals in a single edition of the Asiad.

Gulveer timed 13:32.75, a far cry from his personal best but given the tough, testing conditions, constant downpour over the last few days coupled with his tight schedule here, it was creditable.

The men's quartermilers, defending champions in the 4x400m relay, clocked 3:01.61, Dharamveer Chaudhary, Manu T.S., Jaykumar and Vishal T.K. bringing home bronze while Gurindervir, Sneha, Animesh Kujur and Harita Bhadra improved on their heat timing for a bronze with a season's best of 41.06 in mixed 4x100m relay.

Pooja Singh, the National record holder in high jump, led for a large part before finishing with a bronze (1.84m). Pooja cleared every mark on the first attempt till she attempted 1.87. Pole vaulter Dev Meena finished seventh but managed to set a new National record of 5.50m while Tanya Chaudhary recorded a new personal best of 65.35m on the last attempt to finish fourth in hammer throw.

Mission accomplished: Neeru exults after becoming the first Indian woman to be crowned trap champion in the Asiad. AP

Neeru clinches historic gold in trap shooting

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

It took 10 days and one fearless 26-year-old woman to finally end India's long wait for an individual gold from the Aichi General Shooting Range at the Asian Games on Tuesday. It also ended a 48-year wait for trap shooting gold as Neeru Dhanda stamped her mark on the competition in style.

Neeru shot an Asian record of 28 points out of a maximum 30 to be crowned the champion, the first Indian woman to do so. A few months back, she had become the first Indian woman to win a trap World Cup gold. For an accidental shooter, the Haryana markswoman has made it a habit of breaking new ground. Neeru also became only the second Indian to win a trap gold at the Asiad after former IOA and OCA president Randhir Singh.

Neeru led all the way from start to finish across three days and 155 shots of gruelling competition.

She shot 48 on the first day and 47 on the second to go clear at the top with a two-day total of 95. She managed 118 out of a possible 125, equalling Qatar's Ray Bassil before winning a tense shoot-off. The other two Indians in the fray – Manisha Keer (104) and Ashima Ahlawat (106) – finished way behind but the three together managed 328 for a second consecutive team silver in the event.

Neeru was not to be bothered by either the proceedings of the past nine days or the conditions – wet and windy. She stayed the course, kept hitting the targets and never ceded control, missing just two to go clear of China's Sun Yunong at the top.

The men, however, disappointed with Shapath Bhardwaj finishing eighth in the final and the trio of Shapath, Kynan Chenai and Ahvar Rizvi totalling 339 for sixth spot.

Neeru doffs her hat to cousin Lakshya and armed forces

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

When Lakshya Sheoran won an Asian Games silver in trap at Palembang eight years ago, it was the start of a dream for one girl. Lakshya's cousin Neeru Dhanda, a year younger, was inspired to follow in his footsteps. On Tuesday, she went one better in Aichi, becoming India's first woman and only the second gold medallist in trap.

"I shifted to the MP Shooting Academy in Bhopal in 2019, only months after I had started shooting. Lakshya's parents encouraged me a lot, I started with his father's old gun only," she admitted.

The shooting academy is the brainchild of former MP sports minister Yashodhara Raje Scindia and Neeru acknowledged her contribution. "She is still constantly in touch and sent a message this morning also. She has played a big role in my success," said Neeru.

Neeru... a golden moment. PTI

A naib subedar in the Indian Army, Neeru dedicated her medal to the Indian armed forces and Randhir Singh. "It wasn't easy (winning gold) but I made it easy so that juniors training now and coming up will get the confidence and think if she can do it, anyone can do it."

From shooting with a rusted gun to becoming a World Cup and Asian Games champion, Neeru has come a long way. And she is only starting.

Parveen punches her way past Li; Ankush upsets Erkinboev

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Last year when Parveen Hooda was selected for the World Boxing Cup Finals, the 25-year-old was more than happy to slip under the radar. Returning to national action after almost two years, Parveen was content letting her game speak inside the ring.

She finished with a gold in 60kg and it was clear that the forced time away had done little to blunt the sharpness of her punches. On Tuesday, Parveen became only the third Indian woman boxer to reach the final of the Asian Games, storming past China's Li Shu 5-0 in the semifinal at the Nishio Gymnasium.

Post the World Cup Finals, Parveen missed the bus for the Asian championships and had a forgettable outing at the Commonwealth Games, coming into the Asian Games low on performance and confidence.

Ankush. X@MEDIA_SAI

Her bout against Li, however, was anything but. The youngster played a tactically intelligent game, keeping her distance and being on target with her punches every time she had a chance.

The 2022 Asian champion started tentatively, though, taking the first round narrowly 3-2 before completely dominating the proceedings in the second for a 5-0 verdict. Li tried to close in and cramp her for space in the final round but Parveen managed to score crucial points to win 4-1 and book her final spot.

On the men's side, Ankush Panghal upset reigning 75kg world champion Fazliddin Erkinboev of Uzbekistan 4-1 in the 80kg semifinals, making a remarkable comeback in the last two rounds after trailing in the first.

Ankush lost the first round 1-4 and struggled to connect his punches against his experienced opponent before starting a slow and painful comeback. He won the second round 3-2 before punching his way into the final with a 5-0 third round verdict.

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	143	62	49	254
2	Japan	45	71	67	183
3	South Korea	24	27	44	95
4	Uzbekistan	14	17	13	44
5	Thailand	12	9	12	33
10	**India**	**6**	**21**	**25**	**52**

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Tuesday:

Archery: 1/8 Eliminations: Recurve individual: Men: Dhiraj bt Cheng (Tpe); Neeraj bt Je Deok (Kor); Women: Kumkum bt Saima (Ban); Kirti lost to Kang (Kor).

Athletics: Men (finals): 5000m: Gulveer (bronze); 4x400m relay: Bronze; Pole vault: Dev (seventh), Kuldeep (10th); 800m: Afsal (eighth). Women (finals): 4x400m relay: Gold; High jump: Pooja Singh (bronze), Supriya (12th); Hammer throw: Tanya (fourth), Anushka (fifth); 800m: Pooja Olla (seventh). Mixed 4x100m relay final: Bronze.

Boxing: Semifinals: Women's 65kg: Parveen bt Shu (Chn); Men's 80kg: Ankush bt Erkinboev (Uzb); Men's +90kg: Narender lost to Oralbay (Kaz), bagged bronze.

Shooting: Trap: Individual final: Women: Neeru (gold); Men: Shapath (eighth); Team final: Women: Silver (Neeru, Manisha, Aashima); Men: Sixth (Shapath, Kynan, Ahvar).

Squash: Women's team (Pool C): bt Iran 3-0.

Tennis: Second round: Men: Dhakshineswar bt Gunawan (Ina) 7-5, 7-6(2); Nagal bt Hong (Kor) 6-4, 6-0; Doubles: Anirudh & Sriram Balaji bt Abhishek & Pradip (Nep) 6-2, 6-1; Yuki & Dhakshineswar bt Yevseyev & Zhukayev (Kaz) 6-1, 7-5. First round: Mixed doubles: Ankita & Sriram Balaji lost to Chong & Thompson (Hkg) 4-6, 4-6.

Plenty to cheer: Manisha, Ashima and Neeru ensured a second consecutive silver for India in the team event. PTI

INDIANS IN ACTION

A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Wednesday (all times IST):

Archery: Compound: Women's team semifinal: vs. South Korea (5.55 a.m.); Medal matches (6.25 a.m. onwards); Mixed team semifinal: vs. Thailand (7.55 a.m.); Medal matches (8.50 a.m. onwards); Men's team semifinal: vs. South Korea (10.55 a.m.); Medal matches (11.25 a.m. onwards).

Boxing: Semifinals: Women: 60kg: Priya vs. Chengyu (Chn), 10.15 a.m.; 75kg: Lovlina vs. Bogdanova (Kaz), 10.45 a.m.; Men: 90kg: Kapil vs. Khabibullaev (Uzb), noon.

Hockey: Women (semifinal): vs. South Korea, 3.30 p.m.

Shooting: 25m rapid fire pistol men's individual qualification (stage 1) — Anish, 6.10 a.m.; Trap mixed team qualification (Neeru and Kynan), 6.30 a.m.; final, 11 a.m.

Squash: Quarterfinals: Women's team: vs. Singapore, 6.30 a.m.; Men's team: vs. Kuwait, 11 a.m.

Tennis: Men: Third round: Dhakshineswar vs. Chun-hsin (Tpe), noon; Nagal vs. Fomin (Uzb), not before 1 p.m.; Doubles (quarterfinals): Anirudh & Sriram Balaji vs. Fumin & Tianhui (Chn), 2 p.m.; Yuki & Dhakshineswar vs. Chenjui vs. Yu-hsiou (Tpe), not before 1.30 p.m.; Mixed doubles (second round): Rutuja & Yuki vs. Su-wei & Chun-hsin (Tpe), not before 4.30 p.m.

Wrestling: Women's 68kg (1/8 finals): Nisha vs. Sol-gum (PRK), 7.20 a.m.; Men's Greco-Roman 87kg (1/4 finals): Sunil vs. TBC, 7.45 a.m.

INBRIEF

Italy routs Turkiye, France wins late against Belgium

Italy crushed Turkiye 4-1 in the Bursa rain to drag itself into contention in Nations League Group A1, as leader France struck late to win 1-0 in Belgium on Monday.

Important results: League A: Group 1: Belgium 0 lost to France 1 (Olise 88); Turkiye 1 (Yilmaz 47) lost to Italy 4 (Bastoni 9, Frattesi 22, Kayode 27, Esposito 50).

Brazil comes from behind to beat Australia in friendly

Brazil came from behind to beat a gallant Australia 4-2 in an entertaining friendly in front of over 52,000 fans in Brisbane on Tuesday.

The result: Australia 2 (Alessandro Circati 28, Connor Metcalfe 33) lost to Brazil 4 (Vanderson 3, Raphinha 45-pen, Guimaraes 69, Vinicius Junior 80-pen).

Shree Charani achieves highest-ever rating points

India's Shree Charani has achieved the highest-ever rating points in the ICC women's T20I bowling rankings after her impressive performances in recent tournaments. The left-arm spinner, who is already the top-ranked T20I bowler, reached a record rating of 817 points, surpassing the previous best mark of 806 held by Australia's Megan Schutt since November 2018.

India-A batters impress on first day of women's 'Test'

Half-centuries from Tanisha Singh (92), Niki Prasad (78 batting), and Shubha Satheesh (59) helped India-A to 351 for nine at stumps on the first day of their one-off women's 'Test' against Australia-A at Mohali on Tuesday.

The scores: India-A 351/9 in 100 overs (Shubha Satheesh 59, Tanisha Singh 92, Niki Prasad 78 batting; Charli Knott 3/82) vs. Australia-A.

Mohit likely to be CSK bowling coach for 2027

Mohit Sharma is likely to join Chennai Super Kings (CSK) as bowling coach for the 2027 season. The 38-year-old former India medium-pacer retired from all forms of the game late last year. He represented CSK as a player for four years. The Haryana cricketer will be the first support staff to join Super Kings under new head coach Zaheer Khan. Mohit played 26 ODIs and eight T20Is.

Prem Khandle emerges overall winner

Prem Khandle, *right in pic.*, emerged overall winner in the FIM Moto Mini India Series in Bengaluru recently. Rian Sarath, *left in pic.*, finished second while Rithin Sai, hailing from Coimbatore, emerged third.

LIVE TELECAST

India-A vs Australia-A: Second 'Test', Day 2, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

India vs West Indies: Second ODI, Star Sports 2 & JioHotstar, 2 p.m.

South Africa vs Australia: Third ODI, FanCode, 5 p.m.

Asian Games: Sony Sports Ten 2, 5 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Thursday).

Cricket: Asian Games (Men): Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 5.30 a.m. (Thursday).

Ojha to be interim head of selection committee

Press Trust of India
GUWAHATI

Former India left-arm spinner Pragyan Ojha for the time being will be interim head of the four-man selection committee after Ajit Agarkar's departure and is in line to become the next chief selector.

Head coach Gautam Gambhir was seen engaged in a lengthy discussion with the four-member National selection committee on the eve of India's second ODI against the West Indies, here on Tuesday.

The presence of all four selectors during a bilateral series is not commonplace, making their meeting with Gambhir particularly noteworthy ahead of India's upcoming tour of New Zealand.

The selectors need to pick squads for three India-A 'Tests', T20Is and ODIs along with the Test team. With the last ODI slated for November 15 in Tauranga and first Test starting on November 19 in Wellington, some of the key Test players, who are part of the ODI squad, might be released early for training.

On Tuesday, Agarkar, however, was not present as Gambhir held the discussion with Shiv Sundar Das, Ajay Ratra, R.P. Singh and Ojha at the Barsapara Stadium.

India eyes series victory, Windies hope to stay alive

The form of Gill and Kohli augurs well for the host; Kuldeep finding his rhythm is another plus for the Men in Blue; the visitor needs to come up with an improved bowling and fielding display

WI IN INDIA

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
GUWAHATI

Long before Barsapara had floodlights, before the city had learned the vocabulary of international cricket, Guwahati had its gods, its hills, and its river. Kamakhya still looks down from Nilachal, Umananda sits improbably in the Brahmaputra, and the river continues its immense journey past them all. A day of cricket arrives here on Wednesday as India and the West Indies lock horns in the second ODI.

The India-West Indies ODI fixture has twice marked a milestone in Guwahati's cricket history.

In 1983, Nehru Stadium hosted the city's first international match. India had just won the World Cup, but the West Indies was still the game's sovereign. Richie Richardson made his ODI debut that day, entering a cricket world in which Caribbean supremacy remained largely unquestioned.

Thirty-five years later, in 2018, the city had acquired a new home for international cricket. Barsapara, the modern successor, hosted its first ODI. India had become a white-ball powerhouse, and Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli scored centuries as the host chased down 323. The West Indies, once the team everyone else sought to catch, was now trying to keep pace.

In focus: Senior opener Rohit will be keen to produce a big score. RITU RAJ KONWAR

Guwahati is now an IPL venue, another marker of its growing place in Indian cricket. India sits atop the ODI rankings.

The West Indies, however, has missed an automatic spot for the 2027 World Cup and must play the qualifiers for a third successive time. Denied the ideal start in Thiruvananthapuram, it will look to recover here and keep alive its bid to end a 24-year wait for a bilateral ODI series win in India.

There were signs of promise in Thiruvananthapuram. John Campbell and Justin Greaves, the West Indies' fourth different opening combination in its last five ODIs, put together a 135-run stand. Greaves scored his maiden ODI hundred, while Campbell and Amir Jangoo made half-centuries. The bowling and fielding, however, need inspiration.

There is a certain ease to a team that knows where it stands. India seems to have it. Shubman Gill is the world's top-ranked ODI batter and is in sublime form. Kohli looks liberated. There is a new aggression to his batting, an almost extravagant intent. Kuldeep Yadav's return to the playing XI and his rhythm with the ball offered a timely reminder of his quality.

Prasidh Krishna spoke of clarity within the team. India's decision to forgo practice on Tuesday seemed another expression of that assurance.

Match starts at 2 p.m.

Yashbardhan and Ishan bowl India u-19 to a thumping win

YOUTH TEST

Shayan Acharya
RAJKOT

India under-19 captain Yashbardhan Singh Chauhan claimed six wickets as his team registered an innings and 48-run victory over Australia u-19 in the first youth Test at the Niranjan Shah Stadium here on Tuesday.

After Lakshya Raichandani (240, 281b, 24x4, 4x6) and Mohit Ulva (92, 84b, 10x4, 4x6) shared a massive 180-run partnership for the ninth wicket to take India to 494 and a 277-run lead, the Australian batters had little answer to the Indian spinners.

With the temperature soaring, wickets fell in clusters as off-spinner Yashbardhan (six for 75) and left-arm spinner Ishan Om (four for 62) kept the pressure on.

Australia was eventually bowled out for 229, barely an hour after tea on the third day.

The scores: Australia u-19 217 & 229 in 59.4 overs (Neel Patel 41, Blake Cattle 123, Ishan Om 4/62, Yashbardhan Chauhan 6/75) lost to India u-19 494 in 102.3 overs (Lakshya Raichandani 240, Yashbardhan 54, Mohit Ulva 92, Kasey Barton 3/83).
PoM: Lakshya.

Harper showed positive intent from the get-go. CAP

Harper rescues Australia-A

AUS-A IN INDIA

Abhishek Saini
PUDUCHERRY

Sam Harper gave no inkling that he was on Australia-A debut, hit a century in a middle-order riposte, and made sure his team batted out the opening day of the second 'Test' against India-A at the Siechem Cricket Stadium here on Tuesday.

His unbeaten 153-ball 101 (7x4, 3x6) was the lead act: he was involved in an 84-run sixth-wicket stand with Liam Scott and an 89-run seventh-wicket alliance with Todd Murphy, which took Australia-A to 282 for seven at stumps.

Harper and Murphy (33, 91b, 2x4, 1x6) endured an 87-ball spell without a boundary in the final session.

The partnership ended after Anshul Kamboj breached Murphy's gate just five deliveries into the second new ball.

Australia-A's recovery, however, had started in the first session with Nathan McSweeney (34) and Jason Sangha (46, 75b, 6x4, 1x6) rescuing the team with an 81-run association.

But Mulani, who bowled a baffling 14 no balls on the day, got Sangha and McSweeney in successive overs after lunch.

The scores: Australia-A 282/7 in 87 overs (Jason Sangha 46, Sam Harper 101 batting) vs. India-A.
Toss: Australia-A.

MAC stands to be named after Venkataraghavan, Srikkanth, Ashwin

Venkataraghavan.

Srikkanth.

Ashwin.

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Cricket Association will name three stands at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium after former internationals S. Venkataraghavan, K. Srikkanth and R. Ashwin. A decision regarding this was taken at the TNCA's AGM on Sunday.

The unveiling is likely to take place before the venue hosts the Big Bash League's opening fixture between Perth Scorchers and Melbourne Renegades on December 12.

Venkataraghavan played 57 Tests for the country and led it in the first two ODI World Cups (1975, 1979) before becoming a renowned umpire.

Srikkanth was an architect of India's two ODI World Cup triumphs, as a player in 1983 and as the chairman of the selection committee that picked the victorious squad in 2011.

Ashwin, arguably the finest cricketer from TN, is India's second-highest Test wicket-taker with 537 scalps.

The 40-year-old is the only player from the State to have turned out in more than 100 Tests (106) and was part of the 2011 World Cup-winning squad.

Behind the scenes on Salt Lake's status for India's clash with Brazil

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

India's football fans were in for a surprise when five-time World Cup champion Brazil confirmed an international friendly against the Blue Tigers at the Salt Lake Stadium in Kolkata on October 3.

Soon after, a team from the Brazilian Football Confederation (CBF) visited Kolkata, returning unhappy with the pitch condition. Preparations that followed involved the All India Football Federation coordinating with CBF to have turf expert Ivan Nascimento travel from Brazil and stay in Kolkata for a month to ensure the pitch was ready in time.

"Our main goal was to regularise the processes and the soil. We found some unevenness, with waves on the surface, and the grass was very tall," Nascimento said.

"The main changes we had to make were to correct the soil level and make the necessary agronomic adjustments, particularly with the fertilisation.

Picture perfect: The efforts put in by turf expert Nascimento and the local team seems to have paid off. COURTESY: IVAN NASCIMENTO

Once the grass was taken care of, Nascimento's team moved to the next target: design.

"We came from Brazil with two teams, an agronomic team that included me and a team from the stadium department.

"We adjusted the operation day by day, but we also had the support of the local team that already takes care of the lawn and the pitch, which has been fantastic," he said.

Nascimento's work will reach completion in a way that both India and Brazil can train on the main pitch a day before kick-off.

"According to protocol, there will be no separate training pitches.

"Brazil will train on the main pitch before the day of the match, from 4 p.m. to 5 p.m. India will train from 6 p.m. to 7 p.m.," Ivan said.

"So, we have a field that will accommodate both teams' training sessions. We will prepare it for the match and also for the subsequent game against Uruguay on October 6," he added.

SportsMechanics launches AI-driven sporting application

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

SportsMechanics, one of India's pioneers in sports analytics and sports technology, has launched *SportOS*, an AI-driven intelligence layer designed to connect data, video, sporting context and workflows across the sports ecosystem.

The application was launched by J.C.D. Prabhakar, Honourable Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, on Monday.

Speaking at the event, Prabhakar promised to bring the application to the state government's notice and discuss how best to use it to help develop sports in Tamil Nadu.

New venture: J.C.D. Prabhakar launches the app in the presence of D.V. Sundar, Ramakrishnan and K.S. Viswanathan. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

K.S. Viswanathan, MD, Chennai Super Kings, D.V. Sundar, former vice-president, FIDE, and T.J. Srinivasaraj, president, Tamil Nadu Cricket Association (TNCA), were also present.

Founded by Ramakrishnan Subramanian, the company pioneered visual-based coaching, has supported the Indian cricket team, and is celebrating its 20th anniversary.

The challenge

"Twenty years ago, our challenge was to help sport capture and understand data. Today, an enormous amount of data exists around every athlete, team, competition and fan. The challenge now is making sense of it," said Ramakrishnan.

"Over the last 20 years, SportsMechanics has learnt what data to collect, how to collect it, and, most importantly, what to do with it. SportOS brings that experience together with AI to create an intelligence layer that understands the context of sport and helps people make better decisions," he added.

Apart from cricket, *SportsMechanics* has also worked with Indian hockey and supported India's Olympic programmes, supporting athletes and teams across disciplines including weightlifting, boxing, athletics and table tennis in the build-up to the 2012 and 2016 Olympic Games.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA pre-round-robin under-14 tournament, City-II vs. City III (St. Bede's-A); City-V vs. City-VI (St. Bede's-B), 9 a.m.

Akash Deep counts his blessings

The pacer is returning to action for Rest of India against Jammu & Kashmir in the Irani Cup fixture from Thursday after spending seven months on the sidelines due to a stress fracture in his lower back. Having faced numerous hardships in his life, the 29-year-old, who notably finished with a match haul of 10 for 187 for India against England last year, speaks about how he dealt with the injury and the lessons he has learnt from the setback

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

Akash Deep's early years were engulfed by one ordeal after another. Sometime in 2010, he was in his teens when he had to leave his modest home in Bihar and move to neighbouring West Bengal on the pretext of finding a job. In 2015, he lost his father and elder brother in the space of a few months. Even in mid-2025, as he was bowling India to victory against England in the second Test at Edgbaston with a match haul of 10 for 187, his elder sister was battling cancer.

So when he found out in March this year that he would be sidelined for nearly seven months with a stress fracture in his lower back, he didn't panic. Myriad curveballs had been thrown at the 29-year-old, and this was merely another that he had to deal with.

"I take everything positively. If I am injured today, I have the Centre of Excellence, a trainer, a physio and a coach. Even when I am practising, there are four or five members from the support staff. There are so many things set up for you to succeed. These are blessings," Akash, donning a training jersey and shorts, said in a chat with *The Hindu*. "If I was still back in my village, there wouldn't have been anyone to even tell me I am injured. I didn't see this phase as needing mental toughness. There was nothing to be depressed about. I had such a well-drilled system looking after me. You have to just wake up and work hard. There is nothing else to think about. It is a blessing to have such things. So I was motivated and positive throughout."

Akash was offering his perspective at a five-star hotel in Srinagar on Tuesday, two days out from the Irani Cup fixture between Rest of India and Jammu & Kashmir at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium. It will be his return to competitive action – his last outing was for Bengal against J&K in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy semifinal in February.

Vis-a-vis the hardships that life can entail beyond the sporting arena, a stress fracture may not be a tragedy. But it is no trivial matter either, for back injuries have derailed the careers of many promising fast bowlers.

The injury came about at the back end of a hectic season that saw Akash push the envelope in the quest to deliver Ranji glory for Bengal.

"When you are playing so much cricket through the year, I thought it was normal to feel stiffness. In the first innings of the semifinal, it was fine. In the second innings, I started feeling pain in my left glute and hamstring," recalled Akash. "I didn't feel anything in my back. We had a small total to defend. I took two wickets in six overs in the final session of day three. I was feeling stiffness overnight. But I thought I will get a break after the game for 7-8 days. I wanted to put in maximum effort. I bowled a spell of 10 overs with that on the morning of day four. While bowling, I didn't feel much. But when my body cooled, I started feeling it. There was a camp in the CoE after that. They took a scan and it showed a stress fracture in the lower back."

Till then, Akash hadn't known what it would be like to miss so many months of cricket. But in keeping with his propensity to see the upside of every situation, he felt this was his body getting its wish for a breather.

"By God's grace, the good thing in my case has been that I have recovered very quickly from injuries. I knew that even if it is a stress fracture, I would recover well if I followed all the processes correctly. Yes, I would have to miss some cricket. But I also felt that my body was demanding rest. I had been playing regularly for 8-9 years. I had never taken a very long break. Even when I had injuries, I had to miss cricket for a month at the most. I didn't take it in a negative way," he said.

K. MURALI KUMAR & IMRAN NISSAR

Recovery and rehab

While the BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) has faced severe flak recently for the recurring injuries that many of India's top players have encountered, Akash was generous in his praise of the state-of-the-art facility. So much so that he willingly returned to Bengaluru soon after his marriage in June.

"The people at CoE have a lot of experience. They have seen a lot of cases. Around 10 days after the injury was diagnosed, they put the entire plan and timeline in place. It has all gone accordingly. Neither I nor they missed a beat. In the initial stages, which was about rest and strengthening the core, I was going back home occasionally. But after my marriage, I was at CoE all through. If there is time on your hands, there is no better facility than CoE for practice, gym and recovery," he asserted.

The months at CoE, according to Akash, were put to very good use.

"I analysed a lot about how I can spend this time productively. I started focusing on every aspect. I spoke to a dietitian about how I can improve my diet further. Things like muscle training, how much to sleep... I realised that I have to use this time well to prolong my career. I hope I don't have to spend so much time on the sidelines again. I went into every little detail as an athlete," informed the seamer from the town of Sasaram.

Understanding his body

Keeping Akash company at different junctures were the likes of Jasprit Bumrah, Hardik Pandya and Mayank Yadav. All of them have had a history of acute back injuries.

"I asked them about the things I wanted to know, but the main thing is how does your body respond. That is the main lesson I've learnt from these months. I learnt about how my body reacts to different things like diet, training and sleep. It is very important to read your body as an athlete. That was a big takeaway," opined Akash.

Another learning is knowing when to operate at full tilt and when to apply the brakes.

It is admittedly a hard balancing act whilst being in the heat of the battle. Having entered the domestic season on the back of a breakthrough performance at Edgbaston, Akash seems to think he exerted himself a tad too much.

"After that England series, which was a lot of fun to play, I exerted a lot of effort in domestic cricket. I should have understood my body more," he felt.

"But when you are in the thick of the action, you tend to forget a lot of things. You just give it your all. You can never know about injuries. You have to play through phases. You don't know what that can lead to. To be honest, if it is a do-or-die match, it is very hard to hold back. But I can try to be smarter about situations where it is needed and where it is not needed."

An eye on Kiwiland

If Akash's comeback goes smoothly in Srinagar, his focus will gradually turn towards making the cut for the Test tour of New Zealand.

Scheduled in November, in the early stages of the Black Caps' home season, Akash's knack for extracting seam movement should make him an enticing pick in the southern hemisphere. "My strength is bowling long spells and at a consistent spot. My focus will be on that," he explained.

"You may have practised for 7-8 months, but a match is different. I have to get used to the rigour of playing matches. You may sustain yourself physically, but it is also about sustaining mentally for six hours for five days. That can only come from game time. So I have to get used to these things. Whenever I get a chance, I will keep myself ready to deliver."

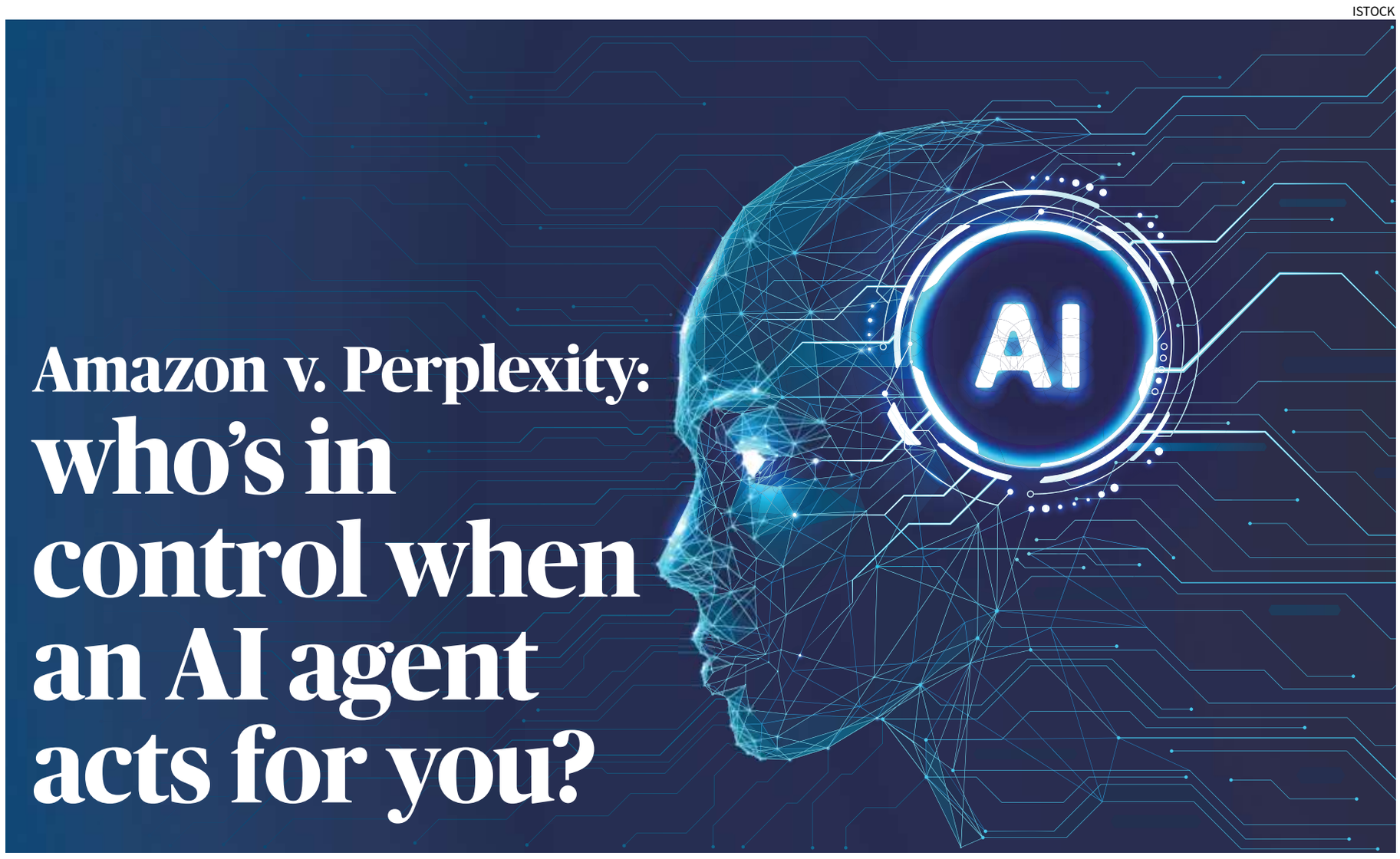
If there are any concerns about how soon Akash can find his rhythm, the seamless start he made to his Test career against England in Ranchi, with three wickets in his opening spell, is instructive. He may be still new to the Test fold, but knows his craft thoroughly by virtue of his extensive grind in the domestic circuit.

"I had played 40-45 First Class matches by the time I played Test cricket," he said. "So, I had that advantage. I had that confidence. When you are performing consistently in domestic cricket, you know how to perform regardless of the situation and batter. "I knew my strengths. I knew I just had to keep doing the same things that I had been doing for around four years."

THE GIST

- Akash will play for the first time after the Bengal-J&K Ranji Trophy semifinal in February in the 2025-26 season
- While the BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) has faced severe flak recently for the recurring injuries many of India's top players have encountered, Akash was generous in his praise of the state-of-the-art facility
- If Akash's comeback goes smoothly in Srinagar, his focus will gradually turn towards making the cut for the Test tour of New Zealand scheduled in November

ISTOCK



Amazon v. Perplexity: who's in control when an AI agent acts for you?

In India, where e-commerce, automated consumer services, and AI adoption are all expanding rapidly, the legal dispute between Amazon.com and Perplexity AI offers a useful, if also imperfect, template to think about platform governance and intermediary liability

Krishna Ravi Srinivas
Feba Sara
Gaurangi Kapoor

Artificial intelligence and digital commerce have locked horns in a case Amazon.com has filed against Perplexity AI. Amazon filed the suit in November challenging Perplexity's Comet browser, especially its 'Assistant' artificial intelligence (AI) feature.

While a conventional web scraper passively harvests text to train a model, an agentic system like Assistant can take multiple actions on a user's behalf, like a typical human agent: it can log into an account, compare products, fill a cart, enter credit card details, and complete a purchase all by itself.

Amazon's grouse is that while the Assistant accesses customers' password-protected accounts with the users' permission, it lacks Amazon's own authorisation.

The technology giant brought its claims under the U.S. Computer Fraud and Abuse Act (CFAA) and California's Comprehensive Computer Data Access and Fraud Act. On March 9, the judge hearing the case granted a preliminary injunction reasoning that the Assistant's access was unauthorised "regardless of whether the Amazon users had permitted Assistant to access their own Amazon accounts".

On August 4, a three-judge panel of the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit vacated that injunction. The panel held that it was the user, not Perplexity, who had "accessed" Amazon's servers, because Perplexity's own systems never communicated directly with Amazon's.

The ruling is narrow: the panel confined itself to the meaning of "access" under the CFAA and expressly left open other issues, including a potential breach of the terms of service. Still, the ruling is important for what it says about the legal identity of AI agents and the boundaries of a user's agency online.

In India, where e-commerce, automated consumer services, and AI adoption are all expanding rapidly, the case also offers a useful, if also imperfect, template to think about platform governance and intermediary liability.

Judicial reasoning

Three questions were central in the appeal.

First, the CFAA holds "whoever ... intentionally accesses a computer without authorisation" liable. And the Ninth Circuit read "access" to mean an action contemplated by a person rather than by a software tool. This reasoning distinguishes the case from the one between Facebook and Power Ventures, where a third party's own servers communicated directly with Facebook's – i.e. true server-to-server access.

In this case, because Perplexity's servers never contacted Amazon's, and the Assistant operated as an intermediary within the user's own session, the panel treated the user, assisted by the tool, as the party doing the accessing.

Second, the court had reasoned that a user consenting to use the Assistant could not stand in for Amazon's own authorisation. This reasoning effectively treated a consumer's authority over their own account to suffice, at least for the purposes of the CFAA, to authorise an AI intermediary acting at their direction. This is a meaningful change in how "authorisation" is allocated between platform and user, with implications for how judges decide on access and agency for the user vis-à-vis those of a service provider or a platform.

Third, Amazon sued Perplexity AI under the CFAA and the CDAFA rather than for breach of contract, and the panel did not decide whether the Assistant violated Amazon's terms of service. In fact, it noted that "other legal theories, such as breach of terms of service, may remain available".

This reservation can be read in light of a broader trend: to confine CFAA-type 'anti-hacking' statutes to breaches of technical barriers, and leaving purely contractual disputes to ordinary contract law.

Technically speaking, the case between Amazon and Perplexity AI has been decided by the technical architecture of the systems involved. To the panel, it did not matter whether the Comet browser meant to help users act against Amazon's wishes. Here, it was a two-hop design in which a user's browser 'spoke' directly to Amazon while Perplexity AI servers, working from screenshots, spoke only to the user's own device. A centralised scraping or transaction service maintaining its own sessions with retailers' servers would likely have fared differently. In such a case, the role of Perplexity AI might be central.

In four Acts

Section 43(a) of India's Information Technology Act 2000 penalises a person who accesses or secures access to a computer, computer system or network without the permission of its owner or the person-in-charge. Section 66 of the same Act attaches criminal liability where such access is dishonest or fraudulent.

An Indian court effectively has to decide whether a user's own authority over their account displaces the platform's denial of permission to third-party tools. Since the user supplies their own credentials, the AI agent functions as a digital proxy. However, Indian jurisprudence on agency and authorised delegation would generally consider this to be "unauthorised" access.

Now, India's major e-commerce platforms hold significant market power in several verticals. According to a May 2026 ICICI Securities Report, Flipkart held 50-60% gross merchandise value of Indian e-commerce, Amazon held another 25-30%, and Meesho accounted for roughly 10%.

A dominant platform that selectively blocks third-party AI agents while favouring its own proprietary assistant could come under the Competition Commission of India (CCI) scanner. This can be for denying market access and leveraging dominance in one market to protect another, categories that the CCI has already invoked against e-commerce platforms, including two cases involving MakeMyTrip (in 2019 and 2020).

Indian e-commerce platforms also make heavy use of click-wrap terms of use – where a user clicks a button saying 'I agree', thus accepting a contract – to restrict automated access. Under the Contract Act 1872, terms that unreasonably restrict a consumer's use of their own account or which amount to an unconscionable bargain remain open to challenge.

The U.S. court's ruling is important because it clarifies that AI agents act on behalf of users rather than as independent actors, helping define the legal boundaries of AI use online

That is, where a consumer has knowingly delegated a shopping task to an AI tool, a blanket platform ban on third-party assistants becomes an unreasonable restraint on consumers' preferences. Assuming such bans are automatically enforceable denies consumers a meaningful choice.

Finally, under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, platforms such as Amazon function as data fiduciaries and consumers as data principals. When an AI agent logs in using a user's own credentials, it processes personal data under that data principal's explicit direction.

The Act's framework allows 'consent managers' to help data principals give, manage, review or withdraw consent. An agentic shopping tool could plausibly operate within this framework as an automated intermediary with managed consent – but which could also complicate any platform strategy that tries to block such agents outright.

Perplexing: Amazon did not sue Perplexity AI for breach of contract, and the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit did not decide if Amazon's terms of service had been violated. REUTERS

Implications for India

The Ninth Circuit's ruling turned on where "access" technically occurred rather than Perplexity's commercial intent. So Indian AI start-ups building agentic tools would be well advised to favour client-side, user-mediated execution, keeping the point of contact anchored to the user's own device or session. This will minimise server-to-server liability and align with the technical distinction that Indian courts are likely to find persuasive under Section 43 of the IT Act.

Second, platforms such as Flipkart, Amazon India, Tata Neum and Meesho are likely to receive traffic from AI agents, if they already aren't. These agents read a page's underlying structure rather than its visual layout. As a result, they may bypass banner advertisements, sponsored placements, and other monetisation mechanisms designed for human attention. This could push platforms towards agent-facing APIs or new monetisation models.

Next, if Indian courts interpret "unauthorised access" to mean bypassing a technical barrier, then existing e-commerce platforms will not be able to rely on computer fraud law in a scenario where an AI agent accessed data simply by browsing a platform.

On the other hand, if the courts assign a broader reading to "unauthorised access" to include browsing by an AI agent, it could disproportionately favour dominant platforms.

A platform may then be able to invoke computer fraud provisions as a readymade instrument against agentic competitors, strengthening their control over the market at the cost of innovation and consumer choice.

Allowing AI agents to access under reasonable conditions is thus a better strategy than relying on technical barriers or blanket restrictions.

Looking ahead, e-commerce platforms should treat the terms of service as a weak and largely untested line of defence against agentic tools. Such terms did not form the basis of Amazon's claim in its case against Perplexity AI. Instead, they should invest in structured, official agent APIs that allow an agent to interact with a platform while also controlling the interactions, such as by limiting the number of data requests per minute or turning away suspicious bots. Such APIs can also protect monetisation.

As for policymakers and regulators, India's e-commerce booms, the advent of agentic AI should be met with laws that precisely define the rights and responsibilities of agents working on behalf of users. They should clarify when user authorisation suffices and they should identify when a platform's security interest should prevail. Overall, the laws should balance platform security, fair competition, and consumer autonomy.

It is time to start developing sandboxes and test multiple technical and legal options so that regulators are not found wanting.

(Krishna Ravi Srinivas is DPIIT IPR Chair Professor & Director, Centre of Excellence in AI & Law. Feba Sara and Gaurangi Kapoor are Research Assistants with IPR Chair, NALSAR University of Law, Hyderabad. Views expressed are personal. k.ravisrinivas@gmail.com)

Wild tapestry: An aerial image shows a blend of verdant and dry areas in Kafue National Park's savanna in Zambia. GETTY IMAGES

Once ruined, old grasslands never regrow the same way

Divya Gandhi

Ancient grasslands are one of the earth's least valued ecosystems, and yet they support a breathtaking diversity of wildlife, create livelihoods of billions of pastoralists, and store one-third of Earth's terrestrial carbon. But they are often considered "wastelands," ripe for development, mining, power projects or afforestation drives.

Now a new global study has found that once destroyed, grasslands that grew for millennia can almost never regenerate the same way, at least for a century. When they do "recover," the secondary grasslands consist of different species that are taller, with greater leaf area, found a study published in the journal Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences.

This phenomenon, said the paper, owes to altered ecological conditions, including soil nutrients and pH levels that are no longer suitable for old grassland flora. In their place are established plants that are taller, have higher specific leaf area, and lower dry-matter content, and non-native annuals, found the scientists, including a researcher at the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research in Pune.

For the study, researchers gathered data on 742 plant species from India, Australian, and Brazilian savannas and the iconic "big four" prairie grasses of the United States and compared old-growth grasslands flora with secondary grasslands species. "Notably, these trait differences that make old-growth grassland plants more resource conservative and secondary grassland plants more resource acquisitive persisted over a century," said the scientists.

Old-growth plant species include

A new study has found that grasslands that evolved over millennia rarely return to their original state; even when they recover, the regenerated grasslands are different species

fire-prone, megafauna-grazed ecosystems such as North American prairies, Australian savannas and Indian savannas, while secondary grasslands consist of a mix of native and non-native species, the paper stated.

Secondary grasslands, on the other hand, contain fewer plant species than the old-growth grasslands they replace.

The paper provides examples: many native perennial grasses and forbs that are characteristic of old-growth grasslands can be missing or replaced by non-native weedy annuals in secondary grasslands, particularly in the initial decades of recovery. Alas, natural grasslands cannot entirely be restored. However, in the Thar desert, Kutch, the Deccan, the Terai and in the Assam flood plains "I have seen restoration and the return to grassland obligated species," Asad Rahmani, a leading Indian conservationist and an ornithologist told *The Hindu*.

For example when the Solapur grassland was restored, it brought back the endangered bustard; in Kutch the grassland restored by the Corbett Foundation, brought the back lesser florican and many larks, warblers, white-browed bush chat; and on the Orange grasslands in Assam, the pygmy hog has been successfully reintroduced, Prof. Rahmani told *The Hindu*.

"We need a National Grassland Restoration Programme along with the National Grazing Policy," he added.

With 15% of the livestock of the world in 4% of surface area of the world, India does not have any programme or policy to restore the grasslands. "This needs to change for our livestock and wild animals that live in grasslands," Prof. Rahmani said.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Energy import bill of EU nations since the beginning of Iran war

113.5 in $ billion. European Union nations have spent over an extra 100 billion euros ($113.5 billion) on energy imports since the outbreak of the Iran war, pushing politicians to seek alternatives to fossil fuels as prices skyrocket. Consumers in some European countries pay nearly 50% more at the pump. AP

Service sub-sectors recording double-digit growth in July

10 As many as 10 out of 19 service sub-sectors recorded double-digit growth in July, according to the Index of Services Production (ISP) data released on Tuesday. The ISP data, published on a trial basis, showed that 17 sub-sectors recorded positive growth in July, according to a Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) release. PTI

Power to be imported by Nepal from India to meet peak demand

1,100 in MW. Nepal is planning to import up to 1,100 MW of electricity from India during the upcoming dry season to meet peak domestic demand, as recent flash floods, landslides and heavy monsoon rains have damaged hydropower projects and temporarily reduced the country's generation capacity. PTI

Amount cleared by Maharashtra govt. for SARTHI hostels

122 in ₹ crore. The Maharashtra government has sanctioned ₹122.34 crore for the Chhatrapati Shahu Maharaj Research, Training and Human Development Institute and released ₹150 crore to the Annasaheb Patil Economic Development Corporation, a State Minister said on Tuesday. Both are autonomous bodies set up by the government. PTI

Persons killed in recent rain-induced disasters across Nepal

27 At least 27 people have been killed in rain-induced disasters across Nepal since September 24, officials said on Tuesday. Four people remain missing and eight have been injured in incidents linked to heavy rainfall, including floods and landslides, according to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA). PTI

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What are the provisions of AFSPA?

AFSPA was enacted in 1958 to give the armed forces special powers in areas declared as 'disturbed' due to insurgency or serious internal security problems; it authorises the personnel to use force against persons acting in contravention of prohibitory orders, arrest without a warrant, and enter and search premises

EXPLAINER

Vijaita Singh

The Story So Far :

The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has extended the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1958 (AFSPA) in parts of Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh for another six months from October 1, 2026.

In Manipur, the entire State has been declared a "disturbed area" under AFSPA, barring the jurisdictions of 13 police stations in five Valley districts.

The latest order comes against the backdrop of the ethnic conflict that erupted in Manipur on May 3, 2023. Though AFSPA had progressively been withdrawn from several areas of the State before the conflict, MHA began restoring it in some areas after the security situation deteriorated.

In Nagaland, AFSPA will continue in nine districts, as well as areas under 21 police stations in five other districts.

In Arunachal Pradesh, the Act has been extended in Tirap, Changlang and Longding districts, and in areas under the Namsai, Mahadevpur and Chowkham police stations in Namsai district bordering Assam.

What powers does it confer?

AFSPA was enacted in 1958 to give the armed forces special powers to operate in areas declared as "disturbed" because of insurgency or serious internal security problems.

Once an area is notified as disturbed under Section 3 of the Act, security personnel operating there receive powers that ordinary police do not have. The law authorises the armed forces, subject to conditions specified in the Act, to use force, including lethal force, against persons acting in contravention of prohibitory orders; arrest without a warrant; and enter and search premises without a warrant.

It also provides legal protection to personnel acting under the Act. Prosecution or other legal proceedings in respect of anything done or purported to have been done done under AFSPA require the prior sanction of the Central government. It is these extraordinary powers and the protection against prosecution that make AFSPA contentious.

A rally organised by the Manipuri Students' Federation (MSF) in August 2026. PTI

Who can declare an area 'disturbed'?

Both the Central and State governments have the power to declare an area as disturbed under Section 3. This explains why the geographical application of the law has not always been determined solely by the MHA.

For decades, the Manipur government itself issued the disturbed-area notifications. Though AFSPA had been in operation in the State since 1981, the MHA had largely left the periodic renewal of the notification to the State government, which changed after the May 3 ethnic violence.

The law first came into effect in 1958 to deal with the uprising in the Naga Hills, followed by the insurgency in Assam.

Currently, the Union Home Ministry issues periodic "disturbed area" notification to extend the AFSPA only for Manipur, Nagaland and parts of Arunachal Pradesh.

The notification for Assam is issued by the State governments. AFSPA was removed from whole of Tripura by the CPI-M led State Government in 2015. Meghalaya was under the AFSPA for 27 years, until it was revoked by the Ministry from April 1, 2018. Jammu and Kashmir has a separate J&K Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act, 1990.

How did AFSPA shrink in Manipur?

AFSPA's footprint in Manipur had been contracting before the current ethnic conflict. Its application was withdrawn from the Imphal municipal area in 2004. A much more substantial rollback began in 2022, when the security situation was considered to have improved.

Between April 1, 2022 and April 1, 2023, AFSPA was withdrawn from all police station areas in the Manipur Valley. The State government cited an improved security situation and a greater sense of security among the public.

AFSPA, however, continued in the hill regions, where disturbed-area notifications had been renewed periodically for decades. The trajectory therefore appeared to be towards a gradual reduction in AFSPA-covered territory. The violence beginning in May 2023 reversed that trend.

On November 14, 2024, the MHA reimposed AFSPA in Manipur in the jurisdictions of six police stations spread across five districts. These were among the areas from which AFSPA had earlier been withdrawn.

The move was noteworthy because the notification came from the MHA rather than the Manipur government.

Did Manipur govt. agree with MHA?

No. The State government sought a reversal almost immediately.

On November 15, 2024, the Manipur Cabinet, led by then Chief Minister N. Biren Singh decided to recommend that the Centre review and withdraw the notification in "public interest".

The disagreement was unusual because the Centre and the State, both then governed by the BJP, took different positions on whether AFSPA should be restored in those six police station areas.

Why does AFSPA continue in Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh?

In Nagaland, the continuation of AFSPA has historically been linked to the presence and movement of armed insurgent groups as well as the unresolved Naga political issue.

The Centre has held negotiations with the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (Isak-Muivah), or NSCN-IM, and Naga National Political Groups (NNPGs). In 2022, security officials had indicated that uncertainty over the conclusion of the Naga peace process was one reason AFSPA continued in some areas of Nagaland and neighbouring States.

In Arunachal Pradesh, its application has been concentrated largely in districts affected by insurgent movement and areas adjoining Assam.

THE GIST

- The Union Home Ministry has extended the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act in parts of Manipur, Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh for another six months from October 1, 2026
- The law first came into effect in 1958 to deal with the uprising in the Naga Hills, followed by the insurgency in Assam

Why did the Centre reduce import duty on edible oils?

While govt. says the move will provide relief to consumers, farmers view it as an attack on their livelihood

A.M. Jigeesh

The story so far:

Ahead of the upcoming festival season, where the demand for edible oil is likely to increase, the Union Government announced on September 24 through a press release issued by the Consumer Affairs Department that the Basic Customs Duty (BCD) on major imported crude edible oils, including palm oil will be reduced. A day earlier, on September 23, the Union Finance Ministry had issued a Gazette Notification amending another notification issued on October 24, 2025 with details of the BCD on major edible oils. According to the government, the decision will help moderate domestic edible oil prices.

International situation

According to the United Nation's Food and Agriculture Organisation's (FAO) food price index, published on September 4, the vegetable oil price index averaged 196.9 points in August, up 1.1 points (0.6%) from July, marking its "third consecutive monthly increase and reaching its highest level since June 2022".

The FAO said the rise reflected higher world palm and soy oil prices, which more than offset lower quotations for sunflower and rapeseed oils. "International palm oil prices continued to increase, driven by robust global import demand and concerns over the potential impact of El Niño-related weather conditions on production prospects in Southeast Asia."

The new rates

The new BCD took effect from September 24. The BCD on crude soybean oil has been reduced from 10% to 5%. From 32.5%, the BCD for peanut oil and olive oil has been reduced to 27.5%.

For crude palm oil, which had a 10% BCD, importers will now have to pay 5% BCD. For refined palm oil, the BCD was reduced from 32.5% to 27.5%. Crude sunflower oil which carried 10% BCD on it, will not have any BCD on it from now on.

For edible-grade sunflower oil, too, the BCD has been reduced from 32.5% to 22.5%. "The Government has simultaneously reduced the applicable BCD on the respective refined edible oils while maintaining an import duty differential of 19.25% between crude and refined edible oils," the Government said in the release.

Reasons for duty rationalisation

According to the Government, the duty rationalisation takes into account the increase in international edible oil prices and the consequent rise in domestic landed costs and retail prices. It reasoned that the import duties constitute an important component of the landed cost of imported edible oils and, therefore, have a bearing on domestic market prices.

The Centre expects that the reduction in BCD on crude edible oils will lower their landed cost and facilitate transmission of the benefit through the domestic supply chain. "The measure is intended to provide relief to consumers while contributing to the broader objective of containing food-price and overall inflationary pressures," it said.

Industry response

The Indian Vegetable Oil Producers' Association (IVPA), the edible oil industry body, said the decision comes at an important juncture, particularly with the festive season approaching. IVPA president Sudhakar Desai said in a statement that lower import duties should improve the landed costs of imported edible oils which can provide some reduction in consumer prices. "For the edible-oil sector, the immediate priority is to ensure adequate availability across the country during the upcoming festival months, with higher household demand as well as increased requirements from the sweets, snacks, food-service and hotel, restaurants and cafes/ catering segments," he said.

He hoped that greater flexibility to import sunflower oil and soybean oil will shift away demand from palm oil which is expected to be relatively expensive due to implementation 'B50 bio fuel mandates' by Indonesia, one of the largest palm oil producers, and reduction of the acreage expansion in palm oil producing countries such as Indonesia and Malaysia.

Farmers fear impact on livelihood

Edible oilseeds farmers view the step as an attack on their livelihood. They also fear that this decision is a prelude to the proposed signing of a trade deal with United States, which is the largest producer of soybean.

Senior leader of All India Kisan Sabha Badal Saroj, who works among edible oilseeds farmers, said the decision works against the Government's claim that they are for self-sufficiency in edible oil production.

"What would the Government tell the farmers who have been asked to grow palms, sunflower, groundnuts and soybean to achieve this [*atmanirbharta]* in edible oil production?" Mr. Saroj asked. He added that the decision was to allow free-flow of soybean oil from the United States and alleged that the Union Government took the decision to please multinational corporate companies in the edible oil industry.

Who is the most vulnerable to cyber frauds?

Amid deeper integration into the digital ecosystem, cybercrime cases rose 17.9% nationally, to 1,01,928 in 2024; respondents who spent more time online were more likely to be targeted by fraudsters, while financial fraud was more closely linked to social and economic status, with wealthier and more educated respondents more likely to report being victims

Devesh Kumar

As daily life is becoming more centred on digital transactions, concerns around online safety and privacy have grown exponentially, with digital scams proliferating at an unprecedented rate. The data from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) highlights this the best. Cybercrime cases rose 17.9 per cent nationally, from 86,420 in 2023 to 1,01,928 in 2024, even as overall registered crime declined by 6 per cent in the same period. Cybercrime as crime category is moving sharply against the national trend.

Although registered cases capture only what was formally reported, and fraud as such is chronically under-reported. A recent study by Lokniti-Centre for the Study of Developing Societies (CSDS) and Common Cause of 8,306 citizens across 16 States captures the much larger, invisible layer on the scale and magnitude of this problem, examining how frequently citizens encounter fraud calls/messages, who is targeted, and the social profile of those most exposed.

Table 1: Frequently reported cyber fraud attempts

Received a call/ text message for	Many times	Sometimes	Rarely	Never
Investment opportunity, guaranteeing a high return	10	21	20	45
Delivery of a product you never ordered	8	25	20	44
Bank official asking for personal account details	7	20	21	49
A phone number has been linked to illegal activities	6	17	16	56
An unknown number claiming to be your friend/ relative who is in urgent need of money	6	17	19	54
Call from police or someone in authority claiming that your friend/ relative is in danger or has committed some crime	5	15	18	59

Note: All figures are in percentages. Others did not respond.

Table 2: Online engagement and exposure to fraudulent calls

Online exposure	Likelihood of receiving fraudulent calls/messages			
	Did not receive any fraudulent calls/messages	Low likelihood	Moderate likelihood	High likelihood
Not active online	54	27	14	5
Low online exposure	45	33	19	3
Moderate online exposure	30	34	26	10
High online exposure	22	32	28	18

Note: All figures are in percentages. This is an index created using questions including those regarding frequency of use of social media, mobile banking apps and UPI; frequency of receiving suspicious/fraud-related calls or messages, including fake deliveries, bank scams, emergency money requests, illegal activity claims, and fraudulent investment offers.

Table 3: Nature of cybercrimes faced by people

Nature of crime	Victims (%)
Digital financial frauds	54
Hacking of devices	13
Personal data theft	11
Cyberbullying/abuse on social media	7
Online sexual harassment	4

Note: The rest did not respond.

Table 4: Socioeconomic profile of digital financial fraud victims

Economic class	Victims of digital financial frauds (%)
Poor	47
Lower	56
Middle	57
Rich	57
Level of education	
Non-Literate	40
Upto Primary	44
Upto Matric	53
College and above	59

Note: The figures are only among financial fraud victims.

Table 5: Financial losses incurred by victims of digital fraud

Amount of financial loss suffered	Digital financial fraud victims (%)
No financial loss*	9
Up to ₹1,000	8
₹1,001 to 5000	25
₹5,001 to 10,000	16
₹10,001 to 20,000	13
Above ₹20,000	23

Note: The rest did not respond.
*Since not all digital fraud resulted in loss of money, some people have reported no financial loss.

Scale of the scams

The scale of scams is striking. Nearly a third of the citizens reported frequently ('many times' and 'sometimes') receiving calls about deliveries they never ordered (33%), and regularly encountered high-return investment scam calls (31%). More than a fourth (27%) frequently received calls from bank officials asking for personal account details, and about a fourth received calls about their phones being linked to illegal activities (23%) or an unknown number claiming to be their friend urgently in need of money (23%). A fifth of the respondents frequently received calls from police or someone in authority claiming that their friend or relative is in danger or has committed some type of crime (**Table 1**). However, it important to note that that a majority, roughly half to six in ten respondents have never received these calls.

Moreover, respondents who spend more time online were more likely to be targeted by fraudsters. Among respondents with high online usage, 18 per cent fall in the high scam-exposure category and 28 per cent in the moderate category; together, over 46 percent report scam exposure. In contrast, among those who do not use the internet, only 5 per cent report high exposure and 14 per cent report moderate exposure (**Table 2**).

Exploiting the digital footprint

The common thread is deeper integration into the digital ecosystem creating a larger footprint for fraudsters to exploit. Instead of relying solely on technical expertise, fraudsters target social relationships and institutional credibility. Investment scams appeal to the aspiration of getting rich quickly, delivery scams draw on trust in e-commerce, bank impersonation uses institutional credibility, and fake police calls exploit fear of authority.

By manipulating familiar relationships and situations, fraudsters are able to effectively make deception appear legitimate.

But the important question is: how many of these encounters convert into actual harm? Data shows that 13 per cent of the people were a direct victim of cybercrime in last two to three years. Among them, more than half (54%) of the people have experienced financial fraud, 13 per cent said their devices were hacked, 11 per cent reported personal data theft, seven per cent reported cyberbullying or abuse on social media and four per cent reported online sexual harassment (**Table 3**).

Fraudsters exploit ignorance and vulnerability while also tracking digital participation to target those with resources

Targets of financial fraud

Financial frauds are more layered around social and economic position. The wealthiest people (57%) are most vulnerable to financial frauds, though nearly half of economically disadvantaged respondents (47%) are victims of digital fraud too.

Similarly, the more educated a respondent is, the more likely they are to be a victim of cybercrime. Forty per cent of those without any formal education are victims of financial fraud, as compared to nearly three in five (59%) college graduates (**Table 4**).

The losses incurred due to frauds are substantial. Over eight in ten victims of cybercrime reported some financial loss. A quarter (23%) lost upwards of ₹20,000. While eight per cent of respondents have lost up to ₹1,000, another 25 per cent have lost between ₹1,001- ₹5,000. Cumulatively, about 29 per cent have lost between ₹5,000 and ₹20,000 (**Table 5**).

In essence, fraudsters in India, all the while exploiting ignorance and vulnerability, are also systematically tracking digital participation aiming to catch those with resources. Fraud in this sense, has less become a tax on carelessness than a tax on connectivity itself.

(Devesh Kumar is a researcher at Lokniti-CSDS. Views expressed are personal. This analysis is based on data collected during a comprehensive study on 'The Status of Policing in India Report 2026' jointly conducted by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause.)

What does it take to obtain justice for cybercrime?

The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026, based on a survey by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause across 16 States, examines two factors that enable the progress of redressal in cybercrime complaints – bribery and using the influence of personal network; both channels are used more often, and appear to work more for the victims from marginalised groups

Priyanka Mittal

As digital payments and online services increasingly become a part of daily life in India, cybercrime has also emerged as a serious security threat for the citizens. For those who fall victim to cybercrime, seeking redressal from the police often involves more than procedural delays, such as the time taken or the number of visits to the police station.

The experience of cybercrime victims with the police is also significantly shaped by their direct interactions with police personnel themselves. This includes situations when victims feel like they must offer a bribe to get their case moving, or turn to someone in their personal network to exert pressure when nothing else seems to work.

The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026, based on a survey of 8,306 citizens conducted by Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause across 16 States, examines this question directly: Once a victim decides to complain, what actually determines whether the police act on it? How often do victims turn to a bribe or personal contacts, and does doing so make a difference to their chances of recovering the money they have lost?

Informal routes

Bribery and personal influence function as parallel, unofficial channels through which cybercrime victims try to secure police action

Table 1: Women, poor and rural victims were more likely to pay a bribe to the police

Gender	Victims who paid bribes (in %)
Male	22
Female	35
Locality	
Rural	36
Urban	24
Economic class	
Poor	51
Lower	18
Middle	17
Rich	12

Note: The responses include only the victims who made a payment to the police.

Question asked: Did you have to make a payment to the police at any point?

Table 3: Social status of victims who used personal contacts to enable/ expedite police action

Gender	Victims contacting their personal network (in %)
Male	35
Female	41
Locality	
Rural	44
Urban	35
Economic class	
Poor	55
Lower	28
Middle	31
Rich	30

Note: The responses include only the victims who contacted someone in their personal network.

Question asked: Did you have to contact someone in your personal network to put pressure on the police to deal with your case properly?

Table 2: Recovery of money by cybercrime victims based on whether they paid a bribe to the police

Victims	Were you able to recover your lost money? (in %)		
	Yes, full amount	Yes, partial amount	No amount recovered
Paid a bribe to the police	41	19	35
Did not pay a bribe	12	10	68

Note: The rest did not respond to either of the questions. All figures are in percentages.

Question asked: Were you able to recover your lost money?

Question asked: Did you have to make a payment to the police at any point?

Table 4: Recovery of money by cybercrime victims who used personal contacts to seek police action and those who did not (in %)

Victims	Were you able to recover your lost money?		
	Yes, full amount	Yes, partial amount	No amount recovered
Contacted someone to put pressure on the police	32	17	46
Did not contact anyone	13	10	67

Note: The rest did not respond to either of the questions.

Question asked: Were you able to recover your lost money?

Question asked: Did you have to contact someone in your personal network to put pressure on the police to deal with your case properly?

Paying to be heard

Nearly half of the victims surveyed – 49 per cent – said that they had complained to the police after the cybercrime. Another 9 per cent went to the police initially but did not pursue the case further, while 39 per cent did not complain at all.

Among those who did complain to the police, more than a quarter (27%) said that they had to make a payment to the police at some point to get their case handled. However, some victims were far more likely to pay this price than others. More than one in three women (35%) paid a bribe to the police as opposed to 22 per cent of male victims. Over a third of the victims in rural areas (36%) were more prone to paying a bribe to the police in comparison to a fourth of the victims in urban areas (24%). The sharpest trend is observed along class lines. Over half of the victims from poor economic backgrounds (51%) had to pay a bribe to the police, as compared to 12 per cent of those from affluent economic backgrounds, making a poor victim more than four times as likely to pay as a wealthy one (**Table 1**).

Furthermore, the findings show that paying a bribe to the police was also associated with a better chance of getting the lost money back. Among the victims who paid a bribe, 41 per cent recovered the full amount lost, compared with only 12 per cent of those who did not pay - a difference of 29 percentage points. In the same vein, the proportion of no recovery almost halved among those who had paid the bribe (35%) than those who had not (68%) (**Table 2**).

The network of influence

Bribery was not the only informal route victims used to move their case forward. More than a third of the victims, 37 per cent, said that they contacted someone in their personal network - senior police or government officials or local politicians - to press the police to handle their case properly.

As with bribery, this reliance on connections was more likely among women victims (41%) than men (35%). Rural victims also turned to their networks slightly more often than their urban counterparts (44% vs. 35% respectively). Once again, the widest gap is by class: 55 per cent of poor victims used a personal contact, against 30 per cent of the rich and 31 per cent of the middle class (**Table 3**).

In the case of both bribery and use of personal networks, it is the women, poor and the rural who report using these informal channels the most, not because they have more money or more powerful contacts to draw on, but seemingly because they have fewer other ways to get the system to work to address their grievances.

Here too, the informal route was linked to better outcomes. A third of the victims (32%) who used a personal network recovered the full amount lost to cyber fraud in comparison to 13 per cent of those victims who did not contact anyone, thus highlighting that a working connection roughly tripled the odds of full recovery (**Table 4**).

The need for change

Together, the two sets of findings point to the same pattern: bribery and personal influence function as parallel, unofficial channels through which cybercrime victims try to secure police action. Both channels are used more often, and appear to work more often, for the victims located on marginalised social positions: women, the poor, and those living in rural areas.

What the findings show clearly is that for a significant proportion of cybercrime victims in India, formal police procedure on its own is not enough to recover what has been lost. Until FIR registration and bank-police coordination for cyber fraud are made a matter of enforceable procedure, a payment or a phone call to the right person will remain, for a large share of India's cybercrime victims, the only reliable route back to their own money.

(Priyanka Mittal is a researcher at Lokniti-CSDS. Views expressed are personal. This analysis is based on data collected during a comprehensive study on The Status of Policing in India Report 2026 jointly conducted by Lokniti-CSDS & Common Cause.)